Small property firms chase, re-key and get fined

Problems, workflows, numbers, vocabulary and service gaps in small UK and US real estate businesses: independent estate and letting agencies of one to three branches, small property managers, brokerages and teams of 1 to 30 agents, solo agents, small landlords, investors and wholesalers

Research report, 12 October 2026

Problems and gaps only. This document adds no solutions and no recommendations.

Scope	UK (England mainly, with Scotland and Wales noted) and US small real estate businesses: sales agencies, lettings and property management, brokerages and agent teams, contract-to-close, investors and wholesalers. Five lines of business in two countries.
Inputs	Research note files compiled by the research team, one per section: time and money benchmarks, practitioners' vocabulary, workflows by line of business, fraud and rules, verification, platforms and the audit angle, handoffs, platform comparison, the thirteen-gap ranking, and the employed-versus-freelance market. Relative dates on BiggerPockets threads were captured on 11-12 October 2026.
Sources blocked	reddit.com on every mirror; Property118; Property Tribes thread bodies; Inman; The Negotiator; Estate Agent Today; Landlord Today in part; ConsumerAffairs; G2, Capterra, Software Advice, GetApp and AllAgents; Fiverr entirely; Upwork client fields and proposal counts; Zillow; HUD PDFs; the FCC; the ICO enforcement search; several GOV.UK HMRC and client-money pages; TPO's annual reports; Goodlord's report pages; Totaljobs, ZipRecruiter, Craigslist, Glassdoor and the Indeed US job-description pages for coordinator roles. The shared web-search budget ran out part-way through every notes file; research continued by direct fetch of known URLs. Facts from blocked hosts rest on search snippets, secondary reports, vendor claims or sponsored comparisons and are tagged.
Currency and dates	All currency as published: GBP for UK figures, USD for US figures. Dates are given so freshness can be judged.

How to read the evidence tags

[snippet]	the fact was seen only in a search-engine summary because the page blocked the researcher
[vendor]	the vendor's own claim or a vendor-run survey; no independent source confirmed it
[user, date]	a dated user review or forum post
[secondary]	the figure was relayed by a news site, aggregator or blog rather than read from the primary report
[sponsored]	a comparison paid for by a rival vendor
[n]	a numbered source; the URL is in the Sources appendix

Prepared for Mustafa Shoukat. Built from the research report *Small real estate firm problems UK US* (11 numbered sections, 40 tables, 13 gap cards, a 40-row unverified list). 485 numbered sources.

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Read this first

The eight numbers that carry the report, then the thirteen service gaps in rank order. Each gap has a full card in section 9.

216 days
UK listing to completion: 62 to find a buyer + 154 to complete; record, +36 vs 2019
Rightmove, Great Britain, Jul 2026 Property Industry Eye [1]

23.7%
of UK agreed sales fall through, at about £3,550 each (£1.065bn in 2025)
TwentyEA Q1 2026 Property Industry Eye [2]; cost Property Industry Eye [3]

9 sides
median US Realtor: $59,200 gross, $37,000 net; first two years $8,000
NAR 2026 Member Profile, 5,116 responses NAR [4]

14% / 5–7%
US contracts delayed / terminated; $223 per Zillow lead, $7,433–$22,300 per closing
NAR RCI [5]; Clever [6] secondary

73% / 61%
UK letting professionals report more admin / re-key data since 1 May 2026; complaints +47%
Propoly via Property Industry Eye [7] vendor survey; Property Industry Eye [8]

$275.1m
FBI real estate fraud losses 2025 (12,368 complaints); seller impersonation at 59% of title firms
FBI IC3 2025 [10]; ALTA 2026 [11]

£9,601
per fraudulent UK tenancy; suspected fraud +40% with AI-built identities; 6.4% of US applications
Goodlord via Property Reporter [12] vendor data; Snappt Multifamily Executive [222]

170 / £835,842
HMRC AML penalties on estate agencies in six months; 332 of 369 for never registering
HMRC list Apr–Sep 2025 via Comsure [13]

The thirteen gaps, ranked by problem signal and vendor weakness

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage	Automatable	Country
1	Renters' Rights Act compliance-date and record validation (certificates, notices, deposits, pets, rent reviews, database)	Very high	Weak	Fully for detection and exception lists	UK
2	Owner-statement and trust-ledger validation against the bank (AppFolio, Buildium)	High	Medium	Partly	US (UK client accounting similar)
3	AML source-of-funds reasoning and written risk assessment on file	High	Weak on the reasoning	Partly	UK
4	Sales-progression log and fall-through cause tracking	Very high	Medium	Partly	UK
5	Maintenance ticket ownership from report to confirmed completion	Very high	Medium	Partly	UK and US
6	Material Information assembly and listing checks (Parts A-C)	High	Weak	Partly	UK
7	Tenant application fraud triage and referencing exception handling	High	Medium	Partly	UK and US
8	CRM configuration validation and dormant-lead exception reports	High	Weak	Fully for detection	US
9	Contract-to-close deadline and document-completeness tracking across systems	High	Medium	Partly	US
10	Deposit deduction evidence and dispute packs	Medium-high	Medium	Partly	UK and US
11	Wholesaler list hygiene, record matching and consent or DNC logging	Medium-high	Medium	Partly	US
12	AI-written content compliance checks (fair-housing wording, Material Information accuracy, photo disclosure)	Medium	Thin on checking	Fully for the check	US and UK
13	CRM migration and data-cleanup validation	Medium-high	Weak	Largely for validation	UK and US

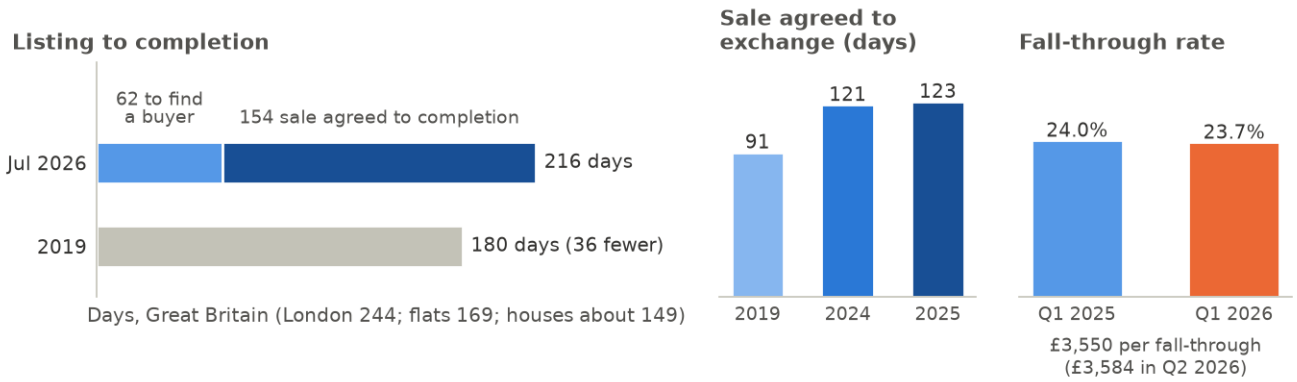
Crowded areas that are **not** gaps: listing descriptions and social posts; AI receptionists; CRM set-up gigs; commodity tenant screening reports; wire-fraud tools for title companies; promo video and photo editing; skip-trace data; AppFolio bookkeeping as a human service; cold-calling VAs and ISAs (section 9).

SECTION 1

An agreed sale pays after 154 days, one in four never pays, and the US agent closes nine a year

In both countries the firm's income arrives at the end of a chain it does not control: a UK agent is paid only at completion after 216 days and one agreed sale in four never pays; a US agent closes nine sides a year, so each delayed or terminated contract is a large share of annual output, and purchased leads cost more than most of them return.

A UK sale now takes 216 days from listing (62 to find a buyer plus 154 to complete), 36 days longer than 2019, and 23.7% of agreed sales fall through at about £3,550 each



Sources: Rightmove via Property Industry Eye, 31 Jul 2026 [1]; TwentyEA via Property Reporter, 15 Dec 2025 [14]; Property Industry Eye 17 Apr 2026 [2], 10 Apr 2026 [3] and 29 Sep 2026 [18]. 2025: 1,257,053 sales agreed, 303,538 fell through (£1.065bn).

UK sales: the longest wait on record, then a one-in-four loss

- A seller in Great Britain now waits **62 days to find a buyer and a further 154 days from sale agreed to completion, 216 days in all**, which Rightmove called the 'longest wait on record' and 36 days longer than 2019; London takes 244 days, flats 169 against about 149 for houses, Slough is the slowest local authority at 229 legal days (Property Industry Eye, 31 Jul 2026 [1]).
- TwentyEA measures **123 days from sale agreed to exchange in 2025 (91 in 2019)** (Property Reporter, 15 Dec 2025 [14]); a sales-progression firm says **60.8% of exchanges now take more than six months from instruction, against 36.1% in 2019** (Property Industry Eye, 1 Oct 2026 [15]).
- The agent is paid only at completion: 'Estate agents do not get their commission until completion so it makes sense for them to have a quick completion' (Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [16] user, Sep 2026).
- The loss rate: of **1,257,053 sales agreed in 2025, 303,538 fell through** and 986,665 exchanged, with 1,125,158 price changes and 803,612 withdrawals on 1,710,950 new instructions (Mortgage Solutions, 19 Jan 2026 [17]); the fall-through rate was **23.7% in Q1 2026** (24.0% a year earlier), 38% of failures happen within four weeks of sale agreed (Property Industry Eye, 17 Apr 2026 [2]); each one costs about **£3,550 (£3,584 in Q2 2026)**, £1.065bn across 2025 (Property Industry Eye, 10 Apr 2026 [3]; Property Industry Eye, 29 Sep 2026 [18]).
- Quick Move Now's smaller sample puts failures far higher, **41% of sales in April-June 2025**, with mortgage difficulties (45%), chain breakdowns (18%) and the buyer changing mind (14%) as causes (HomeOwners Alliance [19] secondary); the two bases differ and should not be averaged.
- The average fee per completed sale is **£3,909** (London £9,378, Liverpool £2,585) (Property Industry Eye, 17 Mar 2026 [20] vendor data, GetAgent), about 1.42% including VAT (HomeOwners Alliance [21]): roughly one agreed sale in four produces nothing after five months of progression work.

The chasing, measured from the other side of the phone

- Conveyancers 'probably spend on average 2 hours per day dealing with chaser calls and emails from estate agents', 'a whole working day per week when conveyancers are not doing conveyancing work', and many sales progressors 'do not speed the progress of a matter' (Conveyancing Matters podcast, 5 Sep 2024 [22]).
- Movers blame the other way round: **72% experienced a delay; of those who named a party 50% blamed the conveyancer, 40% the buyer or seller and 5% the agent** (Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [16] vendor survey).

- At large firms a sales progressor carries '150 to 250 cases at once' (Property Industry Eye, 24 Sep 2026 [23]); the record-keeping gap in one commenter's words: 'Without the log, every fall-through just feels like bad luck' (Property Industry Eye, 1 Oct 2026 [15] user, Oct 2026).

Table 1.1 UK sales measures

UK sales measure	Figure	Population and date	Source
Listing to completion	62 days to find a buyer + 154 days to complete = 216 days (record; +36 vs 2019); London 244; flats 169	Rightmove, Great Britain, Jul 2026	Property Industry Eye, 31 Jul 2026 [1]
Sale agreed to exchange	123 days (121 in 2024; 91 in 2019); Outer London 4.6 months, Scotland 2.9	TwentyEA, 2025	Property Reporter, 15 Dec 2025 [14]
Exchanges over six months from instruction	60.8% (36.1% in 2019)	TwentyEA via sales-progression firm, Oct 2026	Property Industry Eye, 1 Oct 2026 [15] secondary
Pipeline volumes 2025	1,710,950 instructions; 1,257,053 sales agreed; 986,665 exchanges; 303,538 fall-throughs; 1,125,158 price changes; 803,612 withdrawals	TwentyEA full year	Mortgage Solutions, 19 Jan 2026 [17]
Fall-through rate	23.7% Q1 2026 (24.0% Q1 2025); Inner London 27.0%; 38% fail within four weeks	TwentyEA	Property Industry Eye, 17 Apr 2026 [2]
Cost per fall-through	£3,550 (2025), £3,584 (Q2 2026); £1.065bn in 2025; 71,959 fall-throughs in Q2 2026	House Buyer Bureau on TwentyCi	Property Industry Eye, 10 Apr 2026 [3]; Property Industry Eye, 29 Sep 2026 [18]
Fall-through causes	41% of sales failed Apr-Jun 2025; mortgage 45%, chain 18%, change of mind 14%; seller £2,727 out of pocket	Quick Move Now sample	HomeOwners Alliance [19] secondary
Fee per completed sale	£3,909 (London £9,378; Liverpool £2,585); 1.42% inc VAT average	GetAgent Q4 2025; HOA 2026	Property Industry Eye, 17 Mar 2026 [20] vendor data; HomeOwners Alliance [21]
Branch activity	87 buyers registered, 13.6 listings, 2.3 viewings per available property (Apr 2025); 22 appraisals, 11.2 instructions, 39 for sale per branch (Jul 2025); 65 properties in stock per agent, a 12-year high (Sep 2026)	Propertymark, about 100 sales agents; Rightmove	The Intermediary, Apr 2025 [24]; The Intermediary, 3 Sep 2025 [25]; Rightmove HPI, Sep 2026 [26]
Conveyancer time on agent chasers	about 2 hours a day, "a whole working day per week"	Conveyancers' podcast, Sep 2024	Conveyancing Matters [22]
Cases per sales progressor	150 to 250 at large firms (franchise caps at 60)	Sep 2026	Property Industry Eye, 24 Sep 2026 [23]
Movers delayed and who they blame	72% delayed; conveyancer 50%, buyer or seller 40%, agent 5%	Voice of the Agent 2026	Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [16] vendor survey
Portal cost	Rightmove fees up about 18% in 2025; "over £1,500 + VAT per month"; about £4,000 a year extra	Mar 2025	Property Industry Eye, 5 Mar 2025 [27]
Branch closures	2,893 sales and 1,906 lettings branches closed in 2023; 15,401 sales and 14,544 lettings branches active at Q4 2023	TwentyEA	Property Industry Eye, 15 Jan 2024 [28]

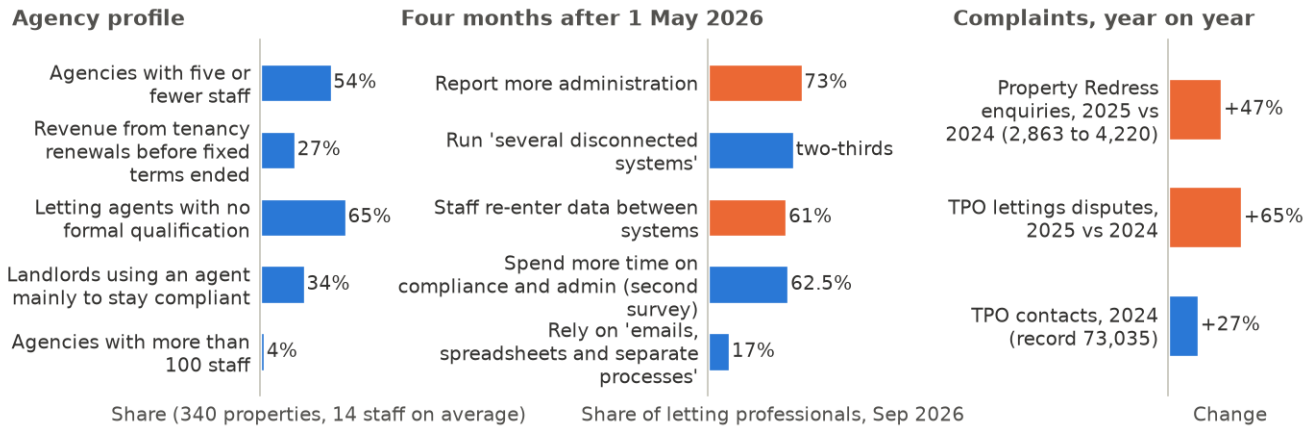
UK lettings has a different clock

- The average letting agency manages **340 properties with 14 staff; 54% of agencies have five or fewer staff**; each property draws **6 to 9 applicants**, voids run about **20 days**, and until May 2026 **27% of agency revenue came from tenancy renewals**, which the Renters' Rights Act removed by abolishing fixed terms (Goodlord SOLI 2025 [29] vendor survey, 2,750+ respondents; Propertymark, Dec 2025 [30]; Goodlord Rental Index, Sep 2026 [31] vendor).
- Four months into the Act, **73% of property professionals report more administration**, two-thirds run 'several disconnected systems', 17% rely on 'emails, spreadsheets and separate processes' and **61% say staff must 'transfer, re-enter or duplicate information between systems during a tenancy'** (Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [7] vendor survey, Propoly); a second small survey found 62.5% spending more time on compliance and administration (Property Reporter, 4 Sep 2026 [32]).
- Complaints moved with it: Property Redress complaint enquiries rose from **2,863 (2024) to 4,220 (2025), +47.4%**, the cause being 'agents having less time to devote to tenant experience as compliance and administrative workloads grow' (Property Industry Eye, 12 Jun 2026 [8]); The Property Ombudsman reported **lettings disputes up 65% on 2024** with 'poor or delayed communication and management' the top cause (Propertymark, 13 Mar 2026 [33]); TPO's 2024 contacts hit a record **73,035, up 27%** (The Intermediary, 20 May 2025 [34]).
- Self-managing portfolio landlords, the group agents compete with and recruit from: **52% find maintenance the most time-consuming task, 77% put off non-urgent maintenance for lack of time, 68% spend**

31 or more hours a month (LandlordZONE, 23 Sep 2026 [35] vendor survey, 525 landlords).

- Staff are cheap: a lettings negotiator averages **£28,492** and a property manager **£33,785** (Indeed UK, lettings negotiator [36]; Indeed UK, property manager [37] self-reported); **65% of letting agents hold no formal property qualification** (LandlordZONE, 18 Sep 2026 [38]).

UK lettings: the average agency runs 340 properties with 14 staff; since 1 May 2026, 73% report more admin, 61% re-key data between systems, and complaints rose 47% and 65%



Sources: Goodlord SOLI 2025 [29] (vendor survey, 350+ agents); Propoly via Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [7] (vendor survey); Property Reporter, 4 Sep 2026 [32]; Property Industry Eye, 12 Jun 2026 [8]; Propertymark, 13 Mar 2026 [33]; The Intermediary, 20 May 2025 [34]; LandlordZONE 18 Sep 2026 [38].

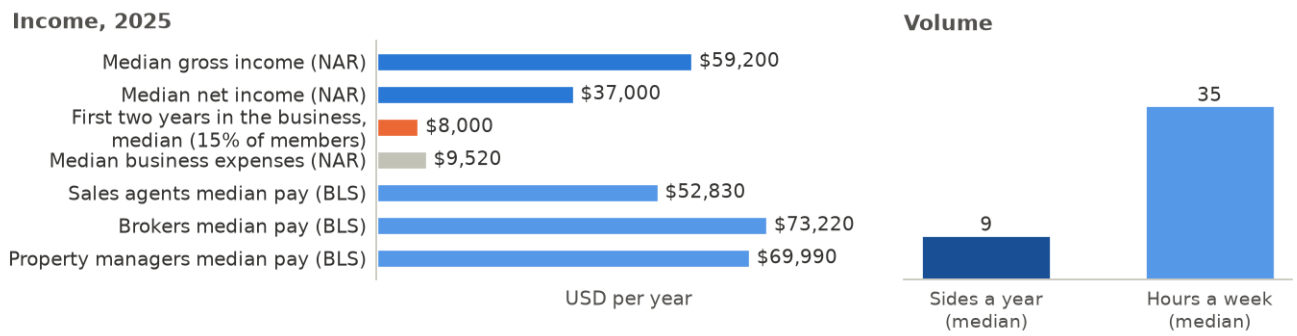
Table 1.2 UK lettings measures

UK lettings measure	Figure	Population and date	Source
Agency size	340 managed properties, 14 staff; 54% have five or fewer staff; 4% more than 100	Goodlord SOLI 2025, 350+ agents	Goodlord [29] vendor
Renewal revenue lost	27% of annual revenue from tenancy renewals before fixed terms ended	Goodlord SOLI 2025	Goodlord [29] vendor
Applicants and voids	6 to 9 applicants per property; 7.31 tenancies agreed per branch (Dec 2025); void 20 days (Sep 2026)	Propertymark; Goodlord	Propertymark, Dec 2025 [30]; Goodlord Rental Index [31] vendor
Extra work after 1 May 2026	73% more admin; 25% "significant"; two-thirds disconnected systems; 61% re-enter data; 17% emails and spreadsheets	Propoly survey, Sep 2026 (sample not stated)	Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [7] vendor
Complaints	Property Redress 4,220 enquiries 2025 (+47.4%), 34-day average resolution, £1,476,824 awards; TPO lettings disputes +65%; TPO 73,035 contacts 2024 (+27%), £1.49m awarded	2025 and 2024 reports	Property Industry Eye, 12 Jun 2026 [8]; Property Reporter, 3 Mar 2026 [39]; Propertymark, 13 Mar 2026 [33]; The Intermediary, 20 May 2025 [34]
Deposit disputes	1% of 4.7m protected deposits adjudicated (46,950 cases); cleaning 54%, damage 49%, redecoration 31%; average deposit £1,175	TDS, year to Mar 2025	NRLA, 22 Dec 2025 [40]
Landlord exits	31% of landlords plan to decrease their portfolio in two years; 16% to sell everything; 22% sold a rental in the year to Jun 2026	English Private Landlord Survey 2024; Pegasus Insights	EPLS 2024 [41]; LandlordZONE, 25 Sep 2026 [42]
Self-managing landlords' time	68% spend 31+ hours a month; 52% say maintenance is most time-consuming; 77% defer maintenance; 57% reconsidering self-management	Rushbrook survey, 525 landlords, Sep 2026	LandlordZONE, 23 Sep 2026 [35] vendor
Staff pay and qualifications	Lettings negotiator £28,492; property manager £33,785; 65% of letting agents no formal qualification	Indeed UK Oct 2026; TLIC survey of 616	Indeed UK [36] self-reported; LandlordZONE, 18 Sep 2026 [38]
New fixed costs	HMRC AML premises fee £300 to £400 plus £400 application fee, called unreasonable by 92% of 220+ members; landlord database £65 per property per year	Propertymark Sep 2025; NRLA Oct 2026	Propertymark, 15 Sep 2025 [43]; Property Industry Eye, 5 Oct 2026 [44]

The US agent's problem is volume, not waiting

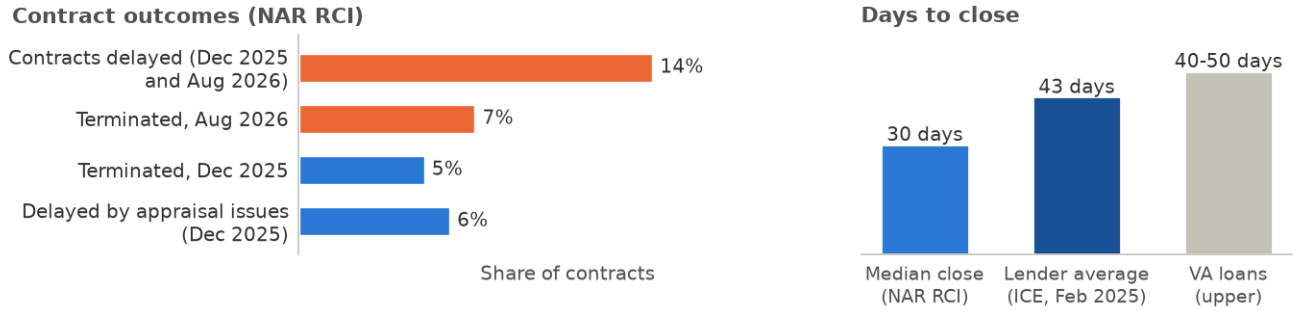
- NAR's 2026 Member Profile (2025 data, 5,116 responses): median **9 transaction sides, 35 hours a week, $59,200 gross and $37,000 net**; 86% independent contractors; 15% of members in their first two years earning a median **$8,000**; median business expenses $9,520; only 48% say real estate is the household's main income (NAR 2026 Member Profile [4]).
- Contract failure is steady: December 2025 confidence index **5% of contracts terminated and 14% delayed**, 6% of delays appraisal issues, median close 30 days (NAR RCI, Dec 2025 [5]); by August 2026, 7% terminated and 14% delayed (NAR RCI [45]).
- The lead side is the money sink. The only independent audit of response time (2013) found **48% of 384 buyer enquiries to brokerages were never answered** and 68% of consumers work with the first professional who answers (WAV Group 2013 [46]); a 2026 vendor benchmark puts the real estate average at **15 hours** (Prospeo [47] vendor, snippet).
- Zillow's published average lead cost is **$223 in major metros and $139 elsewhere**; purchased leads close at roughly 1 to 3%, so the cost per closing is **$7,433 at 3% and $22,300 at 1%**; Zillow's Preferred standard requires a predicted 4% conversion (Clever, 14 Sep 2026 [6] secondary).
- Agents' reviews of paid leads: 'I DID NOT SEE MY ROI', 'I paid over a thousand dollars for completely dead data', 'they promised me 1-3 leads a month but I've barely gotten any... 0 showings 0 meetings 0 future business' (Trustpilot, Realtor.com [48] user, Jan-Oct 2026).
- Behind the contract: agents carrying '15-20 files' lose track of 'inspection objections, lender conditions and signatures'; missed option-period and earnest-money release deadlines are 'still the biggest bleed I see' (BiggerPockets post 7250481 [49] user, about Aug 2026); a transaction coordinator's file takes 3 to 6 hours when clean and 8 to 15 when complex, with 20 to 30 dates per contract, at $350 to $500 a file (ListedKit [50] vendor).

The median US Realtor closes 9 sides a year for $59,200 gross and $37,000 net; members in their first two years earn a median $8,000



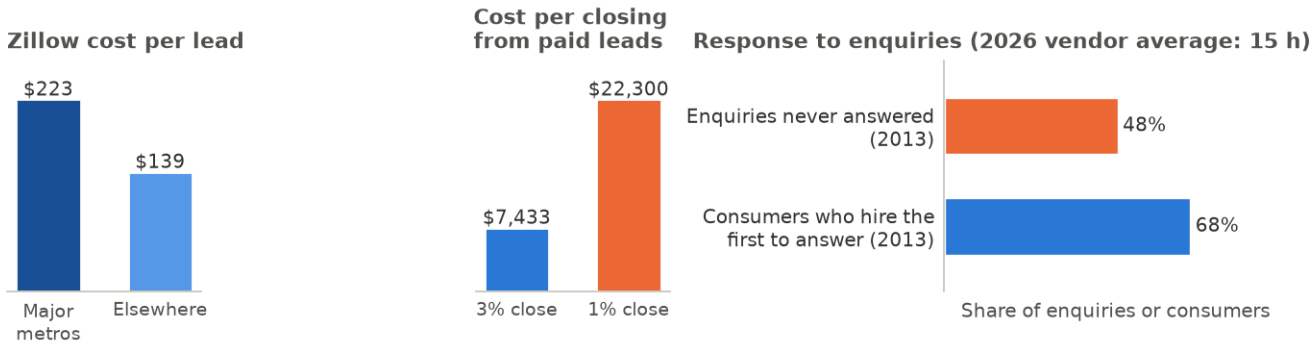
Sources: NAR 2026 Member Profile (2025 data, 5,116 responses) via Florida Realtors PDF [4]; BLS May 2025 [51] [52]. 86% independent contractors; 35 hours a week; median expenses $9,520; 48% say real estate is the household's main income.

US contracts: 14% are delayed and 5% to 7% terminated; the median close is 30 days while lenders average 43



Sources: NAR Realtors Confidence Index, Dec 2025 [5] and Aug 2026 page [45]; ICE via GoBankingRates, 5 Aug 2025 [53] (secondary). Appraisal issues caused 6% of delays; 39 days on market.

Lead economics: a Zillow lead costs about $223 in major metros, a closing from paid leads $7,433 to $22,300, and half of brokerage enquiries were never answered



Sources: Clever, 14 Sep 2026 [6] (secondary; close rates 1-3%, break-even 3.19%, Zillow Preferred requires a predicted 4%); WAV Group 2013 [46] (384 brokerages); Prospeo [47] (vendor, snippet).

Table 1.3 US measures

US measure	Figure	Population and date	Source
Agent income and volume	Median gross $59,200, net $37,000; 9 sides; 35 hours a week; 86% independent contractors; first two years median $8,000; expenses $9,520	NAR 2026 Member Profile, 5,116 responses	NAR via Florida Realtors PDF [4]
Government pay and headcount	Sales agents median $52,830 (427,000 jobs); brokers $73,220; property managers $69,990 (460,400 jobs); 54% of agents self-employed	BLS, May 2025	BLS agents [51]; BLS property managers [52]
Contract failure and delay	Terminated 5% (Dec 2025), 7% (Aug 2026); delayed 14%; appraisal issues 6%; 30 days to close; 39 days on market	NAR RCI	NAR RCI Dec 2025 [5]; NAR RCI page [45]
Lender time to close	43 days average (Feb 2025); VA loans 40-50	ICE via GoBankingRates	GoBankingRates, 5 Aug 2025 [53] secondary
Lead response	48% of enquiries never answered; 1.5 call-backs and 2.07 emails on average; 68% hire the first who answers (2013); 15-hour average (2026)	WAV Group, 384 brokerages; Prospeo	WAV Group 2013 [46]; Prospeo [47] vendor, snippet
Lead cost	Zillow $223 metro, $139 elsewhere; $20-60 commonly; $450-500 hottest markets; $50 per ZIP minimum; Preferred success fee 15-40% of commission; Realtor.com about $200/month shared, $1,000+ exclusive ZIP; referral fees 25% typical	Clever aggregator, 2026	Clever Zillow [6] secondary; Clever Realtor.com [54] secondary
Cost per closing from paid leads	$7,433 at 3%, $22,300 at 1%; break-even 3.19%	Clever worked example	Clever [6] secondary
How clients find agents	Referral 43% of buyers, 37% of sellers; used before 15% / 29%; online enquiry about a property 7%; 80% of sellers contact only one agent	NAR PHBS 2025	BAM summary [55] secondary
Transaction coordinator economics	$350-500 per file; in-house $40,000-65,000; 3-6 hours clean file, 8-15 complex; 20-30 dates per contract; manageable at 10-12 files a month, breaks at 30+	ListedKit 2026	ListedKit [50] vendor
Assistants	US VA $20-40/hour; Philippines agency $7-15, direct $4-10; in-house all-in $4,135-5,495 a month	Stealth Agents May 2026	Stealth Agents [56] vendor
Technology spend and use	34% spend $50-250 a month, 20% $251-500, 24% over $500; CRM used by 46% (2026); barriers learning curve 63%, cost 59%; AI weekly use 48%	NAR technology surveys 2025-26	HGAR, 18 Sep 2025 [57]; HousingWire, 2026 [58]
Property management fees	8-12% of rent; placement $300-500; renewal under $200; maintenance markup 10-20%; eviction fee $200-500	iPropertyManagement 2023	iPropertyManagement [59] secondary
Property manager workload	AI adoption 20% (2024) to 58% (2025); 8% fully automated any process; 56% of owners hired a manager for maintenance; 75% saw more rental fraud; tenant quality top challenge	Buildium 2026 industry report	Buildium [60] vendor
Rent collection	On-time 83.2%; late 12.1%; full payment 95.7%	RentRedi data, 49,745 units, Aug 2026	Chandan Economics [61] vendor data partner
Eviction	$3,500 average total; 7-16 weeks; lost rent $2,540; filing fee $109; attorney $300-1,000 uncontested	Snappt aggregating TransUnion and others, Jul 2026	Snappt [62] vendor, secondary

US measure	Figure	Population and date	Source
Property-manager turnover	33-35%; 150-200+ properties per manager; over 60% faced abusive behaviour; "unmanageable workloads" the top resignation driver	Recruiter blog, Feb 2026	Worth Recruiting [63] secondary
Wholesaler lead economics	PPL vendors "over 200 dollars on average per lead"; ad-driven $500-3,000 a month at about $45 a lead; VA producing 60 leads $1,000-1,500 a month; about 70% of skip-traced numbers disconnected; DNC scrubbing removed "about half"	BiggerPockets threads 2024-26	BiggerPockets 1274376 [64]; BiggerPockets 1286268 [65]; BiggerPockets 1259450 [66] user

The shape of the work, in practitioners' own small numbers

- 15 to 20 open files per US agent; 150 to 250 cases per UK sales progressor; two hours a day of agent chasers on a conveyancer's desk; five message rounds per maintenance text 'because no written answer is on file'; 31 or more hours a month for a UK portfolio landlord; 1,000-plus dials for two sellers in follow-up; a two-hour evening calling shift for a part-time wholesaler (BiggerPockets 1303079 [67] user, Oct 2026; BiggerPockets 1286268 [65] user, about May 2026).
- Nobody in the reachable threads gives a weekly admin-hours figure for themselves; the only such numbers ('8 to 15 hours per file', '13-15 hours a week reclaimed', '45 hours per transaction with 30 on paperwork') are vendor claims with unverified attributions (Form Simplicity [68] vendor; Stealth Agents [56] vendor; ListedKit [50] vendor).

SECTION 2

Their own words: the UK "chases" and "progresses", the US "follows up" and "closes"

The two markets describe the same labour with nouns that almost never appear in the same document, and the difference decides which keywords work: the UK speaks in laws, bodies and forms; the US in tools, deadlines and money.

- **UK**: 'vendor', 'instruction', 'particulars', 'viewing', 'sale agreed', 'sold STC', 'exchange and completion', 'sales progression', 'chain', 'solicitors', 'memorandum of sale', 'referencing', 'right to rent', 'deposit protection', 'prescribed information', 'inventory', 'check-in and check-out', 'gas safety (CP12)', 'EICR', 'EPC', 'HMO licensing', 'section 8', 'section 13', 'section 21', 'arrears', 'landlord statement', 'let-only', 'fully managed', 'Rightmove', 'Propertymark', 'TPO', 'AML', 'Material Information', 'Renters' Rights Act'.
- **US**: 'seller', 'listing agreement', 'MLS remarks', 'showing', 'under contract', 'closing', 'escrow', 'title company', 'transaction coordinator', 'contract to close', 'CMA', 'leasing', 'screening', 'security deposit', 'work orders', 'vendors', 'HOA', 'Fair Housing', '3-day notice', 'owner statement', 'Zillow', 'IDX', 'ISA', 'skip tracing', 'TCPA', 'DNC', 'trust account', '1099' (Propertymark glossary [69]; WizeHire TC [70]; Indeed US leasing agent [71]).
- Autocomplete confirms the split: US searchers compare tools ('follow up boss vs lofty', 'kvcore vs boldtrail', 'claude vs chatgpt for realtors') and ask about fees and checklists; UK searchers name statutes and forms ('renters rights act section 8 ground 1a', 'section 13 notice form 4a', 'material information part b'); 'reapit vs' and 'alto vs' return nothing; 'overwhelmed', 'overload' and 'burnout' phrasings return almost nothing in either country, because the pain is expressed through process nouns ('checklist', 'fee', 'how long', 'vs') rather than feelings (Google suggest, US [72]; Google suggest, UK [73]).

Table 2.1 Concept by concept: UK words against US words (keyword list)

Concept	UK words (ads, glossaries, forums)	US words (ads, forums)
The person	estate agent, negotiator, lettings negotiator, sales progressor, property manager, lettings administrator, inventory clerk, Pre Tenancy Coordinator, "Compliance & Maintenance Coordinator"	agent, realtor, broker, ISA (inside sales agent), transaction coordinator (TC), listing coordinator, leasing agent, maintenance coordinator, real estate VA (REVA), appointment setter, cold caller, acquisitions manager
The client who sells	vendor	seller
Taking the business	instruction, new instruction, valuation, market appraisal, "Book valuations"	listing, listing agreement, CMA, listing appointment
The advert	property details, particulars, "Creating property details"	listing description, MLS remarks ("mls listing description character limit")
Seeing the property	viewing	showing, tour (rentals)
Deal status	sale agreed, sold STC, under offer, let agreed	under contract, pending
Finish line	exchange and completion, "handing over the keys"	closing, "closed keys"
The middle	sales progression, chasing solicitors, chain, memorandum of sale, searches, management pack	contract to close, contingency clock, EMD, option period, inspection, appraisal, clear to close, Closing Disclosure
The other professionals	solicitors, conveyancers, surveyors, lenders, "other estate agents involved in the chain"	title company, escrow, lender, attorney, inspector, appraiser
Failure	fall-through, "sale fell through", chain breakdown, gazumping, gazundering	deal "fell out of escrow", terminated contract, "missed option-period and EMD release deadlines"
Renting	lettings, letting agent, tenancy, AST, periodic tenancy, let-only, fully managed, tenant find	leasing, leasing agent, lease, lease renewal, tenant placement, full-service management
Checking the tenant	referencing, "how long does tenant referencing take", right to rent check, share code, guarantor	tenant screening, background and credit checks, application fee, FCRA adverse action, co-signer
Money held	deposit protection, TDS, DPS, prescribed information, deposit deductions, holding deposit, client money protection	security deposit, itemised deductions, trust account, escrow account, earnest money
Condition records	inventory, check-in, check-out report	move-in and move-out inspection
Safety and compliance	gas safety certificate (CP12), EICR, EPC, HMO licence, selective licensing, Awaab's Law	Fair Housing, HUD, REAC, HAP, Section 8 voucher, lead-paint disclosure
Ending a tenancy	section 8 notice, section 21 (gone), ground 1A, section 13 / Form 4A, notice period	eviction, 3-day or 5-day notice, notice to quit, unlawful detainer, writ
Unpaid rent	arrears, rent arrears, "follow arrears procedure"	late rent, collections, delinquency
Reporting to the owner	landlord statement, landlord updates	owner statement, "Owner-Ready Financials", owner portal, 1099

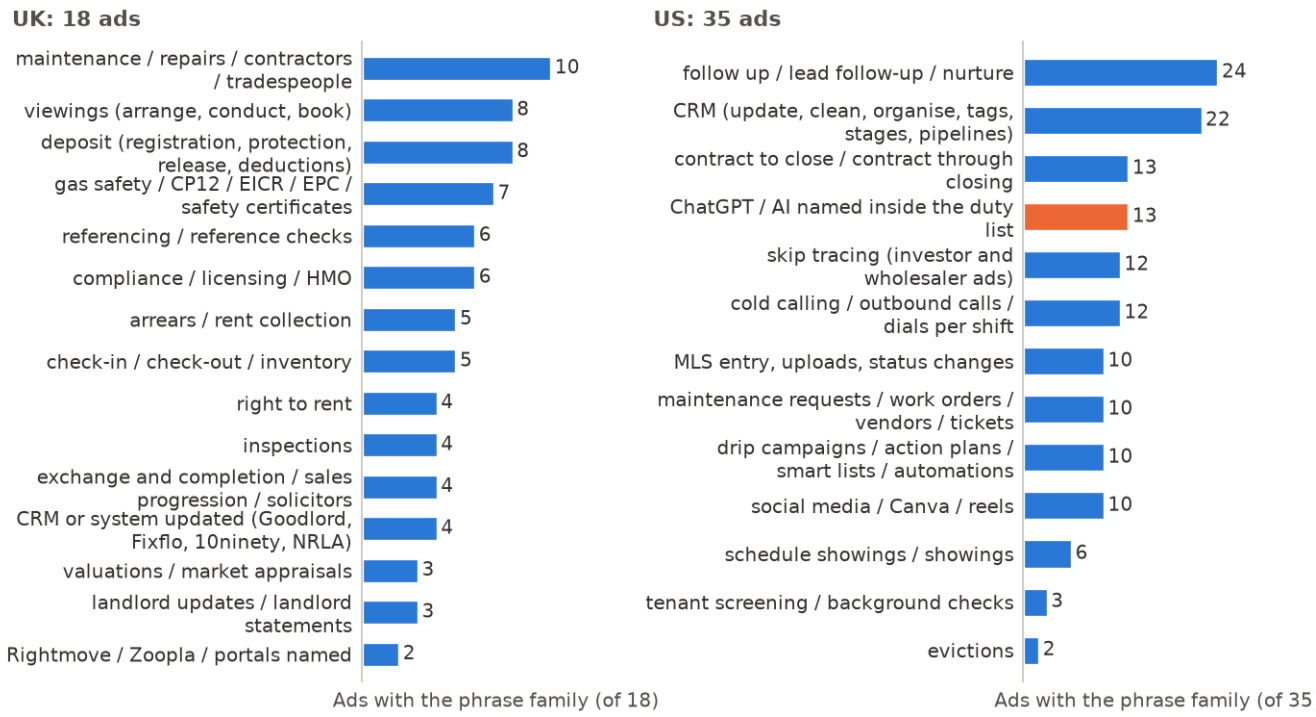
Concept	UK words (ads, glossaries, forums)	US words (ads, forums)
Where the leads come from	Rightmove, Zoopla, OnTheMarket, OpenRent, SpareRoom, "portals"	MLS, IDX, Zillow, Realtor.com, Zillow Flex, expireds, FSBOs, "geographic prospecting lists"
Lead handling	"update landlords on feedback", "follow up leads so no enquiry goes cold", "chase"	"follow up", "speed to lead", "nurture", "drip campaigns", "action plans", "smart lists", "no lead falls through the cracks"
Repairs	maintenance, repairs, contractors, tradespeople, works orders, "chase every job to completion"	maintenance requests, work orders, vendors, tickets, "vendor dispatch", NTE (not-to-exceed), "'Vendor says it's done' is not the same thing as closed"
Rules and bodies	Propertymark, ARLA, TPO, Property Redress, NTS, HMRC, AML, Material Information, DMCC, Tenant Fees Act, Renters' Rights Act	NAR, brokerage compliance, file compliance, disclosures, TCPA, DNC, 10DLC, mini-TCPA
Block work	block management, service charge, section 20, resident management company	HOA, community association management, estoppel certificate
The pain verb	chasing, being chased, "any update?", "ghosting", "nobody turned up", "daylight robbery" (portal fees), "cannot recover" (AML fees)	follow up, "falls through the cracks", "nobody owned it", "dead data", "I DID NOT SEE MY ROI", "padded", "skip tracing dead names"

Sources: Propertymark glossary [69]; Propertymark on advertising terms [74]; GOV.UK How to let [75]; Reed estate agency jobs [76]; Indeed UK property manager [77]; OnlineJobs.ph compliance coordinator post [78]; WizeHire listing coordinator [79]; Indeed US property manager [80]; Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]; BiggerPockets 1303197 [9]; Property Industry Eye, 5 Mar 2025 [27]; Trustpilot Realtor.com [48].

What job advertisements pay people to do

- Across **18 UK ads** read on 11-12 October 2026 (Indeed UK templates and examples, three Connells-group ads on Reed, one Workable ad, a Propertymark snippet, six posts by small UK agencies on OnlineJobs.ph) the duty families are maintenance and contractors, viewings, deposit administration and safety certificates; across **35 US ads** (WizeHire templates, Indeed US templates, nine OnlineJobs.ph posts, two ProsMarketplace posts, one South African staffing site, 16 Upwork posts) they are lead follow-up, keeping the CRM clean, contract to close, and, in **13 of 35, an AI tool named inside the duty list** ('Create post captions with ChatGPT', 'use AI to draft replies', 'creating high-quality AI prompts for real estate follow-up') (Indeed UK lettings negotiator [82]; Reed 57397576 [83]; WizeHire TC [70]; OnlineJobs.ph 1491810 [84]; Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]). Both tallies are counts of phrase families in the ads fetched, not board-wide statistics.
- 'No lead falls through the cracks' appears in three separate US posts; 'fall-through' never appears in UK ads but does in UK autocomplete; 'chasing' appears in UK posts by small firms ('chasing unresponsive contacts through multiple channels until resolved', 'Chase every job to completion and close it out with photos and invoices') but not in the Connells-group ads, which write around process stages ('Progressing sales through to exchange and completion') (OnlineJobs.ph 1734802 [85]; Reed 57348677 [86]).

UK ads are about maintenance, viewings, deposits and certificates; US ads about lead follow-up, keeping the CRM clean and contract to close, with an AI tool named in 13 of 35



Sources: 18 UK ads read 11-12 Oct 2026 (Indeed UK templates, three Connells-group ads on Reed [83], one Workable ad, a Propertymark snippet, six OnlineJobs.ph posts [78]); 35 US ads (WizeHire [70], Indeed US, nine OnlineJobs.ph posts, two ProsMarketplace posts, one South African staffing site, 16 Upwork posts [81]). Counts of phrase families, not board-wide statistics.

Table 2.2 Phrase families in UK and US ads

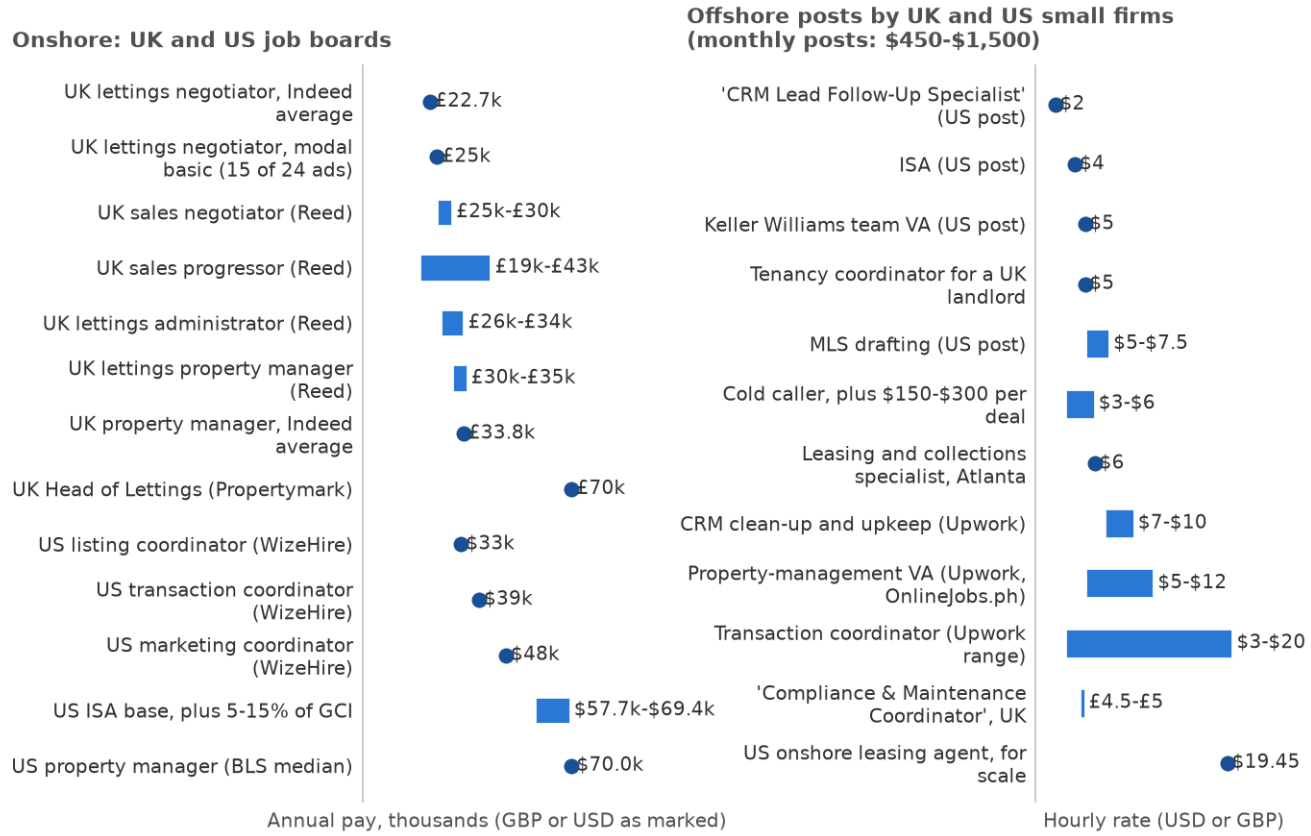
Phrase family in UK ads (18 ads)	Ads	Phrase family in US ads (35 ads)	Ads
maintenance / repairs / contractors / tradespeople	10	follow up / lead follow-up / nurture	24
viewings (arrange, conduct, book)	8	CRM (update, clean, organise, tags, stages, pipelines)	22
deposit (registration, protection, release, deductions, TDS/DPS, prescribed information)	8	contract to close / contract through closing	13
gas safety / CP12 / EICR / electrical / EPC / safety certificates	7	ChatGPT / AI named inside the duty list	13
referencing / reference checks	6	skip tracing (investor and wholesaler ads)	12
compliance / licensing / HMO	6	cold calling / outbound calls / dials per shift	12
arrears / rent collection	5	MLS entry, uploads, status changes	10
check-in / check-out / inventory	5	maintenance requests / work orders / vendors / tickets	10
right to rent	4	drip campaigns / action plans / smart lists / automations	10
inspections	4	social media / Canva / reels	10
exchange and completion / sales progression / solicitors (sales ads only)	4	schedule showings / showings	6
CRM or system updated (Goodlord, Fixflo, 10ninety, NRLA Portfolio named)	4	tenant screening / screen applicants / background checks	3
valuations / market appraisals	3	evictions	2
landlord updates / landlord statements	3		
Rightmove / Zoopla / portals named	2		

Sources: UK tally over Indeed UK lettings negotiator [82], estate agent [87] and property manager [77], Reed 57341662 [88], 57348677 [86] and 57397576 [83], Workable St John Lettings [89], OnlineJobs.ph 1740481 [78], 1731573 [90] and 1742926 [91]; US tally over WizeHire TC [70] and admin assistant [92], Indeed US leasing agent [71], OnlineJobs.ph 1329666 [93] and 1658028 [94], wfh.team ISA [95], Upwork jobs: kvcore [96], transaction coordinator [97] and property management VA [98].

The pay attached to those duties sets the ceiling

- Reed, September-October 2026: **15 of 24 lettings negotiator ads state £25,000 basic** (Connells, William H Brown, Dixons, Frank Innes and others); sales negotiators cluster at £25,000 to £30,000; sales progressors run from £19,000-£22,000 (Connells, Wolverhampton, part time) to £37,000-£43,000 (Blackburn); lettings administrators £26,000-£34,000; lettings property managers £30,000-£35,000; the only salaried ad on Propertymark's board was a Head of Lettings at £70,000 (Reed lettings negotiator [99]; Reed sales progressor [100]; Reed lettings administrator [101]; Propertymark jobs [102]); Indeed's UK averages are £22,657 for a lettings negotiator and £27,979 for an estate agent; a part-time block-management property manager in Aylesbury is offered 'Up to £12.00 per hour' (Indeed UK lettings negotiator [82]; Indeed UK property manager [77]).
- US: WizeHire's national averages are **$39,000 for a transaction coordinator, $33,000 for a listing coordinator, $48,000 for a marketing coordinator and $15 an hour for an administrative assistant**; Indeed's common leasing-agent rate is $19.45 an hour; an ISA is benchmarked at $57,686 to $69,398 plus 5 to 15% of gross commission (WizeHire TC [70]; WizeHire listing coordinator [79]; Indeed US leasing agent [71]; Wise Pelican [103] secondary).
- The same duty lists posted offshore pay a tenth of that: a West London single-branch agency offers a property-management VA 'From $1,050/month' for 45 hours a week including Saturday mornings; a UK lettings and HMO agency offers a 'Compliance & Maintenance Coordinator' at 'GBP 4.50 - 5.00+ per hour'; a UK landlord offers 'US$5 per hour' for a tenancy coordinator to 'build and maintain an auditable property-management system' showing 'what needed doing, what was done, when, by whom and the supporting evidence'; a 200-property UK portfolio offers two remote property managers at $700-$850 a month; US posts offer $2 an hour for a 'CRM Lead Follow-Up Specialist', $4 for an ISA, $5 for a Keller Williams team VA, $5-$7.50 for MLS drafting, $700-$1,500 a month for a transaction coordinator and $450-$800 a month for a bilingual Follow Up Boss VA (OnlineJobs.ph 1734802 [85]; OnlineJobs.ph 1740481 [78]; OnlineJobs.ph 1731573 [90]; OnlineJobs.ph 1742926 [91]; OnlineJobs.ph 1329666 [93]; OnlineJobs.ph 847141 [104]; ProsMarketplace TC [105]; ProsMarketplace FUB VA [106]).
- OnlineJobs.ph search volumes on 11 October 2026 (the search caps at 300): **'transaction coordinator' 300, 'skip tracing' 298, 'follow up boss' 296, 'real estate cold calling' 292, 'property management' 287, 'real estate' 263, 'UK property' 190**, 'listing description' 18 (mostly e-commerce): the titles the small US firm already outsources, and UK property work a sizeable minority on the same board (OnlineJobs.ph: transaction coordinator [107]; OnlineJobs.ph: UK property [108]).

The same duties pay £22,657 to £43,000 onshore in the UK and $33,000 to $69,398 in the US, and $2 to $12 an hour or $450 to $1,500 a month when posted offshore



Sources: Reed Sep-Oct 2026 [99] [100] [101]; Indeed UK [36] [37] (self-reported); WizeHire [70] [79]; Indeed US [71]; Wise Pelican [103] (secondary); OnlineJobs.ph posts [85] [78] [90] [91]; ProsMarketplace [105] [106]; Upwork posts [81].

Table 2.3 Pay for the duty, where posted

Pay for the duty (where posted)	UK	US onshore	Offshore posts by UK and US small firms	Sources
Lettings negotiator / leasing agent	£25,000 modal basic (15 of 24 Reed ads); Indeed average £22,657	$19.45/hour common; examples $13-$21/hour	"Leasing & Collections Specialist" $6/hour (Atlanta)	Reed [99]; Indeed US [71]; OnlineJobs.ph PM search [109]
Sales progressor / transaction coordinator	£19,000-£22,000 (Connells) to £37,000-£43,000; £28,000 basic with £35-40k OTE (East London)	$39,000 national average (WizeHire); TC fee $350-$500 per file	$2-$12/hour; $350 per closed file; $700-$1,500 a month; "$5.50-$6.80/hr + $50 per closed deal"	Reed sales progressor [100]; StudentJob [110]; WizeHire [70]; OnlineJobs.ph TC [107]; Upwork TC jobs [97]
Lettings administrator / listing coordinator	£26,000-£34,000; deposit administrator £23,333; part-time £12-£14/hour	$33,000 national average	"Real Estate Admin VA (Transaction/Listing Coordinator)" $4-$6/hour	Reed lettings administrator [101]; WizeHire listing coordinator [79]; OnlineJobs.ph 1740324 [111]
Property manager	£30,000-£35,000 (Reed); £33,785 Indeed average; £12/hour part-time block work	$45,000 example; $69,990 BLS median	UK: $700-$855 a month, $500 a month; "GBP 4.50-5.00+ per hour"; US: $800-$1,000 a month, $4/hour with Hubstaff monitoring	Reed lettings property manager [112]; Indeed US property manager [80]; OnlineJobs.ph UK property [108]
ISA / cold caller / lead follow-up	No UK equivalent found; "Business Development Associate" $300 a month plus $50-$75 per instruction	$57,686-$69,398 plus 5-15% of GCI; Napa listing $60-115k	$2/hour (follow-up only), $3-$6/hour plus $150-$300 per closed deal, $5-$7/hour plus $10 per appointment that shows; "900 calls per week"	OnlineJobs.ph 1746826 [113]; Wise Pelican [103] secondary; OnlineJobs.ph cold calling [114]; Upwork FUB jobs [81]
Head of department	Head of Lettings £70,000 (Basingstoke); Lettings Manager £37,000-£50,000 (Connells Bristol)	Marketing coordinator $48,000	"Operations Manager / Integrator" $8-$10/hour with "3 years of direct US Residential Real Estate experience (Non-negotiable)"	Propertymark jobs [102]; Reed [112]; OnlineJobs.ph TC [107]

Freelance posts carry the pain in plainer words

- Upwork (81 live posts read across nine searches, August-October 2026): a Wilmington team hiring a 'Follow Up Boss Lead Backstop' at $5-$7 an hour writes 'Your job is to make sure no lead falls through the cracks' and 'When our agents don't work a lead fast enough, you step in'; a broker wants someone to 'Clean up duplicate or outdated contacts' and 'take ownership of keeping my CRM clean, organized, and current'; a sole agent types, verbatim, 'set up my follow-up bus to where the clients that I have worked with are being touched on a 30 day basis or 90 day basis or some kind of touch point I don't know exactly what I'm needing'; an owner-finance investor needs a TC who 'proactively identifies missing documents, follows up with the appropriate parties, and keeps every transaction moving without waiting for management to notice a problem'; a Denver founder wants 'someone to take the day-to-day off my plate so I can stay focused on deals'; a two-agent team says '840-850 leads are sitting dormant in the team's CRM' while warm leads 'go unworked while he is out on showings'; a Miami brokerage owner budgets $1,000 fixed for the whole BoldTrail stack (Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]; Upwork jobs: transaction coordinator [97]; Upwork jobs: real estate ai chatbot [115]; wfh.team ISA [95]; Upwork jobs: kvcore [96]).
- Property-management posts: the 'day to day runs on maintenance getting handled, vendors staying coordinated, and leases renewing on schedule'; 'Coordinate open maintenance tickets end to end, from intake to vendor dispatch to close out'; 'Track vendor response time and flag delays before they become resident complaints' (Upwork jobs: property management VA [98]).
- The 2026 posts fold AI into the admin role ('use AI to draft replies', 'I'll provide the AI instructions (my voice, the questions to ask, fair housing rules, and when to hand off to me)') and a new 'AI agent / automation / voice bot' category pays $20-$60 an hour or $500 fixed, with one buyer saying 'I'm not looking for someone who only connects apps' (Upwork jobs: real estate ai chatbot [115]).
- UK buyers are almost absent: PeoplePerHour's 'estate agent' search returned 23 results of which three were property-related and none a lettings or progression admin post; the one UK-worded gig among 192 Upwork catalogue gigs read was 'property management VA for UK landlords and agents' from $25 with 35 feedback (PeoplePerHour jobs: estate agent [116]; Upwork services: property management [117]).

Table 2.4 Work bought on freelance boards, Aug-Oct 2026

Work bought on freelance boards (Aug-Oct 2026)	Price seen	Where	Source
Follow Up Boss automation build (sequences for buyer, seller, internet, open-house and unresponsive leads, "AI prompts for real estate follow-up")	$100 fixed	Upwork	Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]
ISA / lead backstop in Follow Up Boss	$5-$7/hour + $10 per appointment that shows; $7/hour for 5 hours a week	Upwork	Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]
CRM clean-up and upkeep (dedupe, tags, stages)	$7-$10/hour, 5 hours a week	Upwork	Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]
BoldTrail CRM and BackOffice implementation for a new brokerage, with training	$1,000 fixed	Upwork	Upwork jobs: kvcore [96]
Lofty landing pages (8 templates across 49 pages)	$2,300 fixed	Upwork	Upwork jobs: kvcore [96]
Follow Up Boss to dotloop and BoldTrail integration, including "reading a pdf in boldtrail to confirm completeness and accuracy"	$160 fixed	Upwork	Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]
Transaction coordinator	$3-$20/hour; $350 per closed file; $700-$1,500 a month; Expert tier $15-$20/hour	Upwork, OnlineJobs.ph, ProsMarketplace	Upwork jobs: transaction coordinator [97]; OnlineJobs.ph TC [107]
Property-management VA (maintenance tickets, renewals, tenant communication)	$5-$12/hour; $500-$1,000 a month; $12-$25/hour for a 10-12 unit landlord's bookkeeping-plus-PM assistant	Upwork, OnlineJobs.ph	Upwork jobs: property management VA [98]
Evictions support VA (notices, ledgers, timelines)	$6-$10/hour	Upwork	Upwork jobs: property management VA [98]
Skip tracing and list building	$3-$5/hour or per record; "500k skips/year" buyer; commercial owner research $15-$25/hour	Upwork, OnlineJobs.ph	Upwork jobs: skip tracing [118]; OnlineJobs.ph skip tracing [119]
Cold calling	$3-$6/hour plus $150-$300 per closed deal; 250-350 dials per shift on a three-line dialer	OnlineJobs.ph, Upwork	OnlineJobs.ph cold calling [114]; Upwork jobs: kvcore [96]
AI agent and automation expert ("not someone who only connects apps")	$30-$60/hour; GoHighLevel + CloseBot texting $20-$25/hour; Retell voice agent $500 fixed; Claude-API chatbot optimisation (NJ wholesaler)	Upwork	Upwork jobs: real estate ai chatbot [115]

Work bought on freelance boards (Aug-Oct 2026)	Price seen	Where	Source
Local SEO and "GEO/AEO" so a 1% listing brokerage appears in ChatGPT and AI Overviews	$35-$60/hour	Upwork	Upwork jobs: listing description [120]
UK lettings and PM admin (certificates, referencing, Right to Rent, deposits, maintenance chasing, landlord statements)	$4.50-$5/hour; $500-$1,050 a month; bookkeeper for a UK lettings company $5/hour	OnlineJobs.ph	OnlineJobs.ph UK property [108]
Upwork catalogue gigs: Follow Up Boss set-up	$30-$399, modal $50; top sellers 58-146 feedback	Upwork Project Catalog	Upwork services: follow up boss [121]
Upwork catalogue gigs: kvCORE / BoldTrail / Lofty set-up	$20-$175, modal $50; top sellers 85-140 feedback	Upwork Project Catalog	Upwork services: kvcore [122]
Upwork catalogue gigs: transaction coordinator	$20-$450; 15 of 24 unrated, the rest 1-11 feedback	Upwork Project Catalog	Upwork services: transaction coordinator [123]
Upwork catalogue gigs: listing description	$15-$40 (3 of 24 results are real estate; the rest e-commerce)	Upwork Project Catalog	Upwork services: listing description [124]
Upwork catalogue gigs: real estate AI chatbot	$20-$400, modal $50-$100; real-estate-named gigs have 5-10 feedback	Upwork Project Catalog	Upwork services: real estate chatbot [125]
Fiverr Follow Up Boss category	about 1,160 gigs; CRM set-up from $20; real estate VA gig with 195 orders and 55 reviews; UK real estate VA gig 4 reviews	Fiverr	Fiverr gigs: follow-up-boss [126] snippet; Fiverr UK gig [127] snippet
PeoplePerHour real-estate hourlies	3D floorplan $85 (21 sales); retouch 10 photos $20 (57 sales); "uK letting and Estate agents database 20,000" £200 (17 sales); FCA-compliant article £75; 100 calls $55	PeoplePerHour	PeoplePerHour real estate [128]
Vendor rate cards the gigs compete with	HireTalent.ph Follow Up Boss VAs $5-$9/hour (95 profiles); Stealth Agents FUB VA "starting at $15/hr"; MyOutDesk ISA "Up to 70% less than a local hire"	VA agencies	HireTalent.ph FUB [129]; Stealth Agents [130] vendor; MyOutDesk [131] vendor

How practitioners phrase their own searches (Google autocomplete, 11-12 October 2026)

Volumes are unknown; only the suggestion order was captured; question-type suggestions are marked PAA. The seeds below returned the most practitioner-specific tails.

Table 2.5 US seeds and suggestions, verbatim

US seed	Autocomplete suggestions (verbatim)
ai for real estate agents	ai for real estate agents free; ... course; ... reddit; ... 2026; ... book; ai for real estate agency; ai for real estate broker; best ai for real estate agents; ai tools for real estate agents
chatgpt for realtors	chatgpt for realtors free; chatgpt prompts for realtors; best chatgpt for realtors; chatgpt ads for realtors; claude vs chatgpt for realtors; claude or chatgpt for realtors; how to use chatgpt for realtors; what software do real estate agents use
chatgpt prompts for real estate	... pdf; ... agents; ... investors; ... lead generation; ... listing descriptions; ... pdf free download; ... marketing; chatgpt prompt for real estate analysis
ai listing description	ai listing description generator; ai listing description free; ai property description generator; ai property description writer; ai house listing description
ai receptionist real estate	ai receptionist for real estate agents; best ai receptionist for real estate agents; ai voice receptionist for real estate
ai for property managers	ai for property management companies; ai tools for property managers; ai agents for property managers; ai receptionist for property management; free ai for property management; ai assistant for property management
real estate lead follow up	real estate lead follow up system; ... sheet; ... schedule; ... scripts; ai lead follow up real estate
speed to lead	speed to lead real estate; speed to lead ai; speed to lead statistics; speed to lead automation
fair housing words to avoid	fair housing words to avoid pdf; fair housing terms to avoid; real estate fair housing words to avoid; fair housing act categories
follow up boss vs	follow up boss vs lofty; ... wise agent; ... go high level; ... boldtrail; ... cloze; ... hubspot; ... pipedrive; ... kvcore; ... brivity
kvcore vs	kvcore vs follow up boss; kvcore vs lofty; kvcore vs boldtrail; kvcore vs kw command; chime vs kvcore
best real estate crm	best real estate crm for single agent; best real estate crm 2026; best real estate crm reddit; best real estate crm software

US seed	Autocomplete suggestions (verbatim)
transaction coordinator checklist	... pdf; ... template excel; ... template; ... california; ... real estate; transaction coordinator duties; transaction coordinator duties real estate; free transaction coordinator checklist
transaction coordinator fee	transaction coordinator fee real estate; ... california; transaction management fee; what is a closing coordinator fee; transaction coordinator price list; transaction coordinator cost; average transaction coordinator fee; who pays the transaction coordinator fee; who pays the transaction coordinator fee in real estate
real estate virtual assistant	... jobs; ... jobs remote; ... salary; ... training; ... companies; ... tasks; ... job description; ... philippines; ... hiring
skip tracing real estate	... meaning; ... free; ... jobs; ... tools; ... software; ... leads; what is skip tracing in real estate wholesaling
property management bookkeeping	... software; ... in qbo; ... template; ... service
tenant screening / maintenance request software	tenant screening report; tenant screening services; tenant screening services for landlords; tenant screening background check; service request software; work request software; free maintenance request software
realtor burnout / realtor paperwork	realtor burnout reddit; is being a real estate agent stressful; realtor just for paperwork; what paperwork does a real estate agent do
No suggestions returned	is chatgpt fair housing compliant; ai fair housing compliant; how to automate lead follow up real estate; real estate admin overload; realtor overwhelmed; property manager overwhelmed; real estate lead response time; tenant chatbot

Table 2.6 UK seeds and suggestions, verbatim

UK seed	Autocomplete suggestions (verbatim)
estate agent ai	estate agent ai photos; estate agent ai tools; estate agent ai complaints; estate agent ai receptionist
ai for estate agents	ai for estate agents uk; ai for property agents; ai for estate agency; ai tools for estate agents; best ai for estate agents; ai receptionist for estate agents
chatgpt estate agent	chatgpt real estate agent; chatgpt real estate agent replacement; chatgpt for estate agents; chatgpt training for real estate agents; chatgpt prompts for real estate agents pdf
ai property management uk	ai property management software uk; best ai property management software uk
estate agent software	estate agent software uk; letting agent software; letting agent software uk; alto estate agent software; spectre estate agent software; street estate agent software; estate agent crm software
lettings software	lettings software uk; alto lettings software; street lettings software; lettings crm software; arthur lettings software
sales progression	sales progression jobs; sales progression company; sales progression fee; sales progression meaning; sales progression jobs remote; sales progression flow chart; sales progression manager jobs
sales progression estate agent	sales progression training for estate agents; outsourced sales progression for estate agents; estate agent sales progression checklist; estate agent sales progression jobs; estate agent sales progression software
chasing solicitors / how to speed up conveyancing	chasing solicitors when buying a house; chasing conveyancing solicitors; do you have to chase solicitors when buying a house; how to speed up conveyancing solicitors; how to speed up solicitors when buying a house; how to speed up sellers solicitors
sale fell through / estate agent fall through	sale fell through after exchange; sale falls through after exchange of contracts; sale fall through rightmove; house sale fell through; do you pay estate agent if sale falls through
material information	material information for estate agents; material information in property listings; material information flow chart; material information examples; material information checklist; material information part b; material information parts b & c; national trading standards material information for property listings
renters rights act checklist	renters rights act checklist for landlords; renters rights bill checklist; renters rights act 2026 checklist; renters rights act compliance checklist; renters rights bill landlord checklist
renters rights act compliance / agents	... checklist; ... fines; ... deadline; ... preparation; renters rights act compliant tenancy agreement; renters rights act agent fines; renters rights act agency workload; renters rights bill agency revenue; renters rights bill letting agents impact
renters rights act (topic tails)	renters rights act information sheet 2026; ... notice period; ... pets; ... rent increases; renters rights act section 8 ground 1a; ... ground 4a; renters rights act section 13 / form 4a; renters rights act awaab's law; renters rights act decent homes standard; renters rights act landlord ombudsman; renters rights act prs database
letting agent compliance / workload	letting agent compliance fee; letting agents compliance workload increase; estate agent compliance checks; estate agent compliance fee; letting agent enforcement order; letting agent aml compliance; letting agent legal requirements uk
aml checks estate agents / estate agent aml	aml checks estate agents cost; money laundering checks estate agents; what aml checks do estate agents do; hmrc aml checks for estate agents; estate agent aml fee; estate agent aml registration; estate agent aml policy; estate agent aml checks reddit; estate agency aml risk assessment
tenant referencing how long / failed	tenant referencing how long does it take; how long does tenant referencing take uk (PAA); how long does it take to reference a tenant (PAA); what happens if you fail tenant referencing; why would you fail tenant referencing; tenant referencing guarantor; tenant referencing self employed

UK seed	Autocomplete suggestions (verbatim)
right to rent check how long	how long does right to rent check take; how long does a right to rent check last; how do you do a right to rent check; right to rent share code
deposit deductions / section 8 notice / section 13 notice	deposit deductions for cleaning; deposit deductions uk; deposit deductions template; section 8 notice template; section 8 notice grounds; section 8 ground 8 notice period; section 13 notice to increase rent; section 13 notice form 4a
estate agent not responding / letting agent not responding	estate agent not responding to offer; ... to emails; ... to viewing request; ... maintenance issues; estate agent not answering calls; estate agent not communicating; letting agent not responding to emails; why are estate agents so slow
estate agent admin / lettings administrator	estate agent admin jobs; estate agent administrator; estate agent admin jobs remote; lettings administrator jobs; lettings administrator job description; lettings coordinator job description
No UK-specific suggestions returned	letting agent chatgpt; chatgpt property description uk; estate agent chatbot; letting agent automation; estate agent outsourcing; letting agent outsourcing; estate agent overwhelmed; rent arrears letting agent; landlord statement letting agent; estate agent lead follow up; reapit vs; alto vs

Sources: Google suggest, US locale [72] and UK locale [73]; listing coordinator job description [132]; fiverr real estate [133]; upwork real estate [134]. Buyers typing a marketplace name search for media first: 'fiverr real estate' suggests photo editing, video editing, leads, website, marketing and cold calling; 'upwork real estate' suggests virtual assistant, video editor, cold caller, photo editor, VA and transaction coordinator; 'fiverr realtor' returns nothing.

Three practical rules for targeting

- US buyers find operations help by typing a product name ('follow up boss', 'kvcore', 'appfolio', 'gohighlevel') or a role name ('transaction coordinator', 'ISA', 'maintenance coordinator'), not 'real estate', which on Upwork and Fiverr returns promo videos and logos; the long 'follow up boss vs' and 'transaction coordinator fee' tails are where the comparison happens because review counts on operations gigs are thin (1 to 146 feedback).
- UK buyers get almost nothing when they type their own words ('estate agent', 'lettings', 'rightmove') into Upwork, PeoplePerHour or OnlineJobs.ph; the demand that exists is served under US-style titles ('property management virtual assistant') or under compliance titles invented by the small firms themselves ('Compliance & Maintenance Coordinator', 'Property & Tenancy Coordinator'), so a UK offer must carry the statute and form names the searcher uses ('renters rights act compliance checklist', 'material information checklist', 'section 13 notice form 4a', 'right to rent share code', 'sales progression checklist', 'aml risk assessment').
- 'AI receptionist' is now a stable phrase on both sides while 'chatbot' phrasings barely register; the consumer-side complaint searches ('estate agent not answering calls', 'letting agent not responding to emails') describe the same gap from the other end (Google suggest, UK [73]; Upwork services: real estate [135]).

SECTION 3

Every line of business is a dated checklist run on someone else's clock

In all five lines of business the firm's controllable work sits at the start (instruction, onboarding, application, contract) and the end (completion, move-in, closing, statement); the middle is weeks of waiting on conveyancers, lenders, contractors, referencing providers, title companies and owners, during which the file must be chased, the deadline watched and the same data re-typed into the next system.

Step marks in the five workflow tables: **M** manual, **R** repetitive, **D** document-heavy, **T** deadline-driven. The marks are the researcher's reading of the sources, not a survey result.

Table 3.1 UK sales (independent agency)

UK sales (independent agency)	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Instruction	Market appraisal (22 per branch a month); written agency terms under the Estate Agents Act 1979; HMRC AML registration before trading, then customer due diligence on the seller (ID, address, beneficial ownership, title) with "the steps taken and the rationale for their conclusions" documented and an up-to-date written risk assessment (M, D)	11.2 new instructions per branch a month; 170 HMRC penalties on estate agencies in six months, 332 of 369 for trading unregistered	The Intermediary, 3 Sep 2025 [25]; Devonshires on HMRC guidance, 7 Oct 2026 [136]; Comsure [13]
Listing	Gather Material Information: Part A (price, council tax, tenure, ground rent, service charge) since July 2022, Parts B and C (utilities, parking, broadband, restrictions, flood risk, building safety) since 30 Nov 2023; no "price on application"; the NTSELAT guidance was withdrawn in 2025 and the DMCC Act applies from 6 April 2025 with no sector guidance (M, D); upload to portals, where some CRM feeds "batch once or twice a day" (R)	96.7% of agents feel underinformed, 46% still use withdrawn guidance, 40% "unsure what to do"; 1,125,158 price changes and 803,612 withdrawals in 2025	iamproperty [137]; Bebeez on Reapit survey, 13 Jun 2025 [138]; National Trading Standards [139]; ESRE Media [140] secondary
Viewings and offers	Viewings booked by phone (only 2 of 20 swept sites offer online booking); offer taken; buyer becomes a customer: ID, proof of address, proof and source of funds, enhanced due diligence for PEPs or high-risk cases; agent refuses to mark sold until the buyer is proceedable (M, D)	2.3 viewings per available property; 57.7% of 415,000+ source-of-funds checks had at least one red flag, averaging two	UK website sweep [141]; Propertymark proof of funds [142]; Property Industry Eye, 19 Mar 2026 [143] vendor data
Sales progression	Memorandum of sale; chase searches, mortgage offers, surveys, management packs, enquiries, the other agents in the chain; keep the seller updated (one of 20 swept sites offers a client progression portal) (M, R, T)	123 days sale agreed to exchange; conveyancers spend about 2 hours a day on agent chasers; 150-250 cases per progressor; 23.7% fall through, 38% within four weeks	Property Reporter, 15 Dec 2025 [14]; Conveyancing Matters [22]; Bartlams [144]; Property Industry Eye, 17 Apr 2026 [2]
Exchange and completion	Exchange; completion; invoice; fee paid only at completion (T)	154 days sale agreed to completion; £3,909 average fee; £3,550 cost per fall-through	Property Industry Eye, 31 Jul 2026 [1]; Property Industry Eye, 17 Mar 2026 [20]
Always	Redress-scheme membership (TPO or Property Redress) or £5,000 fine; client money protection; complaints procedure; records for five years; Material Information and AML policed by NTSELAT and HMRC	TPO 73,035 contacts (2024); Property Redress 4,220 enquiries (2025)	GOV.UK redress [145]; National Trading Standards [139]

Table 3.2 UK lettings and management

UK lettings and management	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Landlord onboarding	Written agent agreement stating whether it covers initial and follow-up Right to Rent checks ("Liability cannot be transferred beyond the appointed agent"); landlord ID; sanctions screening duty on landlords from instruction and on tenants once an offer is accepted (from 14 May 2025, no rent threshold); AML applies to lettings only at €10,000 a month or more; collect gas record (annual), EICR (five-yearly), EPC at E or better, smoke and CO alarms, HMO licence where five or more people in two households (M, D, T)	Right to Rent penalties up to £10,000 per occupier first breach, £20,000 repeat; EPC breach up to £5,000 per property; HMO licence up to five years	Home Office guide, 1 Oct 2026 [146]; OFSI guidance [147]; GOV.UK MEES [148]; GOV.UK HMO [149]
Marketing and enquiries	Advert must state a specific rent; no bidding or offers above the advertised rent; no refusal for children or benefits; enquiries from Rightmove flow into Alto in real time only since August 2026 ("rather than agents having to manage the information separately"); viewings booked by phone (R)	6 to 9 applicants per property; indicative fines: advert omitting rent £3,000, accepting above-advertised offers £4,000, discrimination £6,000	GOV.UK tenants overview [150]; Property Industry Eye, 5 Aug 2026 [151]; Anthony Collins, 17 Dec 2025 [152]
Application and referencing	Privacy notice and consent before any credit check (D); Right to Rent on every adult: manual check with original documents and the holder present in person or on live video, GOV.UK share code (9 characters, starts with R, 90 days), or a registered digital provider for British and Irish passports only; time-limited status checked within 28 days of the tenancy; Landlord Checking Service replies in two working days (M, D, T); referencing (credit, ID, open-banking or HMRC income, employer and landlord references, PEP and sanctions) at £5 to £40 per applicant paid by the landlord or agent; employer and landlord references labelled "manual verification" by the vendors (M, R); guarantor agreement in writing before the tenancy (D)	References "typically 24 to 72 hours"; NRLA/Goodlord about 26 hours average, one in three instant; Canopy 1.75 days; 41 applications per 1,000 flagged for suspected fraud, fake employment references up 226.6% in 2025	LetSafe UK [153]; Home Office guide [146]; NRLA referencing [154]; Canopy [155] vendor; Property Reporter, 7 Aug 2026 [12]
Signing and move-in	Written key terms with no end date (fixed terms banned; a Chesterfield agent was fined £8,652 for issuing a six-month term); no more than one month's rent before signing; holding deposit becomes the deposit and must be protected within 30 days with prescribed information (T); gas record before move-in; inventory with photos; one-off information sheet to every named tenant by 31 May 2026 (D)	Information sheet indicative penalty £4,000; attempting a fixed term £4,000; a 340-property agency had to deliver 340 PDFs by post or attachment	GOV.UK landlord guidance [156]; LandlordZONE, 2 Oct 2026 [157]; GOV.UK deposits [158]; Woking Borough Council [159]
During the tenancy	Rent collection and arrears chasing (R); non-resident landlord tax deducted and paid within 30 days of each quarter end, annual return by 5 July (T); repairs including out-of-hours, contractor sourcing, landlord approval (M, R); pet requests answered within 28 days with reasons (T); rent rise once a year on Form 4A with two months' notice, challengeable at tribunal (T); inspections; certificate renewals (annual gas, five-yearly EICR) (T); landlord statements (R, D)	22% of tenants expect to challenge rent increases; 93% of surveyed landlords had no pet request yet; councils can fine up to £7,000 for minor and £40,000 for serious breaches; Awaab's Law PRS consultation opened 9 Oct 2026 (social template: 24 hours to make safe, 10 working days to investigate)	GOV.UK NRL [160]; Goodlord SOLI 2025 [29] vendor; Property Industry Eye, 7 Oct 2026 [161]; Property Industry Eye, 28 Sep 2026 [162]; Property Industry Eye, 9 Oct 2026 [163]
Ending the tenancy	Tenant gives two months' notice on a rent day; landlord must use a Section 8 ground with the correct form and usually four months' notice (Section 21 gone from 1 May 2026; sale ground not within the first 12 months, 12-month no-relet period with £25,000 indicative penalty); check-out against the inventory; deposit returned within 10 days of agreement; dispute adjudication; utilities calls (D, T)	1% of deposits adjudicated; cleaning 54% and damage 49% of disputes; tenants now use ChatGPT to draft deposit challenges ("A well-written argument supported by incomplete information is still an incomplete argument")	GOV.UK tenants overview [150]; Anthony Collins [152]; NRLA, 22 Dec 2025 [40]; Property Industry Eye, 6 Jul 2026 [164]
Coming in late 2026 and after	PRS landlord database (registration numbers in adverts; £65 per property per year; gas and electrical certificates "fall outside digitisation plans, so landlords must scan and upload them manually"); PRS landlord ombudsman; EPC C target 2030; Decent Homes Standard and Awaab's Law extension (D, T)	Database from 15 Dec 2026 in the West Midlands, full registration by 14 Nov 2027; NRLA estimate £327m a year sector-wide	Property Industry Eye, 5 Oct 2026 [44]; GOV.UK guide to the Act [165]
Block management (rare at small independents)	Section 20 consultation when a leaseholder would pay over £250 for works or £100 a year for a long-term agreement; summaries and receipts on request (criminal offence to refuse); tribunal challenges (D, T)	Leasehold "among the most entrenched areas of complaint" at Property Redress	GOV.UK service charges [166]; Property Reporter, 3 Mar 2026 [39]

Table 3.3 US sales and contract-to-close (small brokerage, team, solo agent)

US sales and contract-to-close (small brokerage, team, solo agent)	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Lead to appointment	Capture consent for calls and texts with date and method recorded; honour revocations within 10 business days (from 11 April 2025); scrub the Do-Not-Call registry every 31 days; respond to the enquiry; qualify; book the showing (M, R, T)	48% of enquiries never answered (2013); 15-hour average response (2026, vendor); 86% of agents are independent contractors; 46% use a CRM; "Most deals require 5-12 touches, yet many agents stop after 2"	WAV Group 2013 [46]; HousingWire on FCC rules [167]; NAR telemarketing [168]; HousingWire, 28 May 2026 [169]
Buyer agreement and listing agreement	Since 17 Aug 2024 a written buyer agreement before any tour, in person or virtual, with compensation stated as an amount or rate, "objectively ascertainable" and not open-ended (D); listing agreement, seller disclosures, lead-paint forms; MLS entry within one business day of any public marketing, or a seller-signed delayed-marketing disclosure on a form each MLS must create (D, T)	Oklahoma's commission lists 31 forms including nine disclosure items and a Wire Fraud Advisory; the Uniform Contract of Sale is effective 1 Jan 2025	NAR Written Buyer Agreements 101 [170]; HGAR legal corner [171]; OREC contract forms [172]
Contract, days 1-3	Review the purchase agreement for price, contingencies, dates and signatures; enter the deal in dotloop or SkySlope; intro email to buyer, seller, both agents, title and lender; verify the earnest-money amount, due date and delivery; get the receipt from title on day 2-3; order title; send the contract to the lender; add every deadline to a shared calendar; request HOA documents; send seller disclosures (M, D, T; "everything in this phase should be wrapped up within 72 hours")	20-30 dates per contract; "Re-entering personal and entity information on every contract"; "Starting from scratch with document packets on every deal"	Serif TC checklist [173] vendor; Process Street [174]; BiggerPockets post 7250481 [49] user, 2026
Inspection, days 3-12	Schedule inspection; reminder 48 hours before the deadline; log the report; track the buyer's election (proceed, repairs, terminate); draft and sign the repair addendum; order a home warranty (D, T)	"inspection deadlines that weren't properly calendared" have killed deals; missed option-period and EMD release deadlines are "the biggest bleed"	Serif [173] vendor; BiggerPockets post 7250481 [49] user
Appraisal and loan, days 12-25	Confirm the lender ordered the appraisal; coordinate access; log the report; if low, document the options; conditional approval by day 18-20; track lender conditions; insurance binder and title commitment by day 20; HOA estoppel (T)	6% of contracts delayed by appraisal issues; 14% delayed overall; lender close 43 days average	Serif [173] vendor; NAR RCI [45]; GoBankingRates [53] secondary
Clear to close, days 25-33	Written clear-to-close; Closing Disclosure three days before closing with buyer acknowledgment; walkthrough 2-3 days before; confirm wire instructions "by direct call" three days before; cash-to-close; commission instructions and splits by day 30 (M, T)	"Never send wire instructions ... via e-mail"; 58% of wire-fraud victims said the fraudulent message appeared to come from their agent	Serif [173] vendor; NAR wire fraud [175]; Realty News Report, 6 Feb 2025 [176] vendor survey
Closing and after, days 33-45	Confirm deed recording; commission disbursement; collect and file all closing documents within 48 hours; send the executed package; update the CRM; request a review within 72 hours; archive per retention policy (D, R)	30 days median close; 5-7% terminated; about 45 tasks and 20 named documents per sale (counted from the checklists)	Serif [173] vendor; NAR RCI Dec 2025 [5]
Always	Fair Housing Act wording in every listing and ad; E&O insurance ($708-936 a year) that may not cover "technology failures or unregulated AI tools"; 30 hours of continuing education per cycle in Oklahoma; trust-account rules for any broker holding deposits	Defence costs $10,000-25,000 "even when the agent wins"	Pearl Insurance, 5 Jun 2026 [177]; CO Advisors, 20 Sep 2026 [178] secondary; OREC CE [179]

Table 3.4 US property management (50-1,500 units)

US property management (50-1,500 units)	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Owner onboarding and marketing	Management agreement with repair-approval threshold; setup fee; trust account per state board rules (deposit within one to two banking days; monthly three-way reconciliation; broker of record liable); listing on 50+ sites; showings by a licensed agent booked by phone at most firms (4 of 30 swept sites book online) (M, D)	Setup $100-300; owner thresholds "typically $500-$1,000 and often not honored"; Texas and Washington keep records four and three years	Hemlane trust rules [180]; iPropertyManagement fees [59] secondary; BiggerPockets 1302698 [181] user, Oct 2026; US website sweep [182]

US property management (50-1,500 units)	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Application and screening	Written screening criteria where the state requires it; application fee (capped at $20 in New York, $50 in New Jersey from 1 May 2026, banned in Vermont and for Massachusetts landlords); applicant consents and authenticates identity with TransUnion or Experian; same-day credit, criminal and eviction report at $17-$49 (some records restricted by state and local law); income proof by pay stubs, bank link, payroll data or document forensics; employer and landlord calls on an independently found number; FCRA adverse-action notice for any denial, co-signer demand, higher deposit or higher rent (M, D, T)	Staff spend most screening time verifying bank statements (72%) and pay stubs (67%) by hand; 6.4% of applications fraudulent (multifamily data); one Birmingham manager takes "up to 7 business days" through an outside agency, another "a minimum of 48 hours"	FTC landlord guide [183]; TenantCloud state guide [184] secondary; SmartMove pricing [185] vendor; NAR Commercial Insights, 2022 [186]; Signal PM [187]; Continental Realty Management [188]
Lease, move-in, rent	Lease signed (e-signature inside AppFolio or Rentvine; no swept site markets it); move-in inspection; rent by portal, third-party link or "local locations" for cash; late and partial payments (accepting a partial payment can invalidate a Florida notice) (R, T)	On-time 83.2%, late 12.1%; "Always, a few days before rent is due I get a maintenance request"	Chandan [61] vendor data; Renters Place [189]; BiggerPockets 1303024 [190] user; BiggerPockets post 4948626 [191] user, 2020
Maintenance	Request arrives by text, call, email or app; triage (emergency or not, often by photo); owner approval above threshold; vendor dispatch with a not-to-exceed; follow-up; completion confirmation; invoice matched to the original request and approved work; tenant told the next step (M, R)	"3-5 work orders per unit per year" vendor, unsourced; "maintenance coordination consumes 35-45% of staff time" vendor, attribution unverified; "Verbal NTEs are where invoice disputes start"; "'Vendor says it's done' is not the same thing as closed"	My AI Front Desk [192] vendor, snippet; US Tech Automations [193] vendor, snippet; BiggerPockets 1302900 [194]; BiggerPockets 1303197 [9] user, Oct 2026
Inspections, renewals, insurance	Periodic or drive-by inspections (every 60-90 days at one Little Rock firm; $50-$150 per inspection where charged); renewal offers; renter's insurance and vendor certificates of insurance tracked by expiry date (R, T)	COI documents are the hardest records because "certificates expire on different dates" and "nobody notices until a claim or an audit"	Little Rock PM blog [195] secondary; iPropertyManagement Birmingham [196]; BiggerPockets 1303196 [197] user
Move-out and deposit	Notice to vacate (PDF download at some firms); move-out inspection with photos; itemised deductions ("Not a general deduction. Not an estimate."); return within the state window (14 days Nebraska and Tennessee, 21 Idaho and California, 30 most states, 45 Oklahoma, 60 Alabama and Kentucky), with penalties up to 3x in Texas (D, T)	Cleaning is the biggest dispute source; a flat "$250 cleaning fee" with no backup gets challenged	NomadLease [198] secondary; BiggerPockets 1302755 [199] user, Oct 2026
Owner statements and money	Monthly owner statement and distribution; vendor payments; trust reconciliation; 1099-MISC to each owner for rent over $2,000 and 1099-NEC to contractors by 31 January (R, D, T)	AppFolio's "3-5 day window for processing owner/vendor payments" is "the biggest complaint"; "$3,200 vendor payment entered against the wrong property" leaves the bank reconciled but the owner statement wrong	IRS 1099 instructions [200]; Software Connect AppFolio [201] secondary; WPM Accounting [202]
Eviction	Nonpayment notice (3 days Kansas and New Mexico, 5 Oklahoma and South Carolina, 7 Nebraska and Kentucky, 14 Washington); filing; hearing; writ (D, T)	$3,500 average; 7-16 weeks; "Wrong rent figures on notices are the most common reason people restart the clock" (California)	iPropertyManagement eviction [203] secondary; Snappt [62] vendor, secondary; BiggerPockets 1305755 [204] user
Licensing	A real-estate licence is required to manage for others in 15 of 16 target states (Idaho excepted; Kansas only for non-residential); property managers subject to Fair Housing, FCRA, source-of-income laws in 21 jurisdictions and local ordinances (Albuquerque yes, Lexington and Boise pre-empted)		TenantCloud licensing [205] secondary; PRRAC Appendix B, Mar 2026 [206]

Table 3.5 Investors and wholesalers

Investors and wholesalers	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
List building	Pull absentee-owner, pre-foreclosure, tax-lien and code-violation lists from county sites and aggregators; match court filings to the right property and owner ("Court filings often carry an old owner name, a missing unit number or a typo in the address"); export to a CRM (M, R)	Absentee lists go stale "because properties sold, owners died, or tax mailing addresses point to the property itself"	BiggerPockets 1302525 [207] user, Oct 2026; BiggerPockets 1301774 [208] user, Sep 2026; Goliath Data [209] vendor

Investors and wholesalers	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Skip trace and scrub	Batch skip trace for phone numbers; scrub against the national Do-Not-Call registry every 31 days and state call-time rules; rotate caller IDs to avoid spam flags (R, T)	About 70% of numbers "disconnected or unused"; DNC scrubbing removed "about half"; "Skip tracing dead names is the most expensive part of lead gen"	BiggerPockets 1259450 [66]; BiggerPockets 1302811 [210]; BiggerPockets 1301774 [208] user
Outbound and follow-up	Cold calls and texts (manual dialling allowed; auto-dialers, prerecorded or AI voice and ringless voicemail need express written consent); follow-up over four or five touches; log consent provenance per lead (R, T)	"after 1,000+ dials, two sellers in follow-up"; "The people I do get on the phone are tired of wholesalers"; TCPA penalties $500-$1,500 per violation; a part-time wholesaler calls 6pm-8pm weekdays and four hours a day at weekends	BiggerPockets 1286268 [65] user, 2026; BAM on TCPA [211] secondary; Lofty TCPA page [212] vendor
Offer, contract, exit	Comps and after-repair value (no primary source reached); contract; assignment or double close through a title company willing to close assignments; Oklahoma requires a "Notice of Homeowner's Cancellation of Wholesale Real Estate Purchase Contract" (D)	Advertising a property you do not own is described as legally "shady"	BatchLeads [213] vendor; OREC contract forms [172]
Small landlord and investor bookkeeping	Separate trust and operating money from day one; categorise receipts weekly; keep vendor and supply receipts; itemise deposits per property (R, D)	A client mixed personal truck repairs with rental maintenance for three years and was "afraid to show their books to their CPA"; "Buying software won't fix missing details"	BiggerPockets 1303225 [214] user, Oct 2026; BiggerPockets 1302698 [181] user

Two patterns across the five tables

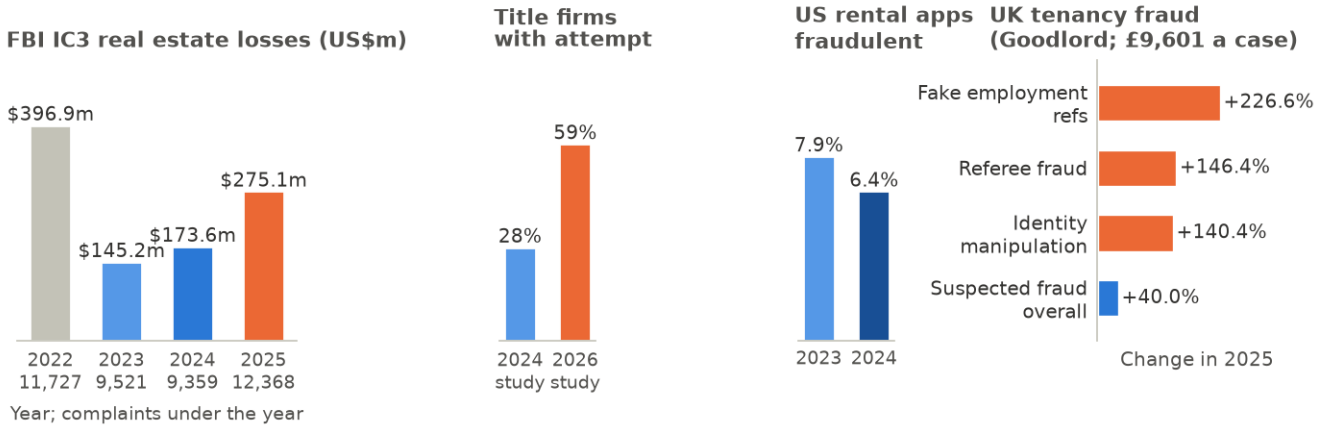
- The document-heavy steps cluster at the gates the law has added recently: Material Information before a UK listing (2022-23), the written buyer agreement before a US tour (August 2024), the written statement of terms and the information sheet under the Renters' Rights Act (May 2026), the FCC revocation rules (April 2025) and the delayed-marketing form (2025). Each is a new piece of paper that must exist before a step the firm used to take informally.
- The deadline-driven steps are short and state- or scheme-specific (30-day deposit protection, 28-day pet response, 14 to 60-day deposit returns, 3 to 20-day eviction notices, the 72-hour contract set-up window, the three-day Closing Disclosure rule, the 31-day DNC scrub, 31 January 1099s), which is why practitioners describe the failure not as ignorance of the rule but as 'No follow-up date means it falls through the cracks' (BiggerPockets 1302426 [215] user, Oct 2026) and 'A reminder being sent is not the same as the work being completed' (Property Industry Eye, 28 Sep 2026 [162] vendor comment).

SECTION 4

Fraud losses doubled, fines land on the unregistered, and AI rules apply to the output, not the tool

Fraud is the cost line that grew fastest between 2023 and 2026, and it lands on the smallest operators because they hold the email account, the deposit and the ID copy; the compliance penalties small UK agencies actually pay are for not registering, not for complex laundering; and in both countries the AI rules bite on the output and the records, not the tool.

Fraud: FBI real estate losses rose to $275.1m in 2025, seller-impersonation attempts hit 59% of title firms, 6.4% of US rental applications were fraudulent, and UK tenancy fraud rose 40% at £9,601 per case



Sources: FBI IC3 2025 [10] and 2024 [216] annual reports; ALTA 2024 [228] (783 firms) and 2026 [11] (245 firms) studies; Snappt via Multifamily Executive [222] (vendor data, about 5m documents); Goodlord via Property Reporter, 7 Aug 2026 [12] (vendor data, 1m+ references).

US: wire fraud, seller impersonation, application fraud

- The FBI's 'Real Estate' crime type recorded **12,368 complaints and $275.1m of losses in 2025**, up from $173.6m (2024) and $145.2m (2023), with victims over 60 losing $123.7m; business email compromise across all sectors cost $3.05bn; the new 'AI Related' tag counted 115 real estate complaints ($2.7m) and $30.3m of AI-assisted BEC; 'Chat generators can quickly create official-sounding emails' (FBI IC3 2025 [10]; FBI IC3 2024 [216]). The category is not just wire fraud, so the derived average of about **$22,200 per complaint** blends closing-fund theft with rental listing scams.
- CertifID's consumer survey: more than one in four consumers were targeted in a transaction, nearly one in 20 victimised, only 47% were warned by their real estate professional, **58% of victims said the fraudulent message appeared to come from their agent** (Realty News Report, 6 Feb 2025 [176] vendor survey); its 2026 edition: 22% of homebuyers receive fraudulent communications and 60% of title professionals say fraud is increasing (CertifID [217] vendor).
- Seller impersonation moved from rare to routine: ALTA's spring 2026 study of 245 title firms found **59% had at least one attempt in the prior year (28% in 2024), 45% in the prior month, 23% three or more in a month**; one in four firms with an attempt paid a claim and 'half reported costs above $100,000'; targets were vacant land (82%), absentee-owned (72%), free-and-clear (68%) and recently deceased owners (55%); 87% saw spoofed contact information; 58% rated deepfake image or voice at least somewhat common; **87% of catches happened in clearance or curative review**, not at first contact (ALTA 2026 study [11]; HousingWire, 14 Sep 2026 [218]).
- A Maryland vacant-land sale of about $100,000 was nearly completed by someone using AI to impersonate the owner on a live remote-notarisation video; one title agent covered a $1m loss personally (HousingWire, 10 Apr 2026 [219]). NAR's deed-fraud survey: 63% of association staff aware of such fraud in their market, 52% of cases on residential land, 12% on owner-occupied homes (NAR [220]); CertifID puts the median seller-net-proceeds loss at $343,497 and lists 'a new lead from an online portal or lead service with no prior relationship' and 'requests a remote notary or refuses an in-person closing' as red flags (CertifID [221] vendor).

- Tenant application fraud: Snappt's analysis of nearly 5 million documents found **6.4% of US rental applications fraudulent in 2024** (7.9% in 2023), over 80,000 manipulated documents, methods 'fraudulent PDF creators', 'text insertion' and 'font fail' (Multifamily Executive, 6 Feb 2025 [222] vendor data, multifamily); institutional managers say 85% have been targeted (66% pre-pandemic) and staff spend most screening time verifying bank statements (72%) and pay stubs (67%) by hand (NAR Commercial Insights, 26 Sep 2022 [186]); 75% of property managers reported more rental fraud last year (Buildium 2026 [60] vendor).

UK: AI-built tenant identities, rental scams, title fraud, document handling

- Goodlord's million-plus references: **41 applications per 1,000 flagged for suspected fraud** (peak 46.6 in late 2024), suspected fraud up almost 40% across 2025, **fake employment references up 226.6%, referee fraud up 146.4%, identity manipulation up 140.4%**, an average direct cost of **£9,601 per fraudulent tenancy**, London at nearly double the national rate, fraudsters who 'use AI to build entire false identities' (Property Reporter, 7 Aug 2026 [12] vendor data).
- Rental scams reported to Action Fraud fell to 4,092 in FY2025/26 (from 4,982) while the average loss rose 46% to **£3,138** and the total to **£12.84m** (Property Reporter, 17 Aug 2026 [223]); HM Land Registry stopped 86 fraudulent applications against more than £59m of property in 2024-25 and paid four indemnity claims totalling £398,964 (HM Land Registry, 17 Sep 2025 [224]).
- The documented UK breaches are about third parties and document handling: the CTS managed-service attack of November 2023 delayed sales nationally with 'no precise timeline for full restoration' (Intelligent CIO, 27 Nov 2023 [225]); a London letting agent was fined £80,000 after a file-transfer set-up left tenants' and landlords' bank statements, passport copies and salary details open online for about two years (Mortgage Solutions, 22 Jul 2019 [226] snippet). Across UK small businesses generally, 42% identified phishing, only 17% hold a specific cyber policy and 40% use two-factor authentication (Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025 [227]).

Table 4.1 Fraud measures

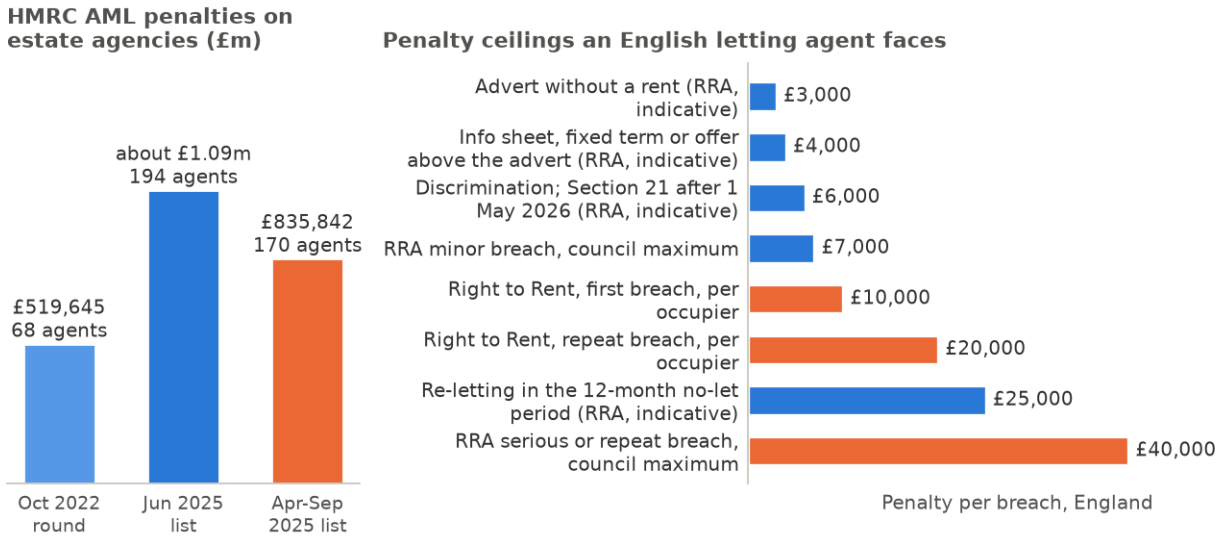
Fraud measure	Figure	Population and date	Source
FBI real estate fraud	2022: 11,727 complaints, $396.9m; 2023: 9,521, $145.2m; 2024: 9,359, $173.6m; 2025: 12,368, $275.1m; over-60 victims 2025: 2,473, $123.7m	IC3 annual reports	IC3 2025 [10]; IC3 2024 [216]
BEC and AI tag	BEC 2025: 24,768 complaints, $3.05bn; "AI Related" 22,364 complaints, $893m; AI real estate 115, $2.7m; AI BEC $30.3m	IC3 2025	IC3 2025 [10]
Consumer wire-fraud exposure	1 in 4 targeted, 1 in 20 victimised; 47% warned by their agent; 58% of fraud appeared to come from the agent; first-time buyers 3x; 27% recovered less than half	CertifID 2025	Realty News Report [176] vendor survey
Seller impersonation	28% (2023) to 59% (2025) of title firms with an attempt; 45% in prior month; 1 in 4 paid a claim; half over $100,000; 85% of 2023 attempts on vacant land; 87% caught in curative review; 5.3 tools on average	ALTA 2024 (783 firms) and 2026 (245 firms)	ALTA 2024 [228]; ALTA 2026 [11]
US tenant application fraud	6.4% of applications (2024), 7.9% (2023); 80,000+ manipulated documents; highest metros Memphis 14.4%, Atlanta 12.2%, Houston 10.9%; 3.6% outside the worst twenty metros	Snappt, about 5m documents	Multifamily Executive [222] vendor data; Snappt, 6 Jan 2026 [229] vendor
UK tenancy fraud	41 per 1,000 flagged; +40% in 2025; £9,601 per fraudulent tenancy; exposure up to £4.1bn; homes over £10,000 a month 18 per 1,000 confirmed	Goodlord, 1m+ references	Property Reporter, 7 Aug 2026 [12] vendor data
UK rental scams (victims)	FY2023/24 4,982 reports, £2,156 average, £10.74m; FY2025/26 4,092 reports, £3,138 average, £12.84m	Action Fraud FOI via Just Landlords	Property Reporter, 17 Aug 2026 [223] secondary
UK title fraud	86 of 4.43m applications fraudulent (2024-25); £59m of property protected; 4 indemnity payments £398,964; 300+ properties worth £194m since 2020	HM Land Registry	HMLR blog, 17 Sep 2025 [224]
UK breach cost and practice	43% of businesses had a breach; phishing in 85% of those; average cost £1,600 (£3,550 excluding zero-cost); 17% of small firms hold a specific cyber policy; 40% use two-factor	DCMS survey 2025, all sectors	GOV.UK [227]

The penalties small UK agencies actually pay

- HMRC's list for 1 April to 30 September 2025: **170 penalties on estate agency businesses totalling £835,842** (about £4,900 each), the largest group of any sector; **332 of the 369 penalties across all sectors were for trading without AML registration**, 'an avoidable administrative failure, not a complex due-diligence issue' (Comsure [13]; Pie Tax [230] secondary). The June 2025 list fined 194 agents about £1.09m (Estate Agent Today, Jun 2025 [231] snippet); the October 2022 round fined 68 agents £519,645, the largest single fine (£53,400, Horton) for failing to apply for registration, plus the first prosecution of an unregistered agent (Property Industry Eye, 12 Oct 2022 [232]; GOV.UK [233]).

- HMRC's updated guidance of 8 July 2026 (Money Laundering Regulations amendments in force 30 June 2026) requires CDD on all parties, source-of-funds work that documents 'both the steps taken and the rationale for their conclusions', an 'up-to-date written risk assessment' covering money laundering, terrorist financing and proliferation financing, extra care with cash buyers, and says that with third-party ID tools 'responsibility for compliance with the MLRs remains with the estate agency business' and providers not on the DVS register 'cannot be relied upon' (Devonshires, 7 Oct 2026 [136]).
- Propertymark's members, mostly single-branch, called the AML fee rise (premises fee £300 to £400 plus a new £400 application fee) unreasonable (92%), said 'Letting agents cannot recover compliance costs through tenant fees', and **96% want more prescriptive guidance, especially on 'how to identify beneficial owners' and 'sources of funds'** (Propertymark, 15 Sep 2025 [43]).
- A vendor's 415,000-plus source-of-funds checks found **57.7% of cases had at least one red flag, averaging two per report** (Property Industry Eye, 19 Mar 2026 [143] vendor data); a Credas survey of 250 agents found 79% use digital ID verification but **64% 'still rely on manual document checks to some extent'**, 63% pass ID-check fees to clients, and small independents spend about £16,000 a year on compliance-related activity (Property Reporter, 23 Jul 2025 [234] vendor survey). Even asking for ID before a viewing is contested: 'This has "GDPR breach" written all over it' (Property Industry Eye, 12 May 2026 [235] user, May 2026).
- **Right to Rent** carries the largest single penalty an English letting agent can face: since February 2024 **up to £10,000 per occupier for a first breach and £20,000 for a repeat** (lodgers £5,000 and £10,000); agent fines in Q1 2024 alone (£165,680) exceeded the whole of 2023; checks rose 577% year on year; since October 2022 documents 'can no longer be accepted by email' (Landlord Today, 29 May 2024 [236]; GOV.UK penalties [237]). The Home Office guide updated 1 October 2026 allows three routes (manual check with original documents and the holder present in person or on live video; the online service with a share code; a registered digital provider for British and Irish passport holders only), mandates registered providers for digital checks from that date, and states the landlord 'remains responsible for ensuring that the check is carried out in accordance with the prescribed requirements' (Home Office guide, 1 Oct 2026 [146]); a certified provider 'does not remove all risk' and the cost cannot be passed to applicants under the Tenant Fees Act 2019 (Propertymark, 14 Jul 2022 [238]).
- **The Renters' Rights Act 2025** (Royal Assent 27 October 2025, Phase 1 in force **1 May 2026**) rewrote the lettings calendar: every assured shorthold tenancy became periodic, no end dates, Section 21 gone, rent rises once a year on Form 4A with two months' notice, adverts must state a rent and no offer above it may be accepted, no more than one month's rent in advance, no refusal of applicants with children or on benefits, pet requests answered within 28 days, the exact GOV.UK information sheet to every tenant by 31 May 2026, and councils may fine **up to £7,000 for minor and £40,000 for serious or repeat breaches** with rent repayment orders of up to two years' rent; council investigatory powers, including 'entering a letting business without notice', started 27 December 2025; the PRS database and landlord ombudsman follow in late 2026 (GOV.UK landlord guidance [156]; GOV.UK tenants overview [150]; Woking Borough Council [159]; Anthony Collins, 17 Dec 2025 [152]).
- The first enforcement case against an agent came within five months: a Chesterfield letting agent was fined £8,652 for issuing a banned six-month fixed term and telling the tenants to leave (LandlordZONE, 2 Oct 2026 [157]). A large agency's four-month review: the one-month advance cap 'has been difficult for international students', two-month tenant notices create overlapping tenancies of 'five or six weeks', 'Some tenants believe they are automatically entitled to have a pet', and 'advertised rents don't always reflect the final agreed rent' (LandlordZONE, 25 Sep 2026 [42]); councils have warned that 'outsourcing the job doesn't automatically mean you've outsourced the risk' (Property Industry Eye, 28 Sep 2026 [162]).

HMRC fined 170 estate agencies £835,842 in six months, mostly for never registering (332 of 369 penalties across all sectors); the Renters' Rights Act and Right to Rent add penalties of £3,000 to £40,000 per breach



Sources: Comsure on HMRC list Apr-Sep 2025 [13]; Estate Agent Today, Jun 2025 [231] (snippet); Property Industry Eye, 12 Oct 2022 [232]; GOV.UK Right to Rent penalties [237]; Anthony Collins, 17 Dec 2025 [152] (indicative schedule; Act text not read, see section 11); Landlord Today, 29 May 2024 [236]: agent fines for Right to Rent in Q1 2024 alone (£165,680) exceeded the whole of 2023.

Table 4.2 UK penalties and duties

UK penalty or duty	Amount or rule	Date	Source
HMRC AML, unregistered or non-compliant	170 estate-agency penalties, £835,842 (Apr-Sep 2025); 332 of 369 for unregistered trading; 194 agents about £1.09m (Jun 2025 list); 68 agents £519,645 (2022), largest £53,400; prosecution possible	2022-2026	Comsure [13]; Property Industry Eye, 12 Oct 2022 [232]
HMRC AML duties	CDD on all parties; documented source-of-funds rationale; written risk assessment; DVS-register providers only; reliance does not reduce responsibility	Guidance 8 Jul 2026	Devonshires [136]
Right to Rent	£5,000/£10,000 per lodger, £10,000/£20,000 per occupier; up to 5 years' prison for knowing breaches; registered digital providers only from 1 Oct 2026; manual check needs original documents and the holder present	Feb 2024; Oct 2026	GOV.UK penalties [237]; Home Office guide [146]
Renters' Rights Act civil penalties	Up to £7,000 minor, £40,000 serious or repeat; indicative: information sheet £4,000, no written statement £4,000, discrimination £6,000, advert without rent £3,000, accepting above-advertised offers £4,000, fixed term £4,000, Section 21 after 1 May 2026 £6,000, re-letting in the 12-month no-let period £25,000; rent repayment orders up to 24 months	From 1 May 2026	Anthony Collins [152]; GOV.UK guide [165]
Financial sanctions	Letting agents must report to OFSI when they know or suspect a designated person, from 14 May 2025, no rent threshold	2025	OFSI guidance [147]
Redress and client money	Redress membership or up to £5,000 fine; Tenant Fees Act penalties and CMP enforcement by Bristol City Council; prohibition orders by Powys	Ongoing	GOV.UK redress [145]; National Trading Standards [139]
Material Information and DMCC Act	NTSELAT Parts A (2022), B and C (2023) withdrawn in 2025; DMCC Act from 6 Apr 2025 with fines up to £300,000 or 10% of turnover; no CMA sector guidance; MHCLG "sales packs" announced Jun 2026	2025-26	Bebeez on Reapit survey [138] secondary; National Trading Standards MI page [239]
Data protection	ICO £80,000 fine on a letting agent for exposed tenant and landlord documents (pre-GDPR regime)	2019	Mortgage Solutions [226] snippet
Scotland and Wales	Scottish Letting Agent Register and Code of Practice, unregistered work up to £50,000 fine and six months' prison; Rent Smart Wales licence and training	Ongoing	mygov.scot [240]; Rent Smart Wales [241]

Material Information: a legal vacuum that worries agents more than any AI rule

- The Property Lawyers Alliance told the CMA that full compliance 'poses a significant burden for agents', that agents should not become 'quasi-lawyers' and that the regime is 'a fertile breeding ground for misrepresentation and other civil claims'; agents agreed that 'most will not have the legal knowledge to complete some of the Material Information' and that vendors 'have forgotten the answers to many the "additional enquiries"' (Property Industry Eye, 23 Jan 2025 [242] user, Jan 2025). The government consulted on new guidance from 6 October to 29 December 2025, noting that problems such as damp or missing planning permission 'only emerge after their offer has been accepted' (GOV.UK consultation [243]).
- On AI-edited photos, National Trading Standards is reported to say deceptive edits may breach the Consumer Protection from Unfair Trading Regulations 2008 and the DMCC Act, that 'clear labelling is the bare minimum', and Rightmove removed virtually staged images from an Eaglescliffe listing even though the staging was disclosed (The Negotiator [244] snippet).
- Agents' recorded views of AI are sceptical and cost-focused: 'AI is a useful took for work, but nothing revolutionary', 'I'd much rather have competent staff than an AI tool (as would my clients)' (Property Industry Eye, 8 Sep 2026 [245] user, Sep 2026); 'Most agents are still paying for tools and time that AI now does for free' (Property Industry Eye, 29 May 2026 [246]); the one AI item Propertymark lists is a course on 'Managing AI-generated complaints' dated 2 November 2026 (Propertymark course [247]). Alto's survey says 52% of agents plan to adopt AI within 12 months and 66% expect to rely on compliance and AML automation, with about a third nervous or unsure, most often independents (Property Industry Eye, 16 Jan 2026 [248] vendor survey).

US: no single AI rule; existing law applied to AI output

- NAR's March 2026 guidance lists the risks every brokerage policy should cover: hallucination ('wrong square footage or invented property features'), fair-housing drift ('who a home is "perfect for"'), privacy ('Entering client, financial, or transaction information into an unapproved tool could expose that data'), and the rule that AI content 'should not go straight from prompt to publication' (NAR, 24 Mar 2026 [249]).
- The fair-housing checklist for AI-written remarks flags 'perfect for young professionals', 'ideal for families', 'quiet neighborhood', 'walking distance to church', 'safe' and 'exclusive', but cites no enforcement action tied to AI copy (HousingWire, 15 May 2026 [250]); the risk is real because **75% of AI-using agents write listing descriptions with it** and 23% use AI daily (NAR Technology Survey 2026 [251]); a thread titled 'Our house got AI-ed' drew nearly 900 upvotes (The AI Career Lab, 5 Jul 2026 [252] secondary).
- HUD's May 2024 guidance applies the Fair Housing Act to AI tenant screening and ad targeting and says providers 'may remain liable even when they have outsourced screening to a third-party screening company' (HousingWire, 2 May 2024 [253]; Orrick, 10 May 2024 [254]); the SafeRent settlement (about $2.3m, final approval 20 Nov 2024) bars scores and accept-or-deny recommendations for voucher holders for five years (Cohen Milstein [255]); the RealPage litigation ended in a November 2025 DOJ settlement banning real-time competitor data, plus city and state bans on rent-setting software and more than 40 bills in 22 states (Propmodo, 22 Feb 2026 [256]).
- Photo rules are fragmenting by MLS and state: NorthstarMLS proposes labels plus an unaltered 'Before' image for every altered room; CRMLS requires the original next to the enhanced image, SmartMLS a watermark, MRED bans removing power lines (NorthstarMLS [257]; The Close [258] snippet); California AB 723 (effective 1 January 2026) requires a conspicuous disclosure and access to the unaltered original by website or QR code (The Close, 25 Jun 2026 [259]).
- Calling and texting: the FCC and NAR treat AI voices including 'voice cloning' as 'artificial or prerecorded voice' under the TCPA; the Do-Not-Call registry must be checked every 31 days; consent revocations honoured within 10 business days from 11 April 2025; the one-to-one consent rule was vacated by the Eleventh Circuit on 24 January 2025 although NAR's standing page still says it 'took effect', a contradiction to check against the FCC record (NAR TCPA one-sheet, 17 Mar 2025 [260]; NAR telemarketing [168]; HousingWire [167]); penalties run $500 to $1,500 per violation with a four-year limitation period (BAM [211] secondary).
- Colorado's SB24-205 imposes deployer duties for high-risk AI from 1 February 2026 (Colorado General Assembly [261]); the FTC's 2024 rule bans fake reviews 'including AI-generated ones' (FTC [262]); an E&O insurer calls AI 'a grey area within most E&O policies' where 'E&O policies might not cover technology failures or unregulated AI tools' (Pearl Insurance, 5 Jun 2026 [177]).

Table 4.3 AI and data rules and what they require of a small firm

AI or data rule	Jurisdiction and date	What it requires of a small firm	Source
NAR brokerage AI policy guidance	US, 24 Mar 2026	Human review before listing content, client communications, marketing, transaction documents and valuations leave the office; no client or transaction data in unapproved tools	NAR [249]; Paperless Agent [263] snippet
HUD fair housing and AI	US, 29 Apr / 2 May 2024	Screening models must give every applicant an equal chance; ad targeting must not deter or steer; liability survives outsourcing; current status after 2025 not verified	HousingWire [253]; Orrick [254]
Algorithmic screening and pricing cases	US, 2024-25	SafeRent: no scores for voucher holders (5 years); RealPage: no real-time competitor data, 12-month-old training data, bans in several cities and New York	Cohen Milstein [255]; Propmodo [256]
MLS and state photo rules	Various MLSs; California from 1 Jan 2026; Wisconsin reported	Label AI-altered images; keep and give access to originals; some MLSs fine for undisclosed staging secondary	NorthstarMLS [257]; The Close [259]
TCPA and FCC rules	US, 2025	AI voice = artificial voice; written consent for auto-dialers, AI or prerecorded calls and texts; DNC every 31 days; revocations honoured within 10 business days; one-to-one rule vacated 24 Jan 2025; state mini-TCPA laws (Florida, Oklahoma, Washington)	NAR one-sheet [260]; HousingWire [167]; EZ Texting [264] vendor, snippet
Colorado AI Act	Colorado, from 1 Feb 2026	Risk-management programme, impact assessments, consumer notice and appeal for high-risk AI decisions; disclosure when a consumer talks to AI	Colorado General Assembly [261]
FTC fake reviews rule	US, 2024	No AI-generated or fake testimonials; civil penalties	FTC [262]
UK consumer law applied to AI content	England and Wales, 2025-26	Deceptive AI photo edits may breach CPRs 2008 and the DMCC Act; portals remove images faster than regulators act	The Negotiator [244] snippet
Renters' Rights Act bans that an AI tool could breach	England, from 1 May 2026	A pricing or enquiry-filtering tool that invites offers above the advertised rent or screens out benefit claimants or families puts the agent in breach	GOV.UK tenants overview [150]

Three things follow

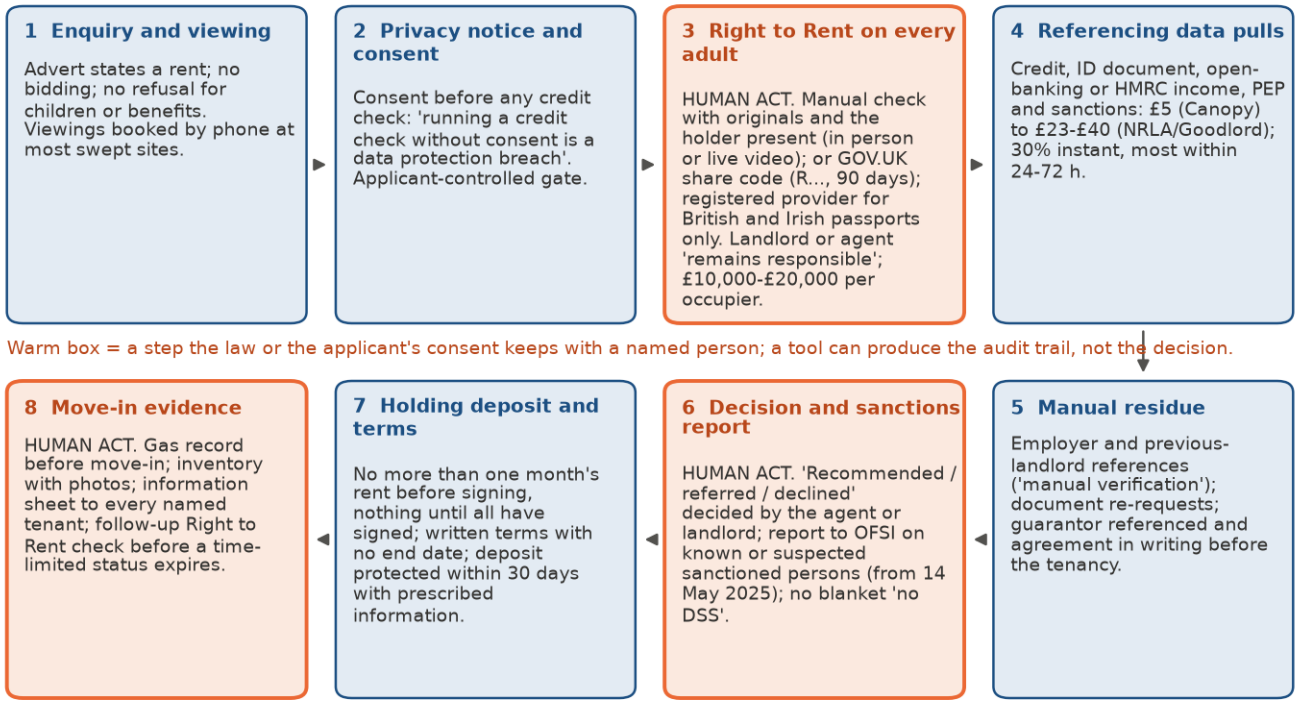
- The money a small firm actually loses is in the low five figures per incident (a £3,138 rental scam, a £9,601 fraudulent tenancy, a £4,900 HMRC penalty, a £8,652 tenancy fine, $500 to $1,500 per TCPA violation) with a long tail of catastrophic single events (seller-impersonation claims over $100,000; a $6.66m BEC case in the FBI record) against insurance that costs under $1,000 a year and may exclude AI errors.
- Email is both the main attack channel (phishing, BEC that looks like the agent) and, for UK agents, a prohibited channel for ID documents, so the everyday workflow sits inside the biggest risk.
- In both countries the rules that bite are about the output and the records (the listing wording, the photo, the consent log, the written risk assessment, the adverse-action notice), which is why every AI question a small firm asks comes back to 'can we show what we did and why'.

SECTION 5

Verification: the data pull takes minutes, the reference call takes days, and the liability never moves

Once the verification steps are separated into three layers the answer is the same in both countries: the data pulls are automated, priced as a commodity and returned in minutes; the residue the vendors themselves label 'manual' takes 24 to 72 hours or weeks; and the law pins the decision and the liability to a named person who cannot delegate it to a tool.

UK lettings, application to move-in: the data pulls take minutes, the references take days, and three steps stay with a named person by law



Sources: Home Office landlord's guide, 1 Oct 2026 [146]; LetSafe UK [153]; NRLA referencing [154]; Canopy [155] (vendor); GOV.UK landlord guidance [156]; GOV.UK deposits [158]; OFSI guidance [147]. US parallel: the same-day screening report ($17-$49) is automated; the landlord's permissible-purpose certification and the FCRA adverse-action notice are human acts [183].

The three layers

- **Layer one, automated**: credit history, document authenticity, open-banking or payroll income, PEP and sanctions lists, US criminal and eviction records; priced as a commodity, returned in minutes or the same day.
- **Layer two, the manual residue**: employer and previous-landlord references, document re-requests when the automated check fails, source-of-funds reasoning, the phone call to confirm a wire instruction or a seller's intent; where the 24-to-72-hour turnarounds and the week-long delays come from.
- **Layer three, fixed by law or consent**: a named person must hold the original documents, make the decision, give the notice and carry the penalty.

UK letting agent: consent, Right to Rent, referencing

- The sequence starts with a privacy notice and consent, because 'running a credit check without consent is a data protection breach' (LetSafe UK [153]), then Right to Rent on every adult who will live there.
- Home Office guide, 1 October 2026, three routes: a manual check where documents are seen 'in the presence of the holder, either in person or by live video call' and the checker is 'in physical possession of the original documents'; the GOV.UK online service using a nine-character share code beginning with R, valid 90 days, with the date of birth; or a registered digital provider, limited to British and Irish passport holders. eVisa-only holders must be checked online; time-limited permission checked no earlier than 28 days before the tenancy

and re-checked before the statutory excuse expires; records kept for the tenancy plus a year; the Landlord Checking Service answers within two working days; the written agent agreement must say whether it covers initial checks, follow-up checks or both (Home Office guide, 1 Oct 2026 [146]).

- Share-code failures seen in practice: tenants using a right-to-work code, expired codes, name or date-of-birth mismatches, lost access to the Home Office account; landlords 'should not automatically refuse or delay the tenancy' on a failed code (Davidson Morris, 1 Apr 2026 [265]).
- Referencing packages: NRLA's Goodlord-powered service checks 'credit, residential history, identification, and income and affordability' with free PEP and sanctions screening for **£23.40 to £40.20 per reference**, returned 'in about 26 hours on average, and one in three is completed instantly' (NRLA [154]); Goodlord's own tiers add open banking, HMRC and payroll income and claim 30% instant, 70% within 24 hours and 90% within 72 hours against 'a typical industry timeframe of two to five working days' (Goodlord/Vouch [266] vendor); Canopy charges **£5 plus VAT per reference**, averages 1.75 days, and labels 'manual verification of current employment and rental history' as a distinct step (Canopy pricing [267]; Canopy for agents [155] vendor); HomeLet claims over 70% within 24 hours, with the National Fraud Database, sold only through agents with no public price (HomeLet [268] vendor).
- Affordability rule of thumb: rent no more than 33 to 40% of gross income, three months of payslips and statements, two years of accounts for the self-employed, a previous (not current) landlord reference, outcomes 'recommended', 'referred' or 'declined'; a guarantor must be a UK homeowner earning three times the annual rent, referenced as fully as the tenant, on a written agreement signed before the tenancy because 'a verbal guarantee is not enforceable' (LetSafe UK [153]).
- Since 1 May 2026 no more than one month's rent may be taken before signing and nothing until every party has signed, which removes the old 'six months up front' workaround for a failed reference (Landlord Studio [269]; Baker McKenzie, Jan 2026 [270]); from 14 May 2025 agents must report to OFSI when they know or suspect a tenant or landlord is sanctioned (OFSI guidance [147]).
- Where the automation breaks, in reviews: Goodlord's 'automated referencing software is deeply flawed' and 'failed every category' despite open-banking data, a landlord 'would like to recall and change my reference but no option to do so', a guarantor's 'AI bot just keeps asking me over and over to upload my documents' (Trustpilot, Goodlord [271] user, Aug-Oct 2026); Canopy returned '5 to 6 days of requests for more documents, some two years old' after open banking was submitted (Trustpilot, Canopy [272] user, 21 Sep 2026); Homeppl 'took 4 weeks to do our referencing' and asked for the same document four times (Trustpilot, Homeppl [273] user, Aug-Sep 2026).

UK estate agent: the same buyer checked three times

- The seller is registered as a customer at instruction (ID, address, beneficial ownership, title) and the buyer at offer. Propertymark tells buyers 'you don't have to provide proof of funds before putting an offer in', lists acceptable proof of name (passport, residence permit, photo licence, HMRC notice) and address (council tax bill, bank statement, non-mobile utility bill), lists sources of funds (mortgage in principle, statements showing the deposit, older statements showing savings building up, evidence of a property sale, gift letter, inheritance, share-sale receipts), and warns that 'the mortgage lender and solicitor or conveyancer will also ask where the money came from' (Propertymark proof of funds [142]).
- The duplication is structural: HMRC says reliance on a third party does not reduce the agency's responsibility; Land Registry Practice Guide 81 covers only the conveyancer's own digital check (NFC chip read with signature verification; 'a photo of the document or MRZ does not meet the requirement'; biometric liveness with a false-match rate of at most 0.01%) and offers no reliance on an estate agent's check; form ID1 'must be verified by a conveyancer', 'A paralegal cannot verify identity', within three months of lodgement (HMLR Practice Guide 81 [274]; HMLR ID1 [275]).
- Tools sold to agents: Thirdfort (NFC ID, PEP and sanctions, source of funds from bank statements, address checks, lettings sanctions screening; 'over 1,500 regulated firms'; remote ID averages '17 hours'; monthly platform fee plus credits on 12-month contracts; recommended client recharges of £30 for an ID check, £15 for source of funds, £5 for lite screening) (Thirdfort [276]; Thirdfort pricing [277] vendor; Thirdfort support [278] snippet); Credas (ID, AML, Right to Rent, source of funds, KYB; tiered, unpriced) (Credas [279] vendor); SmartSearch; Alto's built-in AML at £4.50 pay-as-you-go or £7 plus VAT (Alto support [280] snippet).
- Their reviews complain about the capture step rather than the data: Thirdfort 'app crashes on older phones', camera 'failed to work first 2 times', the same details re-entered per transaction, 'they can access my account anytime they want' on open banking (Trustpilot, Thirdfort [281] user, Oct 2026); Credas has 32% one-star reviews for crashes, timeouts and 'every time there was an issue I was taken back to the beginning' (Trustpilot, Credas [282] user, 18 Sep 2026); SmartSearch has 55% one-star reviews on a three-year contract lock-in and about £1,200 exit fees (Trustpilot, SmartSearch [283] user).
- Seller identity is protected mainly by the owner: HM Land Registry's free Property Alert covers ten properties but 'won't automatically stop fraud'; a restriction (form RX1 at £40 if living there, RQ free if not) stops a sale registering unless a conveyancer certifies the applicant (GOV.UK property fraud [284]; GOV.UK Property Alert

[285]); conveyancers' red flags for an impersonated seller: a vacant property, a seller address different from the searches, email-only remote clients, recently issued ID and quick cash sales (Forsters [286] snippet).

US property manager: the FCRA frame

- The landlord must certify to the consumer reporting agency that the report is for housing; any adverse action (denial, co-signer, larger deposit, higher rent) requires a notice naming the agency, stating that the agency did not make the decision and 'can't give specific reasons for it', and giving the right to dispute and to a free report within 60 days; required 'even if the report played only a small part'; reports must be securely destroyed (FTC, Using Consumer Reports [183]).
- The report is commoditised and same-day: TransUnion SmartMove $25 to $49 ('Most reports delivered same day after the applicant verifies their identity'; 'Choose who pays (where permitted)') (SmartMove pricing [185] vendor); RentSpree $39.99 or $49.99 with bank-verified income and reference checks, landlord free (RentSpree pricing [287] vendor); Buildium $17 landlord-paid, $35 applicant-paid, 'typically generated within 24 hours', income verification excluded so landlords 'verify employment themselves' (Buildium screening [288] vendor); Zillow $29 per applicant (DoorLoop review, 2 Jun 2026 [289] secondary).
- Income is the slow part: Plaid's bank-linked income, The Work Number's 839 million payroll records (credentialed verifiers with a permissible purpose only) and Snappt's and Findigs' document forensics sell on quotes and integrate with Yardi, RealPage and Entrata, not with Buildium or AppFolio-sized tools (Plaid [290]; The Work Number [291]; Snappt pricing [292]; Findigs [293] vendor). Snappt's own advice is to pair its tool with manual steps: two months of pay stubs or statements, pay-stub dates matched to deposit dates, employer calls 'using a number found independently rather than the one on the application' (Snappt, 6 Jan 2026 [229] vendor).
- State law shapes the gate: application fees capped at $20 in New York, $50 in New Jersey from 1 May 2026, actual cost in California, Colorado and Washington, banned in Vermont and for Massachusetts landlords; Colorado, Illinois and New York require acceptance of a reusable report; Cook County, Seattle and D.C. restrict criminal-history questions; California bars eviction records over seven years (TenantCloud [184]; TurboTenant [294] secondary).
- In a lower-tech city: a Birmingham manager requires applicants to view before approval, routes applications through an outside agency taking 'up to 7 business days', and asks for a driver's licence, Social Security card and the last four pay stubs 'as a PDF file, as screenshots are usually illegible' (Signal PM [187]); another issues a Word application and takes 'a minimum of 48 hours' (Continental Realty Management [188]).

US brokerage: wires are a title-company function; the agent warns and calls

- NAR's rule: 'Never send wire instructions (or any personal or financial information) via e-mail'; confirm by phone 'using a number you obtained independently'; some brokers require a signed wire-fraud disclosure; if fraud happens, call the bank and file with IC3 within 24 to 72 hours (NAR wire fraud [175]). Title underwriters add a second person: 'Have a second person review and require a secondary signer for outgoing wires' (FNF 2026 flyer [486] snippet); ALTA's Outgoing Wire Preparation Checklist has three sections (identify the source of instructions; verify instructions received by email or from anyone other than the payee; verify delivery) (ALTA wire fraud [296]).
- Title firms now use about five tools (device analytics, biometrics, government-ID database checks, live facial match, direct seller contact with multi-factor authentication) and rate 'direct seller contact and multifactor authentication' the most effective; one practical check is mailing a letter to the property address; 'One of the biggest red flags is somebody who never wants to get on the phone' (HousingWire, 14 Sep 2026 [218]).
- The automated products are sold to title agents, not brokerages: CertifID (identity, business and payoff verification, insured wires, earnest-money payment; integrations with SoftPro, Resware, RamQuest; no price; zero Trustpilot reviews) (CertifID pricing [297] vendor); Qualia Shield (risk score when wire instructions are entered; '$2 million in coverage, backed by Lloyd's of London' for wires rated low risk only; sellers connect a bank through Stripe) (Qualia Shield [298] vendor); FNF's ionFraud with an account-verification module added 10 September 2026 (ALTA [296]). The insurance covers only what the model rates low risk, so the call-back still decides the risky cases; 87% of impersonation catches happen in curative review.
- Earnest money is verified by the closing company before any release (Colorado closing instructions) (Colorado DRE [299] snippet); no primary source was found on how a listing agent verifies a lender pre-approval or proof-of-funds letter.

Table 5.1 Verification steps: automated today, manual residue, what the law keeps human

Verification step	Automated today (price, turnaround)	Manual residue	Cannot be automated by law or consent	Sources
UK Right to Rent	GOV.UK share-code service (free); registered digital providers for British and Irish passports (Yoti, Post Office; prices not shown); Right to Rent bolt-ons at £2-£7	Manual document route; Landlord Checking Service (two working days); follow-up checks; share-code failures	Holder present and originals in the checker's physical possession for manual checks; eVisa holders online only; landlord or appointed agent "remains responsible"; records kept for the tenancy plus one year; cost cannot be charged to the applicant	Home Office guide [146]; Yoti [300] vendor; Propertymark [238]
UK tenant referencing	Credit, ID document authentication, open-banking and HMRC or payroll income, PEP and sanctions: £5 (Canopy) to £23-£40 (NRLA/Goodlord), 30% instant, most within 24-72 hours	Employer and previous-landlord references ("manual verification"); document re-requests; applicants who do not complete; guarantor referencing	Privacy notice and consent before any credit check; no blanket "no DSS"; guarantor agreement in writing before the tenancy; no more than one month's rent before signing; sanctions reporting to OFSI	NRLA [154]; Canopy [267] vendor; LetSafe UK [153]; OFSI [147]
UK buyer and seller AML	NFC ID, address, PEP and sanctions "instant"; remote ID about 17 hours (Thirdfort); Alto AML £4.50-£7 per check; recharges £5-£30	Source-of-funds analysis and the written rationale; enhanced due diligence on 57.7% of cases with a red flag; 64% still do some manual document checks; buyer repeats the check with the conveyancer and lender	Registration before trading; CDD on all parties; written risk assessment; nominated officer and SARs; five-year records; "reliance on a third party does not reduce" responsibility; only DVS-register providers	Thirdfort [276] vendor; Devonshires [136]; Property Industry Eye, 19 Mar 2026 [143] vendor data; Property Reporter [234]
UK seller identity at the registry	Property Alert (free, alerts only); conveyancer digital ID to PG81 standard	Extra evidence (utility bills, invoices for works) on red-flag sales; restriction applications (RX1 £40, RQ free)	ID1 verified by a conveyancer only, within three months; PG81 gives no reliance on an agent's check	GOV.UK [284]; HMLR ID1 [275]; PG81 [274]
US tenant screening	Credit, criminal, eviction and identity: $17-$49, same day (SmartMove, RentSpree, Buildium, Zillow); bank-linked income (Plaid, under 2 seconds returning users); payroll data (Work Number, instant)	Pay stubs and bank statements checked by hand (72% and 67% of screening time); employer and landlord calls on an independent number; document forensics vendors sell by quote to large portfolios	Landlord's permissible-purpose certification; FCRA adverse-action notice by the landlord even for a minor factor; state fee caps and criteria disclosure; portable reports accepted in Colorado, Illinois and New York; criminal and eviction record limits by jurisdiction; Fair Housing Act applies "regardless of ... the technology used"	SmartMove [185]; RentSpree [287]; Buildium [288] vendor; FTC [183]; NAR Commercial Insights [186]; Snappt [229] vendor
US buyer and seller identity	Title-company tools: device analytics, biometrics, government-ID database checks, live facial match; CertifID identity verification; Proof online notarisation (quote)	Direct seller contact; letter to the property address; checking a pre-approval or proof-of-funds letter (no primary source found)	Notarial acts and closing-agent duties; the seller's own choice of notary is the fraud vector the tools cannot reach	ALTA 2026 [11]; HousingWire [218]; CertifID [297] vendor
US wire instructions	Qualia Shield risk score with $2m cover on low-risk wires; CertifID insured wires and payoff verification; seller bank connection via Stripe instead of email	Call-back to an independently obtained number three days before closing; second-person review and secondary signer; consumer disclosures	Wires the model rates risky are not insured; the call-back decides them; recovery requires bank recall and IC3 filing within 24-72 hours	Qualia Shield [298] vendor; NAR wire fraud [175]; FNF flyer [295].pdf) snippet; Serif TC checklist [173] vendor

The pattern: the automatable layer is evidence collection and database matching; the non-delegable layer is a named human accountable for the decision and its records (landlord or agent for Right to Rent, nominated officer for AML, conveyancer for ID1, landlord for the FCRA notice), a consent gate the applicant controls (credit consent, open-banking consent, share-code generation), and an out-of-band confirmation (a phone call to an employer, a seller or a title company on a number the firm already knew). Software for a small firm therefore has to produce the audit trail, the exception list and the notices, not the decision. Reviews put the pain in case handling: 'rigid automated fails that a human cannot override', the same document requested four times, applicants stuck at the camera, the NFC chip or the open-banking consent screen.

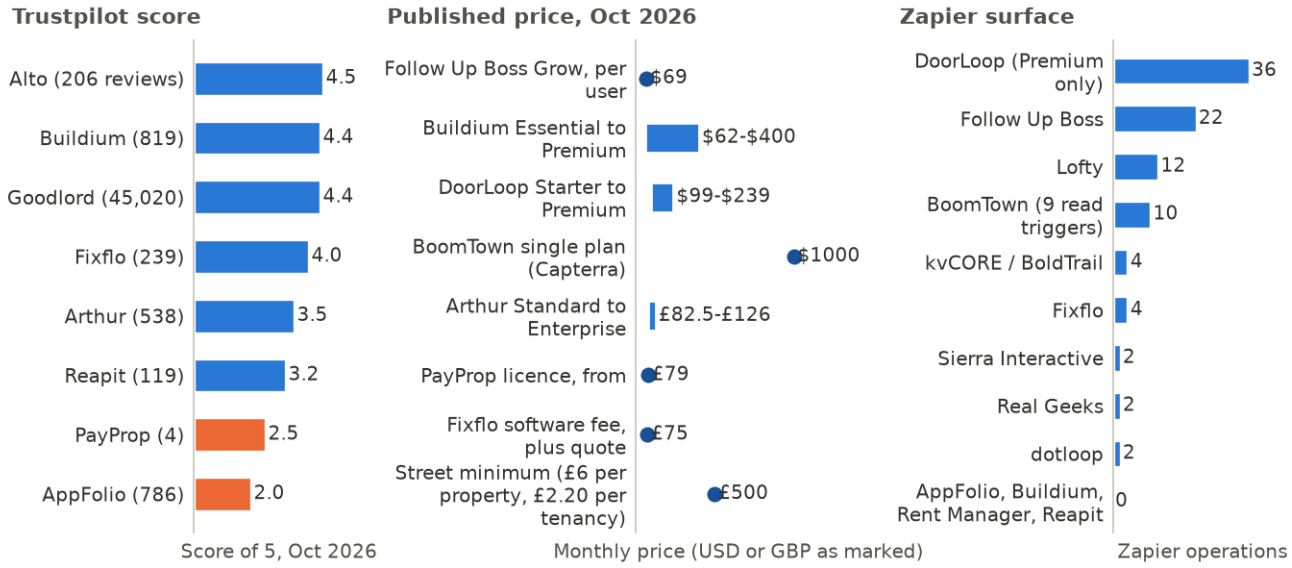
SECTION 6

The platforms can alert but nobody checks they work: the audit angle

Fifteen named systems split into three groups with one shared shape: price-opaque or fee-stacked, integration gated to the top tier, and alert-only on compliance. None sells independent validation after go-live; the one priced audit market (AppFolio trust accounting) exists because the systems let a bank reconciliation pass while owner statements are wrong.

- A US sales CRM group (Follow Up Boss, kvCORE/BoldTrail, Lofty, BoomTown): per-seat priced with paid add-ons or quote-gated with annual terms and ad-management percentages.
- A US property-management group (AppFolio, Buildium, Rent Manager, DoorLoop): the list price is only the start of a fee stack and integration is gated to the top tier.
- A UK agency and lettings group (Reapit, Alto, Street, Goodlord, Fixflo, Arthur, PayProp): a review of 27 vendors found only 9 publish a pound price, and lettings software is 'below that average' (Whito, 4 Sep 2026 [301] secondary).

Platforms: Trustpilot runs from AppFolio 2.0 to Alto 4.5, published prices from $62 to $1,000 a month, and Zapier exposes 36 operations on DoorLoop but none on AppFolio, Buildium or Reapit



Sources: Trustpilot pages for AppFolio [319], Buildium [322], Reapit [333], Alto [336], Arthur [345], Goodlord [340], Fixflo [343], PayProp (4 reviews) [347]; vendor price pages [302] [320] [326] [344] [346] [341]; Zapier app pages [303] [327] [313] [316] [309] [342]. Quote-only vendors (AppFolio, BoldTrail, Lofty, Reapit, Alto, Goodlord, Rent Manager) are not plotted on price.

Table 6.1 Platforms, part 1: published price, automation surface, reporting and alerts

Platform	Published price (Oct 2026)	Automation surface	Reporting and alerts
Follow Up Boss (US sales)	Grow $69/user/month; Pro $499/month for 10 users; Platform $1,000/month for 30; dialer $39/user on Grow; no contract	Zapier 22 operations (7 triggers, 14 actions, 1 search by email, phone or ID); action plans	Deal and pipeline reports; AI call summaries only for calls of 15 seconds to 60 minutes, not transfers
kvCORE / BoldTrail (US sales)	Quote only; third-party estimates $499-$999/month for 5-10 users, setup about $999, ad spend billed separately	Zapier 4 operations (New Lead "may be delayed about 15 minutes", Campaign Action; Create and Update Contact)	Standard dashboards; "campaigns not triggering or IDX not working appropriately" user
Lofty (US sales)	"Request Pricing" on every plan and add-on; 20% ad-management fee on lead generation; $70/month home-evaluation page without IDX	Zapier 12 operations (7 triggers incl. Lead Pipeline Changed, New Transaction; 4 actions)	Smart plans and AI "Sales Agent"; "campaign emails won't be sent when requested. AI will communicate with leads when not" user, 2023
BoomTown (US sales, Inside Real Estate)	$1,000/month single plan on Capterra; "$2,500 or more once ad management fees, MLS charges, and other pass-through costs stack up" secondary	Zapier 10 operations (9 triggers, 1 action; most triggers fire "only for your assigned leads")	Standard; "steep learning curve" user, Dec 2025

Platform	Published price (Oct 2026)	Automation surface	Reporting and alerts
AppFolio (US PM)	Quote only; Core 50-unit minimum plus minimum spend; third-party estimates $1.40-$3.20 per unit, $250-$1,500 minimums, onboarding $400-$1,000+	No Zapier app; API read-only on Plus, read and write on Max	Owner statements, reports hard to pick, "Can't use AI for reporting"; AI could not read uploaded insurance documents user
Buildium (US PM)	Essential $62, Growth $192, Premium $400 per month; bank account setup $99; eSignature $5/$1/free; incoming EFT $2.35/$1.35; inspections $99 setup + $40-$95/month on Essential; 1099 e-file $50 per batch + $4.50 per form; onboarding required on Growth and Premium	No Zapier app; Open API and "Full AI and Automations suite" on Premium only	Analytics on Growth and above; "If you are accounting software I would like to see the entire deposit" (deposits netted) user, 25 Sep 2026
Rent Manager (US PM)	Quote only; texting needs a purchased number; AI call summaries need a phone subscription; call centre, websites and integrations unpriced	No Zapier page found	"outdated-looking interface and a learning curve for larger teams" secondary
DoorLoop (US PM)	Starter $99 ($69 annual, up to 10 units), Pro $189, Premium $239; "$3/unit" above base; eSignature $3/$1/free; onboarding fee by portfolio size	Zapier 36 operations on Premium only (20 triggers incl. Lease Ending, Tenant Moving Out, Renter Insurance Expiring, New Returned Payment, In Eviction); API Premium	Standard; QuickBooks sync on Pro
Reapit (UK agency)	Per user, demo only; "from £150 per user per month" unverified; 12-24 month and three-year contracts reported	Foundations platform and AppMarket for custom apps; API called "the worst API we have ever implemented" user, snippet	Reporting "needs setup" (internal IT resource) sponsored
Alto (UK agency, Zoopla/Houseful)	Demo only; per-branch flat fee, third-party estimate £200-£1,000+/month; "over 6,000 agents"; onboarding and migration included sponsored	Vendor-selected marketplace partners; Rightmove enhanced leads in real time since Aug 2026; Alto Intelligence "five AI capabilities" vendor	Standard dashboards
Street.co.uk (UK agency)	£6 + VAT per active property + £2.20 + VAT per tenancy per month, £500 + VAT minimum, unlimited users; £500 set-up waived for Kerfuffle members	Marketplace partners	"Basic pipeline and activity reporting only" sponsored
Goodlord (UK lettings)	Demo form only	Referencing, Right to Rent collection, e-signing, rent collection; "40+" compliance steps automated vendor	Vendor claims "80%" admin-time reduction vendor
Fixflo (UK repairs)	Plans on request plus £75/month software fee; 50-property minimum; contractor marketplace from £0.30 per unit; services (training, customisation, migration) from £300 + VAT each	Zapier 4 operations (Issue Added, Issue Status Changed, Add New Issue, Get Issue)	"The MI reporting is not especially intuitive" user, 7 Jul 2026
Arthur (UK lettings)	Standard £82.50/month (55 units), Professional £96 (60), Enterprise £126 (70); £1.50-£1.80 per extra unit; annual billing; integrations (signatures, SMS, Xero, Zapier, bank feed) "subject to additional fees"	Zapier available at extra cost	Standard
PayProp (UK client accounting)	Licence from £79/month; setup £600-£2,000 by portfolio; service fee "less than 1%" of processing volume	Bank-feed reconciliation; arrears reminders by text and email vendor	Client accounts "with 100% accurate totals" vendor

Table 6.1 Platforms, part 2: compliance tracking, documented limits, sources

Platform	Compliance tracking	Documented limits	Sources
Follow Up Boss (US sales)	None native; consent provenance must be recorded by the user	No IDX site, "no complete transaction management", no payments; stages, tags, smart lists and routing "take more thought"; "$69/month for a solo agent closing four deals a year is a hard sell"; tagging "wasn't reliable" user	FUB pricing [302] vendor; Zapier FUB [303]; The Close, 21 Sep 2026 [304] secondary; Capterra FUB [305] snippet
kvCORE / BoldTrail (US sales)	None documented	Capterra: 81% negative of 48 reviews on performance, 83% negative of 30 on contract and billing; a G2 reviewer paid about $12,000 over eight months to the lead programme with no data access; brokerage bundles mean the URL and data may not survive leaving the brokerage competitor	BoldTrail pricing blog [306] vendor; AI Tools Bakery [307] secondary; Capterra BoldTrail [308] snippet; Zapier kvCORE [309]
Lofty (US sales)	Consent status tag per lead ("System Recorded", "User Recorded", "Business Relationship", "Unknown", "Internal DNC")	BBB rating F, 22 complaints in three years; 90-day pre-renewal notice clause and a year's auto-renewal; "hidden fees, hidden long contracts" user, 15 Sep 2026	Lofty pricing [310] vendor; Lofty TCPA [212] vendor; BBB Lofty [311]; Software Advice [312] snippet; Zapier Lofty [313]

Platform	Compliance tracking	Documented limits	Sources
BoomTown (US sales, Inside Real Estate)	None documented	BBB complaints of "forced into a new agreement to add agents" and "bait and switch" on data transfer secondary; annual commitments	Capterra BoomTown pricing [314] snippet; Luxury Presence [315] secondary; Zapier BoomTown [316]
AppFolio (US PM)	Renter's insurance tracking; no documented compliance-date workflow	Trustpilot 2.0 from 786 reviews; phone support "by appointment only"; "3-5 day window for processing owner/vendor payments"; updates "crash everything we had just put into place"; cancellation may need "a physical letter"; no native QuickBooks sync; reconciliation "steep learning curve"	AppFolio pricing [317] vendor; CostBench [318] secondary; Software Connect [201] secondary; Trustpilot AppFolio [319] user, 2026
Buildium (US PM)	Renter's insurance, inspections (paid)	Essential has ticket-only support; "6 price increases in the last 2.5 years"; auto-reconciliation "just stopped working" after renewal; 20+ days to change trust-account bank details; cancellation forced "hundreds of owner PAD agreements" to be reset	Buildium pricing [320] vendor; Capterra Buildium [321] snippet; Trustpilot Buildium [322] user, 2025-26; ComplaintsBoard [323]
Rent Manager (US PM)	Not documented	Add-on pricing opaque	Rent Manager pricing [324] vendor; SoftwareWorld [325] secondary
DoorLoop (US PM)	Insurance expiry trigger exposed via Zapier	"problems with deleting leases, moving tenants between units, and handling complex lease terms"; "accounting depth lacking" secondary	DoorLoop pricing [326] vendor; Zapier DoorLoop [327]; Software Advice [328] secondary
Reapit (UK agency)	"No certificate renewal automation live or announced"; arrears and maintenance "within the CRM, not automated triage" sponsored	Trustpilot 3.2 from 119: "they can raise your monthly fees without so much as a phone call", "essentially an empty CRM" at go-live, direct debits after cancelling; no block management	Reapit multi-branch [329] vendor; Softomate [330] secondary; AllAgents Reapit [331] snippet; Letting Agent Today, Aug 2026 [332] sponsored; Trustpilot Reapit [333] user, 2026
Alto (UK agency, Zoopla/Houseful)	Thirdfort-powered AML at £4.50-£7 per check snippet	Trustpilot 4.5 from 206 but 15% one-star: "the software is very poor and slow", a multi-property record loads in "around a minute", "Data was transferred incorrectly" on Reapit migration, "leads not coming through from portals"	Capterra Alto [334]; TradePick [335] secondary; Property Industry Eye, 5 Aug 2026 [151]; Trustpilot Alto [336] user, 2026
Street.co.uk (UK agency)	"Certificate alerts only, with no end-to-end renewal workflow" sponsored	Kerfuffle 4.9 from 22; "a little more prewarning on price increases", "some of the elements are a little clunky/overcomplicated" user; "better suited to sales than lettings" secondary; no block management	Kerfuffle Street [337]; Letting Agent Today [332] sponsored; Superb Digital [338] secondary
Goodlord (UK lettings)	Compliance steps inside the tenancy flow	Trustpilot 4.4 from 45,020 (5% one-star): "failed every category" automated checks, reference cannot be recalled, bots loop on document upload, "reaching a human by phone or chat can be difficult"	Goodlord [339] vendor; Trustpilot Goodlord [340] user, 2026
Fixflo (UK repairs)	Repair reporting and works orders; contractor appointment and pricing sit with the agent	Trustpilot 4.0 from 239 (19% one-star): annual auto-renew "without any ability to cancel in year"; reducing a package "removed their CRM integration" and restoring it needed a new 12-month contract; a landlord saw a £600 lock-barrel bill with no estimate	Fixflo pricing [341] vendor; Zapier Fixflo [342]; Trustpilot Fixflo [343] user, 2026
Arthur (UK lettings)	Tenancy templates "weren't updated for the Renters Reform Bill" user, 19 May 2026	Trustpilot 3.5 from 538: "unable to use the system due to ongoing issues with the Xero integration", "client onboarding is non-existent", tickets only, "charged twice for one reference"	Arthur pricing [344] vendor; Trustpilot Arthur [345] user, 2024-26
PayProp (UK client accounting)	Client-money accounting only	"not a full front-office leasing suite with listing syndication and CRM depth"; "buyers still need to plan setup work for a multi-system stack" secondary; Trustpilot 2.5 from 4	PayProp pricing [346] vendor; RFP.wiki [347] secondary

The Zapier count is the quickest proxy for what a consultant can automate

- Follow Up Boss (22) and DoorLoop Premium (36) are automatable; Lofty (12) and BoomTown (10, mostly read triggers) partly; kvCORE (4), Fixflo (4), Sierra Interactive (2), Real Geeks (2) and dotloop (2) barely; AppFolio, Buildium, Rent Manager, TenantCloud, SkySlope and Reapit return no Zapier app at the expected address (Zapier FUB [303]; Zapier DoorLoop [327]; Zapier AppFolio, 404 [348]).
- API access is tier-gated on AppFolio (read-only Plus, read and write Max), Buildium (Premium), DoorLoop (Premium) and Propertyware ('Add $1 per unit/month') (AppFolio pricing [317]; Buildium pricing [320]; Propertyware pricing [349] vendor). For a small US manager on AppFolio Core or Buildium Essential, automation beyond native features is spreadsheets, VAs and bookkeepers; in the UK, Reapit's Foundations and agentOS's open API are the two integration platforms and the rest rely on vendor-chosen partners (Kerfuffle agentOS [350]; Superb Digital [338] secondary).

Underuse and misconfiguration, documented from three directions

- The adoption base rate is low: **46% of Realtors use a CRM at all**, only 23% call it their top source of quality leads, 36% have the CRM paid for by a brokerage they did not choose it through, and the barriers are 'learning curve' (63%) and 'cost' (59%) (HousingWire, 2026 [58]; NAR 2025 Technology Survey PDF [351]). Brokerage leaders say about 40% of their firms have technology adoption below 50%, about 30% say their technology 'just checks a box', CRM satisfaction fell from about 3.7 to 3.2 stars, 55% train in-house and 10% give no training (TotalBrokerage 2025 [352]; TotalBrokerage 2024 [353] vendor survey, 100+ leaders).
- The consultants who sell around the CRMs describe the decay: 'keeping a CRM current is nobody's dedicated job', leads 'sit untagged, follow-ups get missed, and notes go unlogged', 'Once agents stop trusting the system, they use it even less', the CRM becomes 'an expensive, outdated contact list' (Be Epic Assistant, 22 Jul 2026 [354] vendor); 'Importing a messy database is where teams lose weeks' of 'duplicate records, dead email addresses, and missing phone numbers' (Tomba, Aug 2026 [355] secondary); value 'depends on clean sources, tags, routing, and reporting' and 'a CRM only helps if the team actually follows the workflow' (The Pro Toolkit, Jul 2026 [356] secondary).
- On the accounting side an AppFolio bookkeeping firm lists the errors it is paid to find: duplicate transaction entries from imports plus manual entry, missing deposits, incorrect owner distributions, misclassified security deposits, unrecorded bank fees and unresolved timing differences; 'a $3,200 vendor payment entered against the wrong property' leaves the bank reconciled while 'The owner statements can therefore be incorrect even though the bank account appears reconciled'; 'Many property managers discover trust account issues only after an owner questions a statement' (WPM Accounting [202]).
- Users confirm the 'configured but not working' pattern across vendors: BoldTrail campaigns and IDX, Lofty campaign emails, Follow Up Boss tags, Alto portal leads after migration, Buildium auto-reconciliation after renewal, Arthur's Xero sync (Capterra BoldTrail [308] snippet; Software Advice Lofty [312] snippet; Trustpilot Alto [336] user, 2026; ComplaintsBoard Buildium [323]; Trustpilot Arthur [345] user, Jan 2026).

The consultant market is mature and priced in exactly one place

- AppFolio and Buildium trust accounting is sold by OJO Bookkeeping at **$34 an hour ongoing, $45 an hour for 'cleanup and corrective work', $300 a month minimum**, aimed at 50-plus units and opened with a free 'AppFolio Health Check' for 'Misposted invoices', 'Unapplied tenant credits', 'Trust accounts that drift out of balance', 'Skipped monthly trust reconciliations' and 'Owner statements that don't match the bank balance' (OJO Bookkeeping [357]); by appfoliobookkeeping.com per active unit per month on a custom proposal (appfoliobookkeeping.com [358]); by PM Bookkeeper on a flat monthly quote with forecasts at 500 and 1,000 units after an initial audit ('Before we touch anything, we review the current state of your books') (PM Bookkeeper [359]); and by Balanced Asset Solutions and WPM as setup, 'regular system audits', cleanup and migration on flat-fee proposals (Balanced Asset Solutions [360]; WPM services [361]).
- Upwork lists US AppFolio consultants at **$30 to $75 an hour** (a California property-management consultant at $55, a bookkeeper at $75, a QuickBooks bookkeeper at $30) and offshore freelancers 'around $10/hour' offering 'historical cleanup'; buyer posts offer $25 an hour for a part-time AppFolio bookkeeper and $1,300 to $1,500 a month for multi-entity bookkeeping (Upwork AppFolio California [362]; Upwork AppFolio [363] snippet).
- The CRM side is a commodity gig market: Fiverr sells 'expertly setup real estate crm lofty, follow up boss, kvcore, idx website chime' from **$15**, Follow Up Boss and kvCORE set-ups from $10 and $20, Zapier automation from $25, Make and n8n from $35, with the Follow Up Boss tag running to at least 19 pages (Fiverr FUB gigs [364] snippet); VA firms sell a 'cleanup pass, then ongoing maintenance' with no published rates (Be Epic [354] vendor); third-party estimates put BoldTrail setup at about $999 and implementation at $1,000 to $5,000 (AI Tools Bakery [307] secondary).
- In the UK no independent consultant market around Reapit, Alto, Street or Jupix was found; training and onboarding are vendor-delivered (Reapit runs 'over 50 classroom training sessions every month' in Australia) or discounted through trade bodies (Propertymark members get 25% off SME Professional's onboarding; Kerfuffle members get £500 waived from Street's set-up fee); the exception is Fixflo selling its own professional services at £300 plus VAT each (Reapit AU training [365] vendor; Propertymark SME Professional [366]; Kerfuffle Street [337]; Fixflo pricing [341] vendor). A UK consultancy's rule of thumb is '£100 to £500 per branch per month, plus setup and migration fees' and 'Training usually slows an office for 2 to 4 weeks' (ESRE Media, 30 Jul 2026 [140] secondary).

Table 6.2 Vendor-side set-up fees (the anchor a consultant's quote is compared with)

Vendor-side set-up fee (the anchor a consultant's quote is compared with)	Amount	Source
Buildium onboarding	Required on Growth and Premium, fee not shown; bank account setup $99 each; third-party estimate $1,000-$2,000	Buildium pricing [320] vendor; CostBench [367] snippet
AppFolio onboarding	$400 to over $1,000 (about two months of service)	CostBench [318] secondary
DoorLoop onboarding	"based on portfolio size"; promotional waiver to 7 Nov 2026	DoorLoop pricing [326] vendor
Propertyware implementation	2x the monthly subscription	Propertyware pricing [349] vendor
Yardi Breeze	"No onboarding fees, No training fees, No support fees"; $1 per unit, $100 minimum, annual agreement	Yardi Breeze pricing [368] vendor
Lofty setup	$299-$1,499 reported; about $500 non-refundable	Luxury Presence [369] snippet; CostBench Lofty [370] snippet
Real Geeks and Sierra Interactive	$500 setup each (Sierra waived on annual)	Real Geeks pricing [371] vendor; Luxury Presence Sierra [372] snippet
dotloop (brokerage)	"$600+ one time set up $125+ monthly", six-month opt-out	Trustpilot dotloop [373] user, 28 May 2026
PayProp setup	£600 to £2,000 by portfolio size	PayProp pricing [346] vendor
Fixflo services	From £300 + VAT per service (training, customisation, migration)	Fixflo pricing [341] vendor
Street set-up	At least £500 (the amount waived for Kerfuffle members)	Kerfuffle Street [337]

Table 6.3 Real monthly cost, 2025-26 (researcher's arithmetic from the cited price pages)

Real monthly cost, 2025-26 (researcher's arithmetic from the cited price pages)	Figure	Source
5-agent US team on Follow Up Boss	$345 (5 x $69); $540 with dialer; Pro $499 covers 10 users with calling	FUB pricing [302]
5-agent team on Real Geeks or Sierra	$474 + $500 setup + $10 per MLS board; Sierra Core $499.95	Real Geeks [371]; The Close Sierra [374]
5-agent team on BoldTrail, Lofty or BoomTown	$499-$999 estimated + setup + ad spend; BoomTown $1,000 list, $2,500+ with pass-throughs; Lofty quote + 20% ad management	AI Tools Bakery [307] secondary; Luxury Presence [315] secondary; Lofty [310]
Transaction tool on top	SkySlope from $340/month; dotloop $125+/month plus $600 setup	SkySlope [375]; Trustpilot dotloop [373]
300-unit US manager	Propertyware $300-$600 + $300 API + implementation 2x; Yardi Breeze $300; DoorLoop Pro $189 (API needs Premium $239); AppFolio estimated $447-$960 on third-party per-unit figures; Buildium above the 150-unit Premium "starting at" $400, unpublished; RentRedi $29.95 flat	Propertyware [349]; Yardi Breeze [368]; DoorLoop [326]; Capterra AppFolio [376] snippet; RentRedi [377]
2-branch UK agency	Street about £1,340 + VAT (150 sales properties x £6 + 200 tenancies x £2.20); Reapit about £1,500 (10 users x unverified £150), range £500-£2,000+; Alto £200-£1,000+; Jupix £300-£1,200; lettings add-ons Arthur about £450 for 300 units, PayProp £79 + under 1% + setup, Fixflo £75 + quote; all-in £1,500-£3,000 a month before setup, most of it unquotable without a demo	Kerfuffle Street [337]; TradePick [335] secondary; Arthur [344]; PayProp [346]; Fixflo [341]

The audit angle: set-up is already a paid line item at every vendor, and the 'configured but not working' complaints are all failures a periodic check would have caught before a customer did: a campaign that never fired, a portal feed that stopped after migration, an owner statement that does not tie to the bank, a certificate date that was alerted but never actioned. No vendor in scope documents an error or misconfiguration rate, publishes a utilisation statistic (seats active, leads with no follow-up), or sells independent validation after go-live; the AppFolio bookkeeping niche, with its hourly and per-unit prices and free health check, is the proof that this is paid for when someone offers it.

SECTION 7

Seven handoffs drop the same four things: context, timing, money and dates

Across US sales, US property management and UK sales and lettings, what gets dropped between stages is the same four items: context (the history stays in one person's inbox, voicemail or phone), timing ('No follow-up date means it falls through the cracks'), money mapping (a payment posted to the wrong ledger or property), and compliance dates (tracked by alert rather than by a workflow with an owner and a completion check).

- The strongest quantified evidence is UK fall-through (23 to 30% of agreed sales) and the fact that fewer than half of Realtors use a CRM; the rest is practitioner and consultant testimony (BiggerPockets 1302426 [215] user, Oct 2026; iCloudReady, 2 May 2026 [378] vendor).

Table 7.1 Seven handoffs, part 1: what gets dropped, in practitioners' words, and the numbers

Handoff	What gets dropped, in practitioners' words	Numbers
Lead to appointment (US)	"Most deals require 5-12 touches, yet many agents stop after 2"; leads marked "warm" and never revisited, "a CRM full of abandoned conversations"; "the history stays in a personal chat"; "a CRM where logging is optional has no pipeline visibility"; stale and active leads "look identical without idle-period flags"	48% of enquiries never answered (2013); 15-hour average response (2026, vendor); 46% CRM use; 1-3% close on paid leads at $223 each; "Lead quality was poor the first month" with a VA
Contract to close (US)	"Starting from scratch with document packets on every deal"; "Re-entering personal and entity information on every contract"; documents "spread across email, Dropbox, Google Drive, and texts"; "Nobody is on the same system"; "the contingency clock problem"; missed option-period and EMD release deadlines "still the biggest bleed"	14% delayed, 5-7% terminated; 20-30 dates per contract; 8-15 hours on a complex file; agents carrying 15-20 files
Application to lease (US and UK)	Applicants "have difficulty tracking application progress"; the same document requested four times; automated checks that "failed every category" with no human override; a Birmingham firm's outside agency takes "up to 7 business days"; Right to Rent share codes that fail on name mismatch	References 24-72 hours (UK); 6.4% of US applications fraudulent; 41 per 1,000 UK applications flagged; one month's rent cap removes the "pay up front" fix for a failed reference
Maintenance request to completed job (US and UK)	"everybody saw the request but nobody actually owned it"; "'Vendor says it's done' is not the same thing as closed"; "Tenants mostly call again at midnight because nobody told them what the next step was"; "Verbal NTEs are where invoice disputes start"; "If the invoice arrives before somebody confirms the work, leave that item open"; "Chasing owners down for repair approvals is outdated, inefficient"; a UK landlord found repairs "done in my flat without my permission" and another saw a £600 bill with no estimate	56% of US owners hire a manager for maintenance; owner thresholds $500-$1,000 "often not honored"; about five message rounds per repair text; 52% of UK self-managing landlords call maintenance the biggest time sink; Fixflo processes 150,000+ repairs a month
Instruction to listing (UK)	Material Information collected to a withdrawn standard; vendors "have forgotten the answers to many the 'additional enquiries'"; portal feeds that "batch once or twice a day"; after a CRM migration "leads not coming through from portals"	46% of agents still use the withdrawn NTSELAT guidance; 96.7% feel unsupported; 1,125,158 price changes a year
Offer to completion (UK)	"Searches, documentation, identification, source-of-funds information" must all be chased early; "The longer a transaction remains open, the longer somebody has to manage it"; "Without the log, every fall-through just feels like bad luck"; "Most delays don't come out of nowhere"; "freehold houses need estate management packs" and local search lead times recur	123 days to exchange; 154 to completion; 23.7% fall through, 38% within four weeks; £3,550 per fall-through; 2 hours a day of agent chasers per conveyancer; 150-250 cases per progressor
Compliance renewals (UK lettings; US insurance and 1099s)	"A reminder being sent is not the same as the work being completed"; certificates "fall outside digitisation plans, so landlords must scan and upload them manually"; COI documents "expire on different dates" and "nobody notices until a claim or an audit"; tenancy templates "weren't updated for the Renters Reform Bill"	Annual gas, five-yearly EICR, EPC, 28-day pet response, annual Form 4A, 30-day deposit, PRS database from Dec 2026; penalties £7,000-£40,000; Right to Rent follow-up checks; US 1099s by 31 January; 14-60 day deposit returns
Owner statements and trust money (US PM)	"the owner statements can therefore be incorrect even though the bank account appears reconciled"; "If you can't tell what you paid for, you can't tell whether the month was expensive or just opaque"; "A lump-sum line is where padding hides"; UK: "I have spent countless hours chasing money due to financial errors" and rent "mistakenly paid to the old firm"	AppFolio 3-5 day payment window is "the biggest complaint"; Buildium deposits netted; a TPO expulsion for delayed deposit and rent transfers

Table 7.1 Seven handoffs, part 2: what vendors claim to catch, what reviews confirm, sources

Handoff	What vendors claim to catch	What reviews and independent sources confirm	Sources
Lead to appointment (US)	Every CRM claims action plans and smart lists (FUB, Lofty "Sales Agent", BoldTrail campaigns); Zillow Pro promises "AI-powered alerts for timely outreach" inside Follow Up Boss; AI answering vendors claim to book showings	The failure is adoption, not features: "campaigns not triggering", "AI will communicate with leads when not", tags that "wouldn't work at all"; an AI phone bot "logs that call as answered" even when the caller hung up before escalation vendor-adjacent; no independent data on appointment conversion by CRM	HousingWire, 28 May 2026 [169]; iCloudReady [378] vendor; WAV Group 2013 [46]; Real Estate News, 15 Oct 2025 [379]; Capterra BoldTrail [308] snippet; Perceptionist [380] snippet; BiggerPockets 1302383 [381] user
Contract to close (US)	Lone Wolf Transact "links offer details to the client so information carries over when a deal falls through" plus compliance checklists and broker file review; dotloop and SkySlope checklists; TC services claim "90% of the contract-to-close process" and 16 hours saved	Follow Up Boss has "no complete transaction management", so deal data is re-entered in dotloop or Brokermint; dotloop users report "MLS data not populating into forms" and weak autofill; SkySlope value-for-money 3.6/5	BiggerPockets post 7250481 [49] user, 2026; NAR RCI [45]; Lone Wolf [382] vendor; Transactly [383] vendor; The Close FUB [304] secondary; Capterra dotloop [384] snippet; Capterra SkySlope [385] snippet
Application to lease (US and UK)	Goodlord "40+" compliance steps automated and "80%" admin saved; Canopy fraud found "in about 15 seconds" and 1.75-day average; HomeLet 70% within 24 hours; Findigs automated approve/decline; RentSpree reference checks	Reviews: Goodlord "deeply flawed", landlord cannot amend a reference; Canopy "5 to 6 days of requests for more documents"; Homeppl "4 weeks"; HomeLet progress-tracking complaints; RentSpree score discrepancies; employer and landlord references remain "manual verification" by the vendors' own description	Trustpilot HomeLet [386]; Trustpilot Homeppl [273]; Trustpilot Goodlord [271] user, 2026; Signal PM [187]; Goodlord [339] vendor; Canopy [155] vendor; Trustpilot RentSpree [387] user, Sep 2026
Maintenance request to completed job (US and UK)	Fixflo "Track and progress works orders with a few clicks" and out-of-hours triage; Property Meld inside AppFolio and Smart Move; AppFolio and Rentvine maintenance portals; Reapit maintenance "within the CRM"	Fixflo replies on Trustpilot that it "does not appoint contractors or set pricing; the agent does", so triage, approval and completion sit outside the software; AppFolio pushes Property Meld "to do things the software should/could do"; Reapit maintenance is "not automated triage" sponsored; Fixflo Zapier exposes only four operations	BiggerPockets 1303197 [9]; BiggerPockets 1302900 [194]; BiggerPockets 1303269 [388] user, Oct 2026; PMAssist, 2 Sep 2025 [389]; Trustpilot Martin & Co [390] user, 2026; Trustpilot Fixflo [343] user, Jul 2026; Fixflo [391] vendor; Software Connect AppFolio [201] secondary
Instruction to listing (UK)	CRMs claim portal syndication and AML checks in the flow (Alto with Thirdfort; Street, Reapit); Rightmove-to-Alto real-time leads since Aug 2026	No CRM in scope claims to assemble or validate Material Information Parts A-C; the Rightmove lead integration being news in August 2026 implies hand-copying of enquiries before it; migration failures confirmed by the vendor ("didn't run as smoothly as it should have")	Property Industry Eye, 23 Jan 2025 [242] user; Bebeez [138] secondary; ESRE Media [140] secondary; Trustpilot Alto [336] user, Apr-Sep 2026; Property Industry Eye, 5 Aug 2026 [151]
Offer to completion (UK)	Sales-progression modules and one agency's "personal portal to track progress, with daily updates and milestone alerts"; sales-progression outsourcers and a new franchise capped at 60 cases	No CRM in scope claims to reduce fall-through; it is a market-structure problem (non-binding until exchange) that modules only track; only 1 of 20 swept independents advertises a progression portal	Property Industry Eye, 1 Oct 2026 [15]; Property Industry Eye, 24 Sep 2026 [23]; Bartlams [144]; Conveyancing Matters [22]
Compliance renewals (UK lettings; US insurance and 1099s)	Reapit and Street certificate alerts; Goodlord compliance steps; DoorLoop "Renter Insurance Expiring" trigger; Buildium 1099 e-file; AppFolio renter's-insurance tracking	Reapit: "No certificate renewal automation live or announced"; Street: "Certificate alerts only, with no end-to-end renewal workflow" (both from an Alto-sponsored piece needing independent confirmation); Arthur templates out of date in May 2026; AppFolio's AI "could not read uploaded insurance docs"; no source quantifies missed gas, EICR or EPC renewals	Property Industry Eye, 28 Sep 2026 [162]; Property Industry Eye, 5 Oct 2026 [44]; BiggerPockets 1303196 [197] user; Letting Agent Today [332] sponsored; Trustpilot Arthur [345] user, 19 May 2026; Trustpilot AppFolio [319] user, 29 Sep 2026; Zapier DoorLoop [327]
Owner statements and trust money (US PM)	Owner portals with statements and year-end tax statements; PayProp "100% accurate totals" and real-time reconciliation; AppFolio Plaid auto-reconciliation	Independent bookkeepers list the same five errors at every client (wrong-property posting, unapplied credits, duplicate imports, miscoded deposits, skipped trust recs); a reviewer "spent ~two months getting Plaid auto-reconciliation working"; Buildium auto-reconciliation "just stopped working"	WPM Accounting [202]; BiggerPockets 1302340 [392] user, Oct 2026; Trustpilot Martin & Co [390] user, 2026; Letting Agent Today, 9 Oct 2026 [393]; Capterra AppFolio [394] snippet; ComplaintsBoard Buildium [323]

Three handoffs where vendor claims sit furthest from what reviews confirm

- In US sales the handoff products say they catch is contract-to-close (Lone Wolf's 'carries over when a deal falls through'), while lead-to-appointment is claimed by every CRM through action plans and practitioners say the failure is adoption: 'logging is optional', 'nobody's dedicated job', and the follow-up stops at two touches.
- In UK lettings the compliance-renewal cycle is about to get heavier (PRS database, ombudsman, Awaab's Law timescales, written terms), and the two best-known CRMs are described, by a rival's sponsored comparison, as

alert-only; the clearest near-term unmet need, but it needs non-sponsored confirmation.

- In both countries the maintenance ticket is the handoff where the software stops at the edge of its own screen: Fixflo, Property Meld and the AppFolio portal log the request, but who triages it, who approves it, who confirms the job is done and who tells the tenant the next step are, by the vendors' own replies, the agent's problem.

SECTION 8

Follow Up Boss against BoldTrail and Lofty; AppFolio against Buildium and DoorLoop; Reapit against Alto and Street

The dated user quotes below are the only first-person evidence the researchers could reach, because Reddit, Facebook groups and most of G2 and Capterra were blocked; where a Capterra or G2 line appears it came from a search snippet. The comparison is organised by the choice a small firm actually faces inside each group, and ends with the seven gaps all fifteen platforms share.

Table 8.1 Platforms, part 1: rating and base, praise (dated), complaint (dated)

Platform	Rating and base	Praise (dated)	Complaint (dated)
Follow Up Boss	G2 4.6 from 115 snippet; Trustpilot 1 review	Ease of use and onboarding wizard (G2); "They could have a few more trainings to get up and running" (Trustpilot, 3 Mar 2022)	"$69/month for a solo agent closing four deals a year is a hard sell"; per-user pricing "punishes teams that add assistants"; tagging "wasn't reliable" (Capterra) snippet; "Importing a messy database is where teams lose weeks" (Aug 2026)
BoldTrail (kvCORE)	Capterra 48 reviews, 81% negative on performance; G2 reviews snippet	Called the industry standard for brokerage bundles (eXp, RE/MAX) competitor	"The support is horrendous", fixes "that should take minutes stretching into a full day", "Simple stuff like email setups, campaigns not triggering or IDX not working appropriately" (Capterra, Sep 2025); about $12,000 over eight months to the lead programme with no data access and an undisclosed ad suspension (G2, late 2025); BBB Oct 2025 "misled into an Inside Real Estate contract"; "new owners force customers onto new products" (Capterra broker, Feb 2025)
Lofty (Chime)	G2 4.3 from 389 snippet; BBB F, 22 complaints in 3 years	Broad feature set (AI sales, social and homeowner agents) vendor	"Lofty has hidden fees, hidden long contracts, and its difficult to use/manage"; cancellation refused under a 90-day pre-renewal clause and auto-renewed for a year (BBB, 15 Sep 2026); "Charged me ... for 7 months an account i wasnt using" (BBB, 2025); "made a lot of promises when they sign you up but never delivered ... only got a few bad leads" (Capterra, Nov 2025); "campaign emails won't be sent when requested. AI will communicate with leads when not" (Software Advice, 2023); onboarding liaison "seems MIA" afterwards
BoomTown	GetApp 239 reviews snippet; Capterra UK	"powerful but with a steep learning curve" (Capterra, Dec 2025)	"Don't use Boomtown" (Capterra UK, Feb 2025, 1.0/5); "some reviewers feel the pricing is restrictive"; "forced into a new agreement to add agents" (BBB, 8 Apr 2025); "bait and switch" on data transfer (BBB, 2 May 2025) secondary
AppFolio	Trustpilot 2.0 from 786 (25% one-star; vendor replies to about 4%)	Deep feature set; used by 8 of 23 swept small managers	"I strongly recommend thinking twice before committing to this platform" (6 Oct 2026); "a live person is not available" after an account compromise (2 Oct 2026); "This app is NONFUNCTIONAL!", ACH fees at every step, AI could not read insurance documents (29 Sep 2026); autopay pulled nine days early (25 Aug 2026); "might need to send a physical letter to complete the cancellation" (7 Aug 2026); "an update would come out and crash everything we had just put into place" plus extra training fees (15 Jun 2026); owner "went months without a fix to their reconciliation problem" (Capterra) snippet
Buildium	Trustpilot 4.4 from 819; Capterra 2,234 reviews, 92% positive snippet; ComplaintsBoard 10 complaints, 0% resolved	Published prices; broad positive Capterra base	"terrible customer service, long wait times (50plus minutes), 6 price increases in the last 2.5 years" (Capterra) snippet; trust-account bank change unresolved after 20+ days (6 Oct 2025); subscription cancelled without warning, then told to reset "hundreds of owner PAD agreements" (1 Oct 2026); "If you are accounting software I would like to see the entire deposit" (25 Sep 2026); "contacting support is unreliable" (29 Sep 2026); "not well suited to larger companies" (23 Sep 2026); "we started using the inspection reports but now there will be a charge" (Slashdot); auto-reconciliation "just stopped working" after renewal (Oct 2022)
DoorLoop	Software Advice and third-party reviews snippet	Published prices; widest Zapier surface (36 operations) of any PM tool in scope	"some users report problems with deleting leases, moving tenants between units, and handling complex lease terms"; "accounting depth lacking for complex financial management" secondary; third parties disagree on Starter terms ($59 for 20 units vs DoorLoop's own $99 for 10)
Rent Manager	No reachable reviews beyond aggregators	Scalable, call centre and phone add-ons vendor	"outdated-looking interface and a learning curve for larger teams" secondary

Platform	Rating and base	Praise (dated)	Complaint (dated)
Reapit	Trustpilot 3.2 from 119 (15% one-star, UK and Australia mixed); AllAgents 63 reviews, 81% recommend snippet; Kerfuffle 4.8 from 196 snippet	"the industry standard for larger independents" (AllAgents) snippet; enterprise scalability and custom apps via Foundations secondary	"they can raise your monthly fees without so much as a phone call", three-year contract hard to end, Outlook incompatibility blocking template emails to tenants (28 Jul 2026); "I was provided with what was essentially an empty CRM", about $400/month started immediately (31 Jul 2026); "Signing up to Reapit and Payprop was a mistake", support "deflects to other departments" (25 Mar 2026); "Response times are consistently slow" (27 Apr 2026); "the platform still feels well behind where a modern real estate CRM should be" (9 Sep 2026); direct debits after cancelling (19 Feb 2026); "the worst API we have ever implemented" (AllAgents) snippet; "corrupted data records" sponsored
Alto	Trustpilot 4.5 from 206 (15% one-star)	MRR up 22% and "over 6,000 agents" (Jul 2025); Jupix-to-Alto tool "saves agents 27 hours on average" (2022, pilot of 13); onboarding and migration included sponsored	"the software is very poor and slow", a multi-property record takes "around a minute" to load, support is "someone emailing you instructions and no actual help" (6 Oct 2026); "it can take weeks to receive a response", "Data was transferred incorrectly" on the Reapit migration and the firm went back to Reapit (14 Apr 2026); migration "supposedly one of their most common, straightforward migrations" went wrong, "leads not coming through from portals" (9 Apr and 28 Sep 2026); Alto's reply: the migration "didn't run as smoothly as it should have"
Street.co.uk	Kerfuffle 4.9 from 22; vendor cites 419 Google reviews at 5.0; no Trustpilot or AllAgents presence sponsored	Published per-property price and unlimited users; "the best AI CRM" per its own blog vendor	"only negatives I can say is a little more prewarning on price increases" and "some of the elements are a little clunky/overcomplicated" (Nick Cheshire, Nest in Essex, about a year ago)
Goodlord	Trustpilot 4.4 from 45,020 (81% five-star, 5% one-star)	Volume: 1m+ references; LRG software tie-up snippet	"Currently being harassed on a daily basis for money that we do not owe" (tenant, 8 Oct 2026); "had to take too much of my time for a simple referencing process" (6 Oct 2026); automated checks "failed every category" with a generic disclaimer (6 Oct 2026); "I would like to recall and change my reference but no option to do so" (landlord, 16 Aug 2026); "AI bot just keeps asking me over and over to upload my documents"; referencing report "clashed with their Rent Guarantee Insurance policy requirements"
Fixflo	Trustpilot 4.0 from 239 (19% one-star)	"Over 2,000 agencies", 150,000+ repairs a month vendor	£600 lock-barrel change with "£400 call-out ... extortionate" and no estimate (landlord, 24 Jul 2026); package reduction "removed their CRM integration", restoring it required "a new 12-month contract", "Phone calls went unanswered, managers failed to take ownership" (5 Aug 2026); "it auto renews annually without any ability to cancel in year without paying for the full year" (13 May 2026); "The MI reporting is not especially intuitive" (7 Jul 2026)
Arthur	Trustpilot 3.5 from 538 (11% one-star); Capterra UK 3.9 from 16 snippet	Published prices; Zapier and Xero integrations (paid)	"unable to use the system due to ongoing issues with the Xero integration" (14 Jan 2026); "The client onboarding is non-existent, and sadly the ongoing support is abysmal", "riddled with glitches" (12 Apr 2026); tickets only, no early termination (13 May 2026); tenancy agreement types "weren't updated for the Renters Reform Bill" (19 May 2026); "charged twice for one reference" (16 Jul 2026); platform "not working for weeks" (30 Jul 2024); "can be costly unless you manage dozens of units" snippet
PayProp	Capterra UK 4.5 from 13 snippet; Trustpilot 2.5 from 4	1,300+ UK agencies, £2.6bn processed vendor; published licence and setup prices	"Signing up to Reapit and Payprop was a mistake" (Reapit Trustpilot, 25 Mar 2026); "not a full front-office leasing suite"; "buyers still need to plan setup work for a multi-system stack" secondary

Table 8.1 Platforms, part 2: what it does not do, sources

Platform	What it does not do	Sources
Follow Up Boss	No IDX site, no complete transaction management, no payments, no lead generation; support 8am-8pm ET, no live chat; AI call summaries skip transferred calls	G2 [395] snippet; Trustpilot FUB [396]; Capterra FUB [305] snippet; Tomba [355] secondary; The Close [304] secondary
BoldTrail (kvCORE)	Publishes no price; Zapier limited to 4 operations with a 15-minute lead delay; vanity domain extra; data may not leave with the agent	Capterra BoldTrail [308] snippet; G2 BoldTrail [397] snippet; AI Tools Bakery [307] secondary; Espo.ai [398] competitor
Lofty (Chime)	Every price is "Request Pricing"; 20% ad-management fee; lead counts "not guaranteed"; contract term not stated	BBB Lofty [311] user; Capterra Lofty [399] snippet; Software Advice [312] snippet; Lofty pricing [310] vendor
BoomTown	Single $1,000 plan; triggers fire only for assigned leads; one Zapier action	GetApp BoomTown [400] snippet; Capterra UK [401] snippet; AI Tools Bakery [307] secondary

Platform	What it does not do	Sources
AppFolio	No public price, 50-unit minimum; no Zapier; API only on Plus (read) and Max (write); phone support by appointment; no native QuickBooks; "Can't use AI for reporting"	Trustpilot AppFolio [319] user, 2026; Capterra AppFolio [394] snippet; Software Connect [201] secondary; AppFolio pricing [317]
Buildium	Fee stack (EFT, bank accounts, eSignature, inspections, 1099s); ticket-only support on Essential; Open API and automations on Premium only; no Zapier	Trustpilot Buildium [322] user; Capterra Buildium [321] snippet; Slashdot [402] snippet; ComplaintsBoard [323]; Buildium pricing [320]
DoorLoop	Zapier and API only on Premium; onboarding fee unstated; AI add-on unpriced	Software Advice DoorLoop [328] snippet; AmeriSave guide [403] secondary; TurboTenant [404] competitor; DoorLoop pricing [326]
Rent Manager	Quote only; texting and AI summaries need paid phone subscriptions	Rent Manager pricing [324] vendor; SoftwareWorld [325] secondary
Reapit	No block management; no certificate renewal automation sponsored; reporting needs set-up; full accounting chargeable on lower tiers sponsored; 12-36 month terms	Trustpilot Reapit [333] user, 2026; AllAgents [331] snippet; Letting Agent Today [332] sponsored; Superb Digital [338] secondary
Alto	No public price; "Works best for Zoopla-aligned agencies"; "basic lettings support; fewer integrations" secondary	Trustpilot Alto [336] user, 2026; Estate Agent Today, Jul 2025 [405]; Property Industry Eye, 30 Aug 2022 [406]; TradePick [335] secondary
Street.co.uk	No block management; certificate alerts only; basic reporting; cost rises with stock; "better suited to sales than lettings" secondary	Kerfuffle Street [337] user; Street demo [407] vendor; Letting Agent Today [332] sponsored; Property Webmasters [408] secondary
Goodlord	No public price; hard to reach a human	Trustpilot Goodlord [340] user, 2026; Trustpilot Goodlord p.7 [409] snippet
Fixflo	Contractor appointment and pricing are the agent's, not Fixflo's; 50-property minimum; four Zapier operations	Trustpilot Fixflo [343] user, 2026; Fixflo [391] vendor
Arthur	Integrations all "subject to additional fees"; annual billing	Trustpilot Arthur [345] user; Capterra UK Arthur [410] snippet
PayProp	Client accounting only; no CRM or listing syndication	PayProp [411] vendor; RFP.wiki [347] secondary; Trustpilot Reapit [333] user

Seven gaps recur across all three groups

- **Price opacity and contract lock-in**: AppFolio, Rent Manager, BoldTrail, Lofty, BoomTown, Reapit, Alto, Jupix, Goodlord and SME Professional publish no price; the vendors with the most one-star complaints about contracts (Reapit, Fixflo, Lofty, BoomTown) run 12-month to three-year terms with auto-renewal (BBB Lofty [311]; Trustpilot Reapit [333]; Trustpilot Fixflo [343] user, 2026).
- **Post-setup validation**: nobody checks that routing fires, campaigns send, feeds deliver, statements tie out and compliance dates are complete; every 'configured but not working' review is a failure a periodic audit would have caught.
- **Dirty data on import**: duplicates and dead emails in Follow Up Boss, duplicate imports and misposting in AppFolio, 'corrupted data records' in Reapit, 'fake' leads in Real Geeks; pre-migration cleanup is the one step every source treats as the time sink and none of the vendors prices (Tomba [355] secondary; WPM [412]; Capterra NZ Real Geeks [413] snippet).
- **Tier-gated integration**: AppFolio, Buildium, DoorLoop and Propertyware put the API behind the top tier or a per-unit surcharge, so the firms small enough to need help cannot connect anything.
- **A reporting ceiling** at standard dashboards, named by users for Sierra, Street, Fixflo, Yardi Breeze, Propertyware, Jupix and AppFolio.
- **Compliance tracked as alerts rather than workflows** (Reapit and Street certificate handling, Arthur's outdated templates, AppFolio's unreadable insurance uploads) at the moment the UK has added the heaviest statutory calendar in a generation.
- **Support that is ticket-only or 'by appointment' at the tiers small firms buy** (Buildium Essential, AppFolio, Arthur, Follow Up Boss without live chat, Sierra by ticket and business hours) (Buildium pricing [320]; Software Connect AppFolio [201] secondary; The Close [304] secondary).
- The phrases 'we only use it as an address book', 'leads go into a black hole' and 'nobody updates the pipeline' were not found verbatim in any reachable source; the closest practitioner language is 'an expensive, outdated contact list' (Be Epic [354] vendor) and 'if every agent updates their CRM only when the team leader asks, the data is always stale' (Realatic [414] secondary, India).

SECTION 9

Thirteen service gaps, ranked by problem signal and vendor weakness

Each gap is scored on how strong and recent the problem signal is (regulator findings, fraud data, dated user complaints, job-ad and freelance demand, search phrases) and how weak the vendor coverage is (whether a named product claims to solve the exact sub-problem and whether any independent source confirms it). A third column marks fit with a self-hosted or private-data angle, strongest where the work touches tenant, client or financial records that regulators say the firm must control and that staff today paste into free tools. The report describes existing products factually and does not design or recommend solutions.

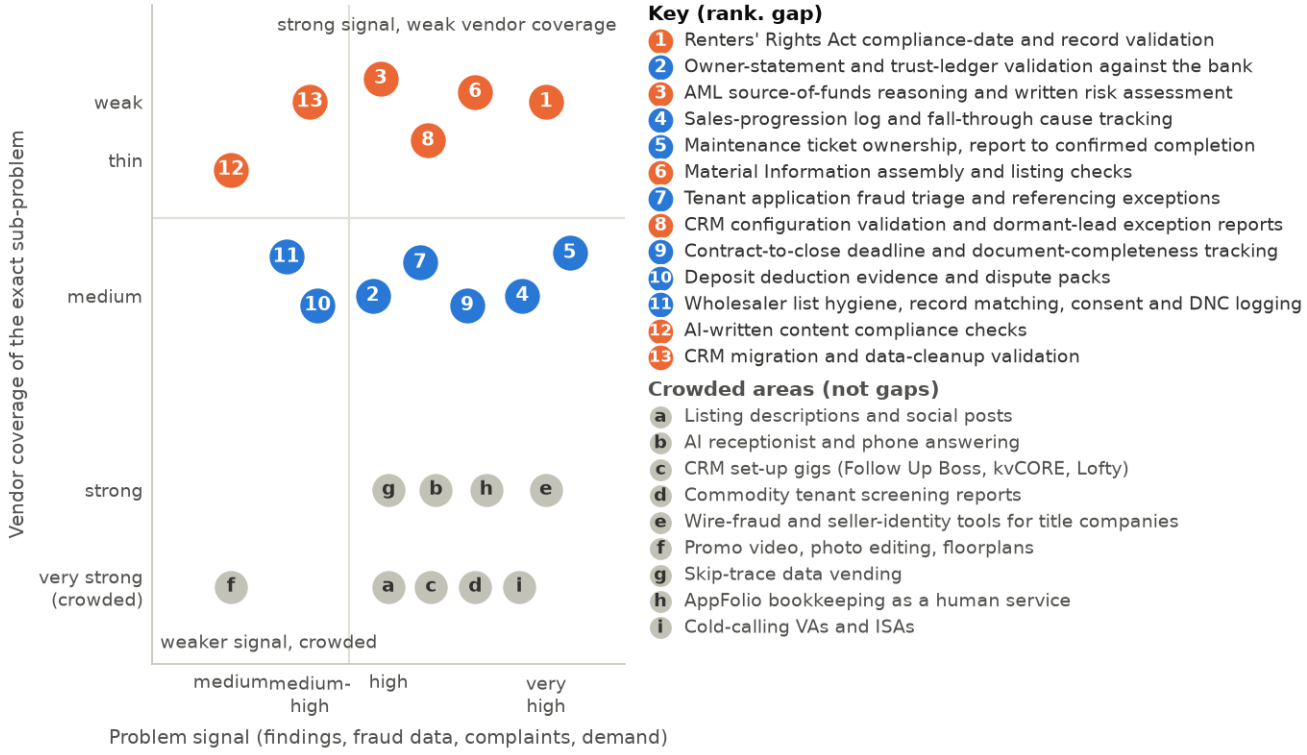
Table 9.1 The ranking, with the nine crowded problems at the end

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage of the exact sub-problem	Self-hosted / private-data fit	Country	Automatable
1	Renters' Rights Act compliance-date and record validation (certificates, notices, deposits, pets, rent reviews, database)	Very high: 73% more admin, 61% re-keying, complaints +47%, first agent fine Oct 2026, £7,000-£40,000 penalties, "compliance workload increase" in autocomplete	Weak: CRMs described as "certificate alerts only" (sponsored source), Arthur templates out of date, Goodlord flow-only; no evidence-based renewal workflow documented	Strongest (tenant data, certificates, notices)	UK	Fully for detection and exception lists; actions and liability human
2	Owner-statement and trust-ledger validation against the bank (AppFolio, Buildium)	High: bookkeepers' error lists, "discover trust account issues only after an owner questions a statement", AppFolio 2.0 Trustpilot, state three-way reconciliation duty	Medium: human bookkeeping priced at $34-$45/hour; no vendor sells continuous automated exception detection; API gated to top tiers	Strong (financial ledgers, owner PII)	US (UK client accounting similar)	Partly: detection automatable; corrections and broker sign-off human
3	AML source-of-funds reasoning and written risk assessment on file	High: 170 fines in six months, 96% want guidance on source of funds, 57.7% of checks red-flagged, July 2026 guidance requires documented rationale, 64% still manual	Weak on the reasoning: Thirdfort, Credas, SmartSearch, Alto stop at the ID and screening result	Strongest (bank statements, ID)	UK	Partly: extraction and draft rationale; nominated officer's judgment human
4	Sales-progression log and fall-through cause tracking	Very high: 123 days to exchange, 23.7% fall-through at £3,550, 2 hours a day of chasers per conveyancer, "Without the log, every fall-through just feels like bad luck", "sales progression software" searches	Medium: CRM modules and outsourcers track but none claims to reduce; one of 20 swept sites has a client portal	Medium (chain data lives in email and calls)	UK	Partly: log building, stall flags, chaser drafts; calls and chain negotiation human
5	Maintenance ticket ownership from report to confirmed completion	Very high: Oct 2026 forum threads, 56% of owners hire for maintenance, 52% of UK landlords' top time sink, Fixflo and Martin & Co reviews, Awaab's Law consultation	Medium: Fixflo, Property Meld, portals log the request; triage, approval and close-out sit with the agent by the vendor's own reply	Medium (tenant data, photos, invoices)	UK and US	Partly: intake, routing, matching, next-step messages; emergency and contractor decisions human
6	Material Information assembly and listing checks (Parts A-C)	High: 96.7% feel unsupported, 46% use withdrawn guidance, DMCC fines up to £300,000 or 10% of turnover, "quasi-lawyers", sales packs coming	Weak: no CRM in scope claims to assemble or validate Material Information from documents	Strong (title registers, leases, seller questionnaires)	UK	Partly: extraction and gap list; legal interpretation and liability human

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage of the exact sub-problem	Self-hosted / private-data fit	Country	Automatable
7	Tenant application fraud triage and referencing exception handling	High: UK fraud +40% with AI identities, £9,601 per case; US 6.4% fraudulent; reviews of rigid auto-fails and four-week delays; share-code failures	Medium: enterprise forensics (Snappt, Findigs) sold to Yardi/RealPage portfolios; small firms get the report plus manual payslip checks; auto-decisions with no override	Strong (ID, payslips, bank statements)	UK and US	Partly: document consistency and status tracking; consent gates, manual checks and FCRA or RRA decisions human
8	CRM configuration validation and dormant-lead exception reports	High: 46% CRM use, "840-850 leads sitting dormant", "no lead falls through the cracks" in three posts, "campaigns not triggering", satisfaction 3.7 to 3.2 stars	Weak: 1,160 Fiverr set-up gigs and VAs, no audit methodology, no vendor utilisation statistics	Medium (lead PII, TCPA consent logs)	US	Fully for detection; cadence and routing decisions human
9	Contract-to-close deadline and document-completeness tracking across systems	High: "biggest bleed", 14% delayed and 5-7% terminated, 20-30 dates per contract, dotloop "MLS data not populating", a buyer paying $160 to "confirm completeness and accuracy" of PDFs	Medium: TC checklists, Transact, SkySlope, dotloop; none checks the documents themselves across systems	Medium-strong (executed contracts, client PII)	US	Partly: date extraction, signature and figure checks, reminders; negotiation and wire call-back human
10	Deposit deduction evidence and dispute packs	Medium-high: cleaning 54% and damage 49% of UK disputes, tenants using ChatGPT to challenge, 14-60 day US windows with 2-3x penalties	Medium: inventory services and scheme adjudication; no evidence-matching product in the notes	Medium (photos of homes, tenant data)	UK and US	Partly: photo pairing, itemised schedules, deadlines; inspection and fair-wear judgment human
11	Wholesaler list hygiene, record matching and consent or DNC logging	Medium-high: 70% bad numbers, "dead names most expensive", filings with wrong names and unit numbers, TCPA $500-$1,500 per violation, 298 OnlineJobs posts	Medium: PropStream, BatchLeads, Goliath offer DNC flagging; no published match accuracy; consent provenance only as CRM tags	Low-medium (public records plus PII)	US	Partly: entity resolution, staleness checks, consent logs; dialling human unless consented
12	AI-written content compliance checks (fair-housing wording, Material Information accuracy, photo disclosure)	Medium: 75% of AI users write listing copy, buyer backlash, MLS and California rules, UK portal removals, NAR "not straight from prompt to publication"; no enforcement case yet	Thin on checking (checklists only) though crowded on generation	Medium (listing drafts, source documents)	US and UK	Fully for the check; publication sign-off human and liable
13	CRM migration and data-cleanup validation	Medium-high: "Data was transferred incorrectly", "essentially an empty CRM", Jupix-to-Alto cohort 2026-27, LionDesk shutdown, "Importing a messy database is where teams lose weeks"	Weak: Zoopla tool covers Jupix-to-Alto only; vendor migration teams; no independent UK validator	Medium (whole agency database)	UK and US	Largely for validation; contract and vendor decisions human
crowded	Listing descriptions and social posts	High use (75% of AI users)	Very strong: ChatGPT, generators, $15-$40 gigs	Low	both	automated already
crowded	AI receptionist and phone answering	High: stable search phrase both sides	Strong: many vendors; Charisma's "Jane"; vendor-adjacent caveats about hang-ups	Low	both	automated, quality disputed
crowded	CRM set-up gigs (Follow Up Boss, kvCORE, Lofty)	High	Very strong: about 1,160 Fiverr gigs, Upwork $20-$399, 50+ bidders	Low	US	commodity
crowded	Commodity tenant screening reports	High	Very strong: TransUnion, Experian via SmartMove, RentSpree, Buildium, Zillow at $17-$49 same day	Low	US	automated

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage of the exact sub-problem	Self-hosted / private-data fit	Country	Automatable
crowded	Wire-fraud and seller-identity tools for title companies	Very high problem, but the tools exist	Strong: CertifID, Qualia Shield, FNF ionFraud, insured wires; the brokerage's role is the call-back, which law and practice keep human	Low for a brokerage	US	procedural
crowded	Promo video, photo editing, floorplans	Medium	Very strong: 694-1,045 feedback gigs	Low	both	commodity
crowded	Skip-trace data vending	High	Strong: PropStream, BatchLeads, REISkip, Skip Genie	Low	US	commodity
crowded	AppFolio bookkeeping as a human service	High	Strong: OJO, PM Bookkeeper, WPM and others at $34-$45/hour; the automated exception layer is gap 2	Medium	US	human service market
crowded	Cold-calling VAs and ISAs	High	Very strong: 292 OnlineJobs posts, MyOutDesk, $3-$7/hour	Low	US	human service market

Gap map: the thirteen gaps placed by problem signal against vendor weakness, using the report's own ranking words; nine crowded areas in grey



Positions follow the wording of the ranking table in section 9 (very high / high / medium-high / medium signal; weak / thin / medium / strong / very strong coverage), not measured scores. Warm = coverage weak or thin; blue = medium coverage; grey letters = the nine crowded areas the report says are not gaps.

The thirteen gap cards

Every card has the same eight fields in the same order. The three badges summarise the ranking table: problem signal (strong = very high or high), vendor coverage (weak = weak, thin or unknown; partial = medium), and the report's own word on automation (fully, largely, partly).

1 Renters' Rights Act compliance-date and record validation — UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** fully

Problem	Since 1 May 2026 every managed tenancy in England carries a dated set of duties: an advertised rent with no bidding, written terms with no end date, no more than one month's rent before signing, the deposit protected within 30 days with prescribed information, the government information sheet to every named tenant by 31 May 2026, pet requests answered within 28 days, one rent rise a year on Form 4A with two months' notice, annual gas and five-yearly electrical certificates, EPC at E or better, Right to Rent follow-up checks, and from December 2026 a database registration number in every advert with certificates "scanned and uploaded manually". The CRMs raise alerts; nobody checks that the item was done, by whom, with what evidence, and staff re-type the data between systems. A missed item is a £3,000-£7,000 council fine, up to £40,000 for repeat breaches, and councils may enter a letting business without notice.
Who has it	UK (England) letting agents and property managers of one to three branches (median agency five or fewer staff, 340 managed properties); self-managing portfolio landlords (62% of a 525-landlord sample own six or more); block managers; agencies in Wales and Scotland under their own licensing regimes. Lettings and management lines of business.
Evidence	73% report more administration, two-thirds run "several disconnected systems", 61% "transfer, re-enter or duplicate information between systems during a tenancy" (Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026 [7] vendor survey); 62.5% more time on compliance (Property Reporter, 4 Sep 2026 [32]); complaints +47.4% (Property Industry Eye, 12 Jun 2026 [8]); TPO lettings disputes +65% (Propertymark, 13 Mar 2026 [33]); Chesterfield agent fined £8,652 for a six-month term (LandlordZONE, 2 Oct 2026 [157]); penalty schedule (Anthony Collins, 17 Dec 2025 [152]); "A reminder being sent is not the same as the work being completed" (Property Industry Eye, 28 Sep 2026 [162]); certificates "fall outside digitisation plans" (Property Industry Eye, 5 Oct 2026 [44]); Reapit "No certificate renewal automation live or announced", Street "Certificate alerts only" (Letting Agent Today, Aug 2026 [332] sponsored); Arthur templates "weren't updated for the Renters Reform Bill" (Trustpilot Arthur [345] user, 19 May 2026); 34% of landlords use an agent mainly to stay compliant (Goodlord SOLI 2025 [29] vendor); 66% of agents expect to rely on compliance and AML automation (Property Industry Eye, 16 Jan 2026 [248] vendor survey); a UK landlord pays $5 an hour for "an auditable property-management system" showing "what needed doing, what was done, when, by whom and the supporting evidence" (OnlineJobs.ph 1731573 [90]).
Their words	"renters rights act compliance checklist", "renters rights act agency workload", "letting agents compliance workload increase", "renters rights act information sheet 2026", "renters rights act section 8 ground 1a", "section 13 notice form 4a", "renters rights act pets", "renters rights act prs database", "letting agent compliance fee", "letting agent enforcement order" (autocomplete); "Monitor compliance tasks and arrange inspection Gas/EPC/electrical as and when due", "Track and book safety certificate renewals (gas, electrical, fire safety, EPCs, licences)", "every task is evidenced and checked", "Oversee safety certifications, deposit protection, and right-to-rent compliance", "Monitor changes, including Renters' Rights Act processes and government rental-property registration" (job posts); "outsourcing the job doesn't automatically mean you've outsourced the risk", "a costly mess", "and an end to fees paid to agents to renew the fixed term!!" (trade press and comments).
How they handle it today	Certificate alerts inside Reapit, Alto or Street; Goodlord's tenancy flow; spreadsheets and email (17% rely on them); one-off PDF mail-outs by post or attachment; NRLA and Propertymark templates and courses; offshore coordinators at £4.50-£5 an hour or $700-$850 a month "chasing unresponsive contacts through multiple channels until resolved"; a daily "summary email of completed and ongoing tasks, including anything unresolved and why".
Vendors already covering it	Reapit, Alto (Alto Intelligence "five AI capabilities" vendor), Street (per-property pricing), Jupix, agentOS: CRMs with certificate fields and alerts; Goodlord: "40+" compliance steps automated inside the tenancy flow and "80%" admin saved vendor, with reviews of auto-fails and bot loops; Arthur: lettings management with templates reported out of date user; Fixflo: repairs only; PayProp: client money only; inventory firms: condition reports. The only source naming the alert-versus-workflow gap is a rival's sponsored comparison, so it needs independent confirmation; no vendor documents an end-to-end renewal workflow with evidence capture and an owner.
Automatable?	Fully for the detection layer: a scheduled export or API pull of tenancies, properties, certificates, notices, deposits and dates from the agency's own systems into a store the agency controls, rules per statutory duty (certificate present, dated, matching the property; information sheet delivered to every named tenant; pet request older than 28 days unanswered; Form 4A within the last 12 months; deposit protected within 30 days of receipt), and an exception list by owner. Not automatable: the engineer's visit, the manual Right to Rent check with the holder present, the decision on a pet request or a rent review, serving a notice; the agent or landlord remains liable whatever tool is used.

What the reader would need to learn	The Act's Phase 1-3 calendar and the civil-penalty schedule; the Right to Rent code (1 Oct 2026 version); deposit-scheme rules and prescribed information; gas, EICR, EPC and HMO rules; how Reapit (Foundations), Alto, Street, Arthur (Zapier at extra cost) and Goodlord export data (most publish no API; CSV exports); document extraction from certificates (dates, addresses, engineer registration numbers); UK GDPR for tenant data; Scotland's and Wales's separate regimes; how to verify the sponsored comparison against the vendors themselves.

2 Owner-statement and trust-ledger validation against the bank

US (UK client accounting similar)

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Small US property managers must deposit client money within one to two banking days, reconcile bank, client ledger and journal monthly, and send each owner a statement; the broker of record is liable. The software lets the bank reconciliation pass while owner statements are wrong (a payment posted to the wrong property, an unapplied credit, a duplicate import, a miscoded deposit), and the error is found "only after an owner questions a statement". Owner and vendor payments sit in a 3-5 day window; deposits are netted; API access is gated to the top tier.
Who has it	US small property-management companies of 50 to 1,500 units on AppFolio (8 of 23 swept small managers), Buildium, Rent Manager, Propertyware, Yardi Breeze or DoorLoop; brokers of record; small landlords with 10-12 units who hire a bookkeeping-plus-PM assistant. UK letting agents with client accounts (PayProp, Reapit) have the same shape of problem. Property-management line of business.
Evidence	Error list and the "$3,200 vendor payment entered against the wrong property" case (WPM Accounting [202]); "Misposted invoices", "Unapplied tenant credits", "Trust accounts that drift out of balance", "Skipped monthly trust reconciliations", "Owner statements that don't match the bank balance" (OJO Bookkeeping [357]); an owner "went months without a fix to their reconciliation problem" (Capterra AppFolio [394] snippet); "3-5 day window" the biggest complaint and no native QuickBooks (Software Connect [201] secondary); Buildium auto-reconciliation "just stopped working" and deposits netted (ComplaintsBoard [323]; Trustpilot Buildium [322] user, 25 Sep 2026); state trust rules and monthly three-way reconciliation (Hemlane [180]); "If you can't tell what you paid for, you can't tell whether the month was expensive or just opaque" (BiggerPockets 1302340 [392] user, Oct 2026); 1099-MISC to owners over $2,000 (IRS [200]); UK parallel: "countless hours chasing money due to financial errors" (Trustpilot Martin & Co [390] user, 2026) and TPO expulsions for delayed deposit and rent transfers (Letting Agent Today, 9 Oct 2026 [393]).
Their words	"owner statements that don't match the bank balance", "unapplied tenant credits", "trust accounts that drift out of balance", "skipped monthly trust reconciliations", "misposted invoices", "security deposit liabilities miscoded", "A lump-sum line is where padding hides", "No NET rental deposits when expected", "I would like to see the entire deposit"; job posts: "Full-Time Bookkeeper with AppFolio Experience", "AppFolio & Realm-X Workflow Automation Expert Needed for 250-Unit Portfolio", "Reconciling bank account daily transactions on the property management software", "Owner-Ready Financials"; search: "property management bookkeeping software", "property management bookkeeping in qbo", "property management bookkeeping template", "real estate bookkeeping spreadsheet", "appfolio bookkeeping".
How they handle it today	Monthly reconciliation by the office manager; outside bookkeepers at $34 an hour ongoing and $45 for cleanup with a $300 monthly minimum, per-unit retainers, or flat quotes at 500 and 1,000 units, each opened with a free "health check"; offshore AppFolio bookkeepers at $6-$10 an hour (51 approved profiles on one directory, median $7) or $25 an hour part time on Upwork; Plaid auto-reconciliation that took one reviewer "two months" to make work.
Vendors already covering it	AppFolio (bank feeds, Plaid auto-reconciliation, owner statements; API read-only on Plus, read and write on Max) vendor; Buildium (reports on Growth and above, Open API on Premium) vendor; DoorLoop (QuickBooks sync on Pro, 36 Zapier operations on Premium) vendor; Propertyware and Yardi Breeze (per-unit, limited reporting secondary); PayProp UK ("100% accurate totals" vendor); human services: OJO, appfoliobookkeeping.com, PM Bookkeeper, Balanced Asset Solutions, WPM. None sells continuous automated detection of statement-to-ledger-to-bank exceptions; the bookkeepers' free health check is the closest thing to an audit product.
Automatable?	Partly. Detection (duplicate entries, wrong-property postings, unapplied credits, timing differences, statement-to-bank tie-out per owner, deposit-liability coding, 1099 threshold checks) is rule-based work on exported ledgers and bank files and can run inside the firm; because the APIs are tier-gated, exports and CSVs are the realistic input for a Core or Essential customer. The correcting entries, the owner conversation and the broker's monthly sign-off are human and regulated.
What the reader would need to learn	Trust-account rules by state (deposit clocks, three-way reconciliation, record retention); NARPM's chart of accounts and designations; AppFolio and Buildium data models, report exports and API tiers; the five error types the bookkeeping firms list; 1099-MISC and 1099-NEC thresholds and dates; QuickBooks structures; how PayProp and Reapit handle UK client accounts; basic accounting controls language for a broker of record.

3 AML source-of-funds reasoning and written risk assessment on file

UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	HMRC's July 2026 guidance requires customer due diligence on every party to a sale, source-of-funds work that documents "both the steps taken and the rationale for their conclusions", an up-to-date written risk assessment covering money laundering, terrorist financing and proliferation financing, and extra care with cash buyers; the ID and screening tools return a pass or a flag and stop there. More than half of source-of-funds checks carry a red flag that triggers enhanced due diligence, two-thirds of agents still do some manual document checks, and single-branch agents say they cannot recover the cost and want "more prescriptive guidance" on beneficial owners and sources of funds.
Who has it	UK estate agencies (sales) of one to three branches, which must register with HMRC before trading; letting agents for tenancies at €10,000 a month or more and, from 14 May 2025, for sanctions screening on every tenant and landlord; conveyancers repeat the checks on the same buyer. Sales line of business mainly.
Evidence	Guidance duties and "reliance on a third party does not reduce" responsibility (Devonshires, 7 Oct 2026 [136]); 170 penalties, £835,842, 332 of 369 for unregistered trading (Comsure [13]); 96% want more prescriptive guidance on beneficial owners and sources of funds, 92% call the fee rise unreasonable (Propertymark, 15 Sep 2025 [43]); 57.7% of 415,000+ checks red-flagged, averaging two flags (Property Industry Eye, 19 Mar 2026 [143] vendor data); 79% use digital ID, 64% still manual, 63% recharge clients, about £16,000 a year on compliance (Property Reporter, 23 Jul 2025 [234] vendor survey); 2022 round with the largest fine for failing to register (Property Industry Eye, 12 Oct 2022 [232]); sanctions duty from 14 May 2025 (OFSI [147]); Thirdfort "17 hours" average remote ID and recharge prices (Thirdfort [276] vendor); reviews of Thirdfort, Credas and SmartSearch (Trustpilot Credas [282] user, 2026).
Their words	"source of funds", "proof of funds", "proceedable", "beneficial owners", "risk assessment", "enhanced due diligence", "red flag", "cash buyers", "the rationale for their conclusions", "Letting agents cannot recover compliance costs through tenant fees", "a bit of a faff", "This has 'GDPR breach' written all over it"; search: "estate agency aml risk assessment", "estate agent aml policy", "estate agent aml registration", "hmrc aml checks for estate agents", "aml checks estate agents cost", "what aml checks do estate agents do", "estate agent aml checks reddit", "letting agent aml compliance".
How they handle it today	A Thirdfort, Credas, SmartSearch or Alto-embedded ID and PEP check recharged to the client at £5-£30; the buyer emails bank statements and a mortgage in principle; a negotiator reads them and files a note; the firm's risk assessment is a template; compliance consultancies run webinars that generate "a considerable number of follow-up questions"; agents refuse to mark a property sold until the buyer is proven proceedable.
Vendors already covering it	Thirdfort (ID with NFC, PEP and sanctions, source of funds from bank statements, lettings sanctions screening; platform fee plus credits on 12-month contracts) vendor; Credas (ID, AML, Right to Rent, open-banking source of funds, payments to recharge clients) vendor; SmartSearch (screening with ongoing monitoring; three-year lock-in complaints) user; Alto built-in AML at £4.50-£7 snippet; Yoti and Post Office (certified identity provider) vendor; compliance consultancies (unpriced). None documents producing the written source-of-funds rationale or the firm-level risk assessment HMRC inspects.
Automatable?	Partly, with a mandatory human step. Extracting deposits, salary credits, gifts, sale proceeds and transfers from statements, comparing them with the stated source and the price, and drafting the rationale against HMRC's own prompts (did the source change mid-transaction, gifted deposit, last-minute mortgage change, proportionality to income) can run on the firm's own documents; the nominated officer's judgment, the decision to file a suspicious activity report, and compliance itself cannot be delegated ("reliance on a third party does not reduce it"), and digital identity may only be relied on from DVS-register providers.
What the reader would need to learn	The Money Laundering Regulations 2017 as amended on 30 June 2026 and the 8 July 2026 HMRC estate-agency guidance (primary text was not fetched; read it); OFSI sanctions duties for letting agents; Land Registry Practice Guide 81 and the ID1 rule to understand why checks repeat; the DVS register; open-banking consent and UK GDPR; Propertymark's proof-of-name, proof-of-address and source-of-funds lists; bank-statement parsing; the red-flag taxonomies vendors publish.

4 Sales-progression log and fall-through cause tracking — UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Between sale agreed and exchange (123 days) the agent's work is chasing solicitors, lenders, surveyors, search providers, management-pack suppliers and the other agents in the chain, keeping the seller updated, and spotting the stall before it becomes a fall-through; the history lives in phone calls and email threads, conveyancers say the chasers cost them two hours a day, and when a sale collapses nobody can say why: "Without the log, every fall-through just feels like bad luck". One in four agreed sales fails and the fee arrives only at completion.
Who has it	UK independent sales agencies of one to three branches (average fee £3,909, 11.2 instructions a branch a month), in-house and outsourced sales progressors carrying 150 to 250 cases, lettings-and-sales hybrids. Sales line of business; the same stall-tracking problem exists in UK lettings between offer and move-in.
Evidence	123 days sale agreed to exchange (Property Reporter, 15 Dec 2025 [14]); 154 and 216 days (Property Industry Eye, 31 Jul 2026 [1]); 23.7% fall-through, 38% within four weeks (Property Industry Eye, 17 Apr 2026 [2]); £3,550 each (Property Industry Eye, 10 Apr 2026 [3]); 60.8% over six months and "Searches, documentation, identification, source-of-funds information" to chase early (Property Industry Eye, 1 Oct 2026 [15]); conveyancers' two hours a day (Conveyancing Matters, 5 Sep 2024 [22]); 150-250 cases, franchise capped at 60 (Property Industry Eye, 24 Sep 2026 [23]); fall-through causes (HomeOwners Alliance [19] secondary); 82% of movers want survey, legal pack and chain details before offering (Property Industry Eye, 23 Sep 2026 [415]); sales progressor pay £19,000 to £43,000 (Reed [100]); one of 20 swept sites with a client portal (Bartlams [144]).
Their words	"sales progression", "progressing sales through to exchange and completion", "identify and resolve issues that could delay a transaction", "The ability to manage multiple sales and competing priorities", "chasing solicitors", "chain", "memorandum of sale", "searches", "management pack", "mortgage offer", "Most delays don't come out of nowhere", "Always the conveyancer who's either working from home or the monthly annual leave", "No other country operates with chains"; search: "sales progression software", "estate agent sales progression checklist", "outsourced sales progression for estate agents", "sales progression fee", "sales progression flow chart", "chasing conveyancing solicitors", "how to speed up conveyancing solicitors", "memorandum of sale how long does it take", "sale fell through", "do you pay estate agent if sale falls through".
How they handle it today	Negotiators and a sales progressor phone and email each party in turn and update the seller; CRM progression modules record milestones when someone types them; outsourced progression firms and a new franchise take the work for a fee; one agency gives sellers "your own personal portal to track progress, with daily updates and milestone alerts"; TwentyEA's "Project 28" campaigns for a 28-day exchange.
Vendors already covering it	Reapit, Alto, Street and Jupix progression modules (milestone tracking; reporting "needs setup" or "basic" sponsored and secondary); outsourced sales-progression companies and the franchise (Property Industry Eye, 24 Sep 2026 [23]); conveyancing-side portals; MHCLG's planned "homebuying sales packs" (National Trading Standards [239]). No product in scope claims to reduce fall-through; the UK offer-to-completion gap is non-binding until exchange, so modules only track it.
Automatable?	Partly. Building the log from emails, call notes and milestone dates, flagging stalls (no update in N days, search ordered but not returned, mortgage offer expiring, management pack outstanding), drafting chasers and seller updates, and recording the cause when a sale fails are document and timeline jobs that can run on the agency's own correspondence. The call to the solicitor, the negotiation across a chain and the decision to re-market are human, and conveyancers already push back on chaser volume.
What the reader would need to learn	The conveyancing sequence and typical waits (searches, mortgage offers, enquiries, management packs); Material Information and the memorandum of sale; how Reapit (Foundations), Alto and Street store progression data; email and call-note parsing; UK GDPR for client correspondence; the fall-through cause taxonomies in the trade press; what outsourced progressors charge (found only as a search phrase, "sales progression fee").

5 Maintenance ticket ownership from report to confirmed completion

UK and US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Repair requests arrive by text, call, email and app, often "casually", and are re-reported because nobody replied; "everybody saw the request but nobody actually owned it"; owner approval thresholds in the management agreement are "often not honored"; a verbal not-to-exceed starts an invoice dispute; "'Vendor says it's done' is not the same thing as closed"; the invoice arrives before anyone confirms the work; the tenant "calls again at midnight because nobody told them what the next step was"; UK landlords find repairs done "without my permission" or a £600 bill with no estimate; Awaab's Law timescales are about to apply to private landlords.
Who has it	US small property managers of 50 to 1,500 units (23 swept firms) and self-managing landlords; UK fully managed letting agents and portfolio landlords (52% name maintenance the most time-consuming task); block managers. Property-management and lettings-management lines of business, both countries.
Evidence	Forum threads on lost requests, handoffs, after-hours and paperwork (BiggerPockets 1303197 [9]; BiggerPockets 1302426 [215]; BiggerPockets 1302900 [194]; BiggerPockets 1303269 [388] user, Oct 2026); "Chasing owners down for repair approvals is outdated, inefficient" (PMAssist, 2 Sep 2025 [389]); thresholds "often not honored" (BiggerPockets 1302698 [181] user); 56% of owners hire a manager for maintenance (Buildium 2026 [60] vendor); 77% of UK self-managing landlords defer maintenance, 52% call it the biggest time sink (LandlordZONE, 23 Sep 2026 [35] vendor survey); Fixflo review and reply that pricing and appointment sit with the agent (Trustpilot Fixflo [343] user, 24 Jul 2026); "Repairs have been done in my flat without my permission" (Trustpilot Martin & Co [390] user, 2026); Awaab's Law PRS consultation (24 hours, 10 working days, 5 working days in the social template) (Property Industry Eye, 9 Oct 2026 [163]); Upwork posts for "intake to vendor dispatch to close out" and "flag delays before they become resident complaints" (Upwork jobs: property management VA [98]); vendor claims of 3-5 work orders per unit a year and 35-45% of staff time (My AI Front Desk [192] vendor, snippet; US Tech Automations [193] vendor, snippet, attribution unverified).
Their words	"maintenance requests", "work orders", "tickets", "vendor dispatch", "close out", "NTE", "owner approval", "after-hours", "decision fatigue", "any update?", "nobody told them what the next step was", "no photo doesn't mean no emergency", "If the invoice arrives before somebody confirms the work, leave that item open", "Chase every job to completion and close it out with photos and invoices", "Process and verify tenant repair reports", "Find and book tradespeople, get fixed quotes and arrange access", "Track vendor response time"; search: "maintenance request software", "work request software", "property management maintenance coordinator job description", "ai for property management companies", "estate agent not responding maintenance issues".
How they handle it today	A Fixflo, Property Meld, AppFolio or Rentvine portal where one exists (12 of 23 US sites; 7 of 20 UK sites) and a phone line where it does not; spreadsheets that "broke the first time i forgot to open it"; VAs at $5-$12 an hour or £4.50-£5 an hour; after-hours answering services or an AI bot; management agreements with a 48-hour owner-response clause; in-house crews at $75-$100 an hour against $150-$300 outside.
Vendors already covering it	Fixflo (repair reporting, works orders, out-of-hours triage, contractor marketplace; £75 a month plus quote, 50-property minimum; four Zapier operations; "MI reporting is not especially intuitive" user); Property Meld (inside AppFolio and small managers' sites); AppFolio, Buildium, Rentvine, DoorLoop work-order modules (DoorLoop exposes work-order triggers via Zapier on Premium); Reapit maintenance "within the CRM, not automated triage" sponsored; AI receptionists (Charisma's "Jane", My AI Front Desk) that take the call. By the vendors' own replies, triage, owner approval, contractor appointment, pricing and completion confirmation sit outside the software.
Automatable?	Partly. Normalising intake across channels, de-duplicating repeat reports, drafting a triage from the photo and description, routing approvals against the agreement threshold, capturing the not-to-exceed, reminding the contractor, matching the invoice to the original request and approved scope, sending the tenant the next step, and running Awaab's-Law clocks can be done inside the firm's own data. The emergency judgment ("no photo doesn't mean no emergency"), the contractor booking, the site visit and the owner's refusal remain human, and tenant texting is subject to consent rules.
What the reader would need to learn	Landlord repair duties in England (HHSRS, gas and electrical rules, Awaab's Law template) and US habitability basics by state; the work-order data models of AppFolio, Buildium, DoorLoop (Zapier) and Fixflo (API); Property Meld; SMS consent and 10DLC registration; photo intake and classification; invoice extraction; contractor certificate-of-insurance tracking; the management-agreement clauses that set thresholds.

6 Material Information assembly and listing checks UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Before a UK property can be advertised the agent must gather Part A (price or rent, council tax, tenure, lease length, ground rent, service charge), Part B (property type, construction, rooms, utilities, broadband, mobile signal, parking) and Part C (building safety, restrictions, rights and easements, flood risk, planning, accessibility, mining) and must not publish "price on application"; the guidance was withdrawn in 2025, the DMCC Act applies with fines of up to £300,000 or 10% of turnover, the CMA has issued no sector guidance, agents say they lack the legal knowledge, sellers "have forgotten the answers", and problems "only emerge after their offer has been accepted".
Who has it	UK sales agencies of one to three branches (Material Information also applies to lettings adverts); small lettings-and-sales hybrids; the 46% still working to the withdrawn guidance. Sales line of business mainly.
Evidence	96.7% underinformed, 40% unsure what to do, 63.1% government guidance insufficient (Property Industry Eye, 13 Jun 2025 [416] vendor survey); 46% use withdrawn guidance, DMCC fines (Bebeez [138] secondary); Property Lawyers Alliance submission and agent comments (Property Industry Eye, 23 Jan 2025 [242] user, Jan 2025); government consultation 6 Oct to 29 Dec 2025 (GOV.UK [243]); Parts A, B and C timing (iamproperty [137]); NTS enforcement tools and the June 2026 sales-pack plan (National Trading Standards [139]); portal removals of AI images (The Negotiator [244] snippet); 82% of movers want survey, legal pack and chain details before offering (Property Industry Eye, 23 Sep 2026 [415]).
Their words	"Material Information", "Parts A, B and C", "quasi-lawyers", "a fertile breeding ground for misrepresentation and other civil claims", "most will not have the legal knowledge to complete some of the Material Information", "vendors have forgotten the answers to many the 'additional enquiries'", "underinformed and unsupported", "unsure what to do", "price on application", "clear labelling is the bare minimum", "Creating property details", "particulars"; search: "material information checklist", "material information form", "material information examples", "material information part b", "material information parts b & c", "material information flow chart", "material information for estate agents", "national trading standards material information for property listings", "what documents do estate agents need".
How they handle it today	A seller questionnaire, a title register download, council tax and EPC lookups, broadband and mobile checkers, flood maps, copied by hand into CRM fields and the portal upload; the withdrawn NTSELAT checklist; Propertymark and RICS guidance; consultancy webinars; some firms recharge the cost.
Vendors already covering it	CRMs (Alto, Reapit, Street, Jupix) carry Material Information fields and portal feeds; Rightmove and Zoopla require the fields; iamproperty and RICS publish guidance; conveyancing-side "sales pack" proposals are government plans, not products. No CRM in scope claims to assemble Parts A-C from the seller's documents or to check a listing against them before publication.
Automatable?	Partly. Extracting the Part A, B and C facts from title registers, leases, EPCs, service-charge accounts and the seller questionnaire, producing a gap list and draft particulars, and checking the published listing against the source facts are document-extraction jobs on the agency's own files. Legal interpretation (restrictive covenants, lease terms, planning), verification with the seller or conveyancer, and the agent's liability under the DMCC Act and the CPRs remain human, and AI-written particulars and edited photos must be checked before publication.
What the reader would need to learn	The DMCC Act 2024 and the Consumer Protection from Unfair Trading Regulations 2008; the withdrawn NTSELAT Parts A-C lists (the notes' reconstruction is unverified; check against the NTS documents); Land Registry title registers and lease structures; EPC and council-tax data; flood, coal and planning data sources; Rightmove's real-time datafeed and portal field rules; UK GDPR; the MHCLG sales-pack proposals as they are published.

7 Tenant application fraud triage and referencing exception handling

UK and US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Fraudsters now "use AI to build entire false identities" with fabricated employers, manipulated ID and invented referees; UK suspected fraud rose about 40% in 2025 and costs £9,601 per fraudulent tenancy; 6.4% of US applications carry manipulated documents. The automated layer returns a pass, a fail or a "referred" in minutes, but the failures are rigid ("failed every category" with no override), the manual residue is slow (the same document requested four times, "4 weeks", "5 to 6 days of requests"), small US operators get the credit report and then check pay stubs and bank statements by hand, and the one-month advance cap has removed the "pay six months up front" fix.
Who has it	UK letting agents (41 flagged per 1,000 applications, London nearly double, homes over £10,000 a month 18 per 1,000 confirmed); US small property managers of 50 to 1,500 units and small landlords on TransUnion or Experian reports; room-by-room and HMO operators. Lettings and property-management lines of business, both countries.
Evidence	Goodlord fraud data (Property Reporter, 7 Aug 2026 [12] vendor data); "95% of fraud comes from income" (Goodlord blog, 3 Jun 2024 [417] vendor); Snappt 6.4% and methods (Multifamily Executive [222] vendor data); 72% and 67% of screening time on statements and pay stubs (NAR Commercial Insights [186]); 75% of managers saw more fraud (Buildium 2026 [60] vendor); reviews of Goodlord, Canopy, Homeppl, HomeLet, RentSpree, Credas, Thirdfort (Trustpilot Goodlord [271]; Trustpilot Canopy [272]; Trustpilot Homeppl [273]; Trustpilot RentSpree [387] user, 2026); Signal PM's seven business days and PDF-only uploads (Signal PM [187]); share-code failure modes (Davidson Morris [265]); Buildium "verify employment themselves" (Buildium screening [288] vendor); Snappt's own manual-step advice (Snappt, 6 Jan 2026 [229] vendor).
Their words	"referencing", "recommended", "referred", "declined", "guarantor", "right to rent share code", "failed every category", "no option to recall and change my reference", "asked for the same document four times", "difficulty tracking application progress", "screenshots are usually illegible", "two forms of identification", "fraudulent PDF creators", "text insertion", "font fail", "Fraudsters are no longer relying on a single forged payslip"; search: "tenant referencing how long does it take", "how long does tenant referencing take uk", "what happens if you fail tenant referencing", "why would you fail tenant referencing", "tenant referencing guarantor", "tenant referencing self employed", "how long does tenant screening take", "how long does rental background check take".
How they handle it today	A referencing package at £5 (Canopy) to £23-£40 (NRLA/Goodlord) with employer and landlord references done "manually" by the provider; a same-day TransUnion or Experian report at $17-$49; staff reading payslips and statements; employer calls on an independently found number; guarantors and rent-guarantee insurance; outside agencies that take "up to 7 business days"; the Landlord Checking Service when a share code fails.
Vendors already covering it	UK: Goodlord/Vouch, Canopy (document forensics "in about 15 seconds" vendor), HomeLet (fraud databases vendor), Homeppl (font, metadata and version-history analysis vendor), Let Alliance, Thirdfort, Credas, Yoti. US: TransUnion SmartMove, RentSpree, Buildium, Zillow, RentRedi for reports; Plaid and The Work Number for income; Snappt and Findigs for forensics and automated decisions, integrated with Yardi, RealPage, Entrata and ResMan rather than Buildium or AppFolio. The gap is case handling and forensics for small operators and a human-override workflow around automated fails.
Automatable?	Partly. Document consistency checks (pay dates against deposits, employer details against public records, metadata and fonts), cross-checks between application fields, status tracking and applicant messaging can run on the firm's own files. The applicant's consent gates (credit check, open banking, share-code generation), the manual Right to Rent check with the holder present, the employer call, the FCRA adverse-action notice and the landlord's or agent's decision are human; scoring must respect the Fair Housing Act, the SafeRent voucher ruling and the Renters' Rights Act bans on refusing families and benefit claimants.
What the reader would need to learn	FCRA duties and HUD's screening guidance (status after 2025 unverified); state application-fee caps, portable-report rules and criminal-history limits; UK referencing norms (rent at 33-40% of income, three months of payslips, previous-landlord reference), the Right to Rent routes, the Tenant Fees Act ban on charging applicants, the Renters' Rights Act discrimination rules; document forensics techniques; open-banking data formats; the lessons of the SafeRent settlement.

8 CRM configuration validation and dormant-lead exception reports

US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** fully

Problem	Fewer than half of US agents use a CRM, those who do set it up "sink or swim", campaigns and tags fail silently ("campaigns not triggering", "AI will communicate with leads when not", tagging that "wouldn't work at all"), nobody owns the upkeep, and leads go dormant: one two-agent team has "840-850 leads sitting dormant in the team's CRM" while warm leads "go unworked while he is out on showings". Set-up gigs configure but do not validate; consent provenance for calls and texts is a tag the user must maintain.
Who has it	US solo agents, teams of two to ten and small independent brokerages on Follow Up Boss, BoldTrail/kvCORE, Lofty, BoomTown, Sierra Interactive, Real Geeks or GoHighLevel, including agents on a brokerage-bundled CRM they did not choose; wholesalers on REsimpli, Podio or GoHighLevel. Sales line of business.
Evidence	46% use a CRM, learning curve 63%, cost 59% (HousingWire, 2026 [58]); 23% call the CRM their top lead source, 36% have it paid by the brokerage (NAR 2025 PDF [351]); about 40% of brokerages with adoption below 50%, satisfaction 3.7 to 3.2 stars (TotalBrokerage 2025 [352] vendor survey); "5-12 touches, yet many agents stop after 2" (HousingWire, 28 May 2026 [169]); "keeping a CRM current is nobody's dedicated job" (Be Epic [354] vendor); dirty imports (Tomba [355] secondary); BoldTrail, Lofty and FUB failure reviews (Capterra BoldTrail [308]; Software Advice Lofty [312]; Capterra FUB [305] snippet); the dormant-lead post (wfh.team [95]); Upwork posts asking to "Clean up my FUB stages, tags, and smart lists so automations trigger correctly" (Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]); about 1,160 Fiverr gigs (Fiverr [126] snippet); Zillow Pro's alerts inside FUB (Real Estate News, 15 Oct 2025 [379]).
Their words	"action plans", "smart lists", "stages, tags, notes, and tasks clean", "automations trigger correctly", "lead routing", "Unresponsive leads", "Past clients and database contacts", "no lead falls through the cracks", "840-850 leads sitting dormant", "campaigns not triggering", "an expensive, outdated contact list", "I don't know exactly what I'm needing but something that is very optimal that I can stay in front of my clients"; search: "follow up boss vs lofty", "kvcore vs boldtrail", "best real estate crm for single agent", "real estate lead follow up system", "lead follow up automation", "speed to lead automation", "follow up boss training videos", "follow up boss customer service".
How they handle it today	Fiverr and Upwork set-up at $10-$399; VAs at $5-$15 an hour to dedupe, tag and run "a cleanup pass, then ongoing maintenance"; brokerage training (55% in-house, 10% none); Zapier and Make flows; Loom videos so the agent "can edit the emails and automations myself"; an ISA "lead backstop" paid $10 per appointment that shows.
Vendors already covering it	Follow Up Boss (22 Zapier operations, action plans, deal reports) vendor; Lofty (12 operations, AI agents, consent-status tags) vendor; BoomTown (10, read-only triggers for assigned leads); kvCORE/BoldTrail (4, 15-minute lead delay); Sierra and Real Geeks (2 each); Zillow Pro alerts vendor; gig sellers and VA firms (Be Epic, Stealth Agents at $15 an hour, MyOutDesk). No vendor publishes seat-activity or unworked-lead statistics or sells an audit; the "configured but not working" reviews are the evidence of the gap.
Automatable?	Fully for detection: pulling contacts, stages, tags, action-plan status, last-touch dates and consent status through the API or Zapier (FUB, Lofty) or exports (the others) into the team's own store, with rules such as "no touch in N days", "action plan not applied", "missing phone or email", "duplicate", "consent unknown", "lead source not mapped", and a weekly exception list by agent. Deciding cadences and routing, and the calls themselves, are human; AI dialling or texting without written consent is a TCPA breach.
What the reader would need to learn	The Follow Up Boss API and Zapier triggers; Lofty, BoldTrail and BoomTown integration limits; TCPA consent provenance and the 10-business-day revocation rule; dedupe and contact-normalisation methods; Zillow Flex and Preferred lead-source mechanics; the NAR technology-survey base rates to size the market; dashboarding.

9 Contract-to-close deadline and document-completeness tracking across systems — US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	A US residential sale carries 20 to 30 dates and about 20 documents across a CRM, a transaction tool, email, Dropbox, Google Drive and text messages, "Nobody is on the same system", agents carrying 15-20 files lose "inspection objections, lender conditions and signatures", missed option-period and earnest-money release deadlines are "the biggest bleed", MLS data does not populate into forms, and one buyer is paying for "a solution to reading a pdf in boldtrail to confirm completeness and accuracy". Each state's contract framework sets different deadlines.
Who has it	US solo agents and teams (median nine sides; 15-20 open files at peak), independent transaction coordinators ($350-$500 per file; manageable at 10-12 files a month, breaking at 30 or more), small brokerages' compliance reviewers, wholesale and novation operators. Sales and contract-to-close line of business.
Evidence	14% delayed, 5-7% terminated (NAR RCI [45]); 20-30 dates, 8-15 hours on a complex file (ListedKit [50] vendor); the 45-task five-phase checklist with a 72-hour first phase (Serif [173] vendor); the forum thread on packets, calendars and "the contingency clock problem" (BiggerPockets post 7250481 [49] user, 2026); dotloop "MLS data not populating into forms" and weak autofill (Capterra dotloop [384] snippet; Trustpilot dotloop [373] user, Feb 2026); the $160 FUB-dotloop-BoldTrail integration post and the owner-finance TC post (Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]; Upwork jobs: transaction coordinator [97]); a TC firm's "critical-dates calendar ... under each state's contract framework (PA ASR, TN RF401, OK TRR, AZ AAR, TX TREC, CO CBS1, FL FR/Bar AS-IS)" and "Claude-built tools" (same search); Oklahoma's 31 forms (OREC [172]); the written buyer agreement and one-business-day MLS rules (NAR [170]; HGAR [171]).
Their words	"contract to close", "contingency clock", "EMD", "option period", "inspection objections", "lender conditions", "clear to close", "Closing Disclosure", "file compliance", "Check each document to verify it has all the correct signatures and dates", "proactively identifies missing documents", "keeps every file moving", "Starting from scratch with document packets on every deal", "Re-entering personal and entity information on every contract", "Nobody is on the same system"; search: "transaction coordinator checklist pdf", "transaction coordinator checklist template excel", "under contract checklist", "buyer under contract checklist", "real estate closing checklist template", "who pays the transaction coordinator fee", "how much does a transaction coordinator charge".
How they handle it today	TC checklists (Process Street, Serif), a shared calendar, dotloop or SkySlope loops, Lone Wolf Transact, Asana, Slack and Google Sheets; VAs at $3-$12 an hour; TC services at $350-$542 a file or $700-$1,500 a month; brokerage file review before commission disbursement.
Vendors already covering it	dotloop ($31.99-$149 a month; six-month opt-out; autofill complaints) vendor and user; SkySlope (from $340 a month; value-for-money 3.6/5 snippet); Lone Wolf Transact ("links offer details to the client so information carries over when a deal falls through", broker checklists and file review) vendor; Brokermint/BoldTrail BackOffice; Follow Up Boss basic deal tracking secondary; TC services (Transactly "90% of the contract-to-close process" and 16 hours saved vendor); Form Simplicity vendor. None claims cross-system checks on the documents themselves (signatures, dates, initials, matching figures between contract, earnest-money receipt and Closing Disclosure).
Automatable?	Partly. Extracting dates, parties and figures from the executed contract, building the deadline calendar for the state form in use, checking that each document has the required signatures, dates and initials, matching the earnest-money receipt and the Closing Disclosure to the contract, and sending 48-hour reminders are document and calendar jobs that can run on the team's own files. Negotiating repairs, drafting addenda, the wire-instruction call-back, legal advice and licensing-based supervision are human.
What the reader would need to learn	State purchase-agreement forms and their deadline structures; the TRID three-day Closing Disclosure rule; earnest-money and trust rules; the dotloop, SkySlope and Transact APIs and their limits; e-signature audit trails; PDF extraction on form fields versus scans; brokerage compliance-review practice; the NAR settlement forms and the delayed-marketing disclosure.

10 Deposit deduction evidence and dispute packs — UK and US

Problem signal: medium	**Vendor coverage:** partial	**Automatable:** partly

Problem	Cleaning (54%) and damage (49%) drive UK deposit disputes, tenants now use ChatGPT to write "persuasive challenges to deductions", and "A written inventory without photos is worthless, an inventory with photos but no writing is worthwhile"; in the US the deduction must be itemised ("Not a general deduction. Not an estimate.") and returned within a state window of 14 to 60 days with penalties of two or three times the deposit, flat "$250 cleaning fee" lines are challenged, and deposits lumped across properties cannot be reconstructed.
Who has it	UK letting agents, inventory clerks and landlords (4.7 million protected deposits, 46,950 adjudications a year); US small property managers and landlords, especially room-by-room operators with shared areas. Lettings and property-management lines of business.
Evidence	TDS statistics (NRLA, 22 Dec 2025 [40]); DPS causes (DPS [418]); the inventory firm's warning and the reader comment (Property Industry Eye, 6 Jul 2026 [164] user, Jul 2026); the mediator's, contractor's and CPA's advice (BiggerPockets 1302755 [199] user, Oct 2026); state windows and caps (NomadLease [198] secondary); California's 21-day rule as a dispute source (BiggerPockets 1302698 [181] user); the 10-day return rule after agreement (GOV.UK [419]); Propertymark's "Managing AI-generated complaints" course (Propertymark [247]); a VA duty to "document evidence for proposed deposit deductions" (OnlineJobs.ph 1739283 [420]).
Their words	"inventory", "check-in", "check-out report", "fair wear and tear", "deposit deductions", "prescribed information", "itemised", "Not a general deduction. Not an estimate.", "$250 cleaning fee", "common-area damage", "A well-written argument supported by incomplete information is still an incomplete argument"; search: "deposit deductions for cleaning", "deposit deductions template", "deposit deductions guidelines", "deposit deductions after 10 days", "check out report tenancy template", "end of tenancy checklist for landlords", "inventory clerk job description", "deposit dispute time limit".
How they handle it today	Inventory clerks or in-house staff produce a check-in report, a check-out report and photos; deductions are listed in an email with invoices; disputes go to TDS, DPS or MyDeposits adjudication; US managers use a move-out checklist PDF and a spreadsheet; one complainant paid £115 for an inventory and "nobody has contacted me back".
Vendors already covering it	Inventory services and apps (used by the agencies; none named with product detail in the notes), the three UK deposit schemes' adjudication services, AppFolio and Buildium move-out and deposit-accounting features, Goodlord's end-of-tenancy steps vendor. No product in the notes claims to match check-in and check-out evidence per item, build an itemised schedule with invoices, or track the state return deadline per unit.
Automatable?	Partly. Pairing check-in and check-out photos and text per room, drafting the itemised schedule with cost evidence, flagging items with no before-and-after evidence, and tracking return deadlines by state or by the 10-day UK rule can run on the firm's own records. The inspection, the fair-wear judgment, the negotiation with the tenant and the adjudicator's decision are human.
What the reader would need to learn	UK scheme rules and adjudication standards, fair wear and tear, prescribed information and the 10-day rule; US state deposit statutes (windows, caps, penalties); image comparison basics; invoice extraction; the language of condition reports; UK GDPR for photographs of occupied homes.

11 Wholesaler list hygiene, record matching and consent or DNC logging

US

Problem signal: medium	Vendor coverage: partial	Automatable: partly

Problem	Wholesalers pull absentee, pre-foreclosure and tax-lien lists that "go stale because properties sold, owners died, or tax mailing addresses point to the property itself", court filings carry "an old owner name, a missing unit number or a typo in the address", about 70% of skip-traced numbers are dead, "Skip tracing dead names is the most expensive part of lead gen", and every outbound call or text sits under the TCPA, state call-time rules and a 31-day Do-Not-Call scrub with penalties of $500 to $1,500 per violation; homeowners ask "how you got their number".
Who has it	US wholesalers and small investors (part-time operators calling 6pm-8pm, land companies with five to ten staff), cold-calling and SMS teams, the 298 OnlineJobs.ph "skip tracing" posts and 292 "real estate cold calling" posts. Investor and wholesaler line of business.
Evidence	Florida pre-foreclosure friction (BiggerPockets 1302525 [207] user, Oct 2026); stale lists and dead names (BiggerPockets 1301774 [208] user, Sep 2026); bad-number rates and DNC scrubbing halving lists (BiggerPockets 1259450 [66]; BiggerPockets 1286268 [65] user); dialer evaluation on DNC and spam flags (BiggerPockets 1302811 [210] user); TCPA rules and penalties (BAM [211] secondary; NAR telemarketing [168]); the tooling chain with custom pricing only (Goliath Data [209] vendor); Oklahoma's wholesale cancellation notice (OREC [172]); Upwork posts for PropStream list pulls into ReadyMode, "500k skips/year", LexisNexis entity resolution and "We are TCPA and Florida FTSA aware, we maintain 10DLC registration, we scrub DNC" (Upwork jobs: skip tracing [118]; Upwork jobs: listing description [120]).
Their words	"absentee owner", "pre-foreclosure", "lis pendens", "folio", "skip trace", "dead names", "disconnected", "DNC scrubbing", "TCPA", "10DLC", "triple-line dialer", "Mojo", "caller-ID reputation", "tired of wholesalers", "Matching the filing to the correct property and owner", "Jumping between county sites, property appraisers, and court records", "Fix the follow-up before you spend another dollar on more leads"; search: "skip tracing real estate", "batch skip tracing cost", "propstream skip tracing cost", "skip tracing services cost", "real estate cold calling scripts for sellers", "does cold calling work in real estate".
How they handle it today	PropStream, BatchLeads, BatchDialer, REsimpli, ReadyMode, Mojo, Podio; VAs at $3-$5 an hour pulling and scrubbing lists every morning; manual county-site hopping; number rotation; DNC scrubbers inside the dialer; "Vocaroo voice recordings" to screen callers.
Vendors already covering it	PropStream, BatchLeads, BatchDialer ("Never was a fan"), REISkip, Skip Genie, Goliath Data, ReadyMode, Mojo Dialer, REsimpli: list aggregation, skip tracing, dialers and DNC flagging, all on custom or enterprise pricing with no published match accuracy or contact-rate statistics; CRMs tag consent status (Lofty). Nobody sells record-matching quality or a consent audit.
Automatable?	Partly. Entity resolution across county records (owner names, unit numbers, typos, deceased owners, mailing-address checks), staleness detection, DNC and consent logging with call-time rules, and follow-up scheduling can run on the operator's own lists. The call itself must be manually dialled unless there is express written consent, AI or prerecorded voice counts as artificial voice, and state wholesaling disclosure rules (Oklahoma's cancellation notice) add human steps.
What the reader would need to learn	The TCPA, the FCC's 2025 revocation rules, state mini-TCPA laws (Florida, Oklahoma, Washington) and the DNC registry process; 10DLC registration; county record formats (Florida folios, lis pendens) and property-appraiser data; skip-trace vendor APIs; entity-resolution methods; state wholesaling laws (Oklahoma confirmed, others unverified).

12 AI-written content compliance checks

US and UK

Problem signal: medium | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** fully

Problem	Three-quarters of AI-using US agents write listing descriptions with it, AI drafts produce fair-housing phrases ("perfect for families", "walking distance to St. Mary's") and invented features, buyers notice ("Our house got AI-ed"), MLS and state rules on altered photos are fragmenting (labels, "Before" images, QR links to originals), UK Trading Standards treats deceptive edits as potential CPR and DMCC breaches and portals remove images, NAR says AI content "should not go straight from prompt to publication", and insurers call AI "a grey area" in E&O cover. No enforcement case tied to AI copy was found, which makes this a risk-prevention gap rather than a penalty-driven one.
Who has it	US solo agents and teams (ChatGPT used by 91% of AI users), US brokerages writing AI policies, MLS compliance staff; UK agents using AI photos or copy, and lettings adverts that must state a rent and avoid discriminatory wording. Sales and lettings marketing, both countries.
Evidence	NAR surveys (NAR Technology Survey [251]; Real Estate News, 22 Sep 2026 [421]); NAR policy guidance (NAR, 24 Mar 2026 [249]); the fair-housing checklist (HousingWire, 15 May 2026 [250]); the questions agents ask and the phrase list (How AI Works [422]); buyer backlash (The AI Career Lab [252] secondary); MLS and California rules (NorthstarMLS [257]; The Close [259]); UK Trading Standards and Rightmove removals (The Negotiator [244] snippet); E&O grey area (Pearl Insurance [177]); Propertymark's AI-complaints course (Propertymark [247]).
Their words	"AI-ed", "fair housing words to avoid pdf", "perfect for families", "walking distance to St. Mary's", "master bedroom", "virtually staged", "Before image", "reasonably conspicuous", "should not go straight from prompt to publication", "clear labelling is the bare minimum", "Can AI check an existing listing description for fair housing problems?", "Do I have to disclose that a listing description was written by AI?"; search: "fair housing words to avoid", "real estate fair housing words to avoid", "chatgpt listing description", "mls listing description character limit", "estate agent ai photos", "estate agent ai complaints", "estate agents using ai images".
How they handle it today	Proofreading against a checklist, brokerage AI policies (NAR's template is behind member login), reading each MLS's rules, captioning staged photos, hoping the portal does not remove the image.
Vendors already covering it	Listing-description generators (many; Upwork and Fiverr gigs at $15-$40), AI photo editors, HousingWire and How AI Works checklists, NAR's policy template member-only, MLS rule pages, Zillow's content standards snippet. Generation is crowded; no product in the notes claims an automated pre-publication check of copy against fair-housing phrase lists, MLS character and content rules, photo-disclosure requirements and the source facts (square footage, features, Material Information).
Automatable?	Fully for the check: phrase screening, character limits, required disclosures present, altered-image labels present, and fact comparison against the source documents are rule and retrieval jobs. The publication decision stays with a licensed person who remains liable, and the human review NAR describes cannot be removed.
What the reader would need to learn	Fair Housing Act protected classes and HUD's advertising guidance; state additions; each MLS's photo and remarks rules; California AB 723; the UK CPRs, the DMCC Act and portal content policies; the Renters' Rights Act advert rules; how to evaluate generated text against source documents for invented facts.

13 CRM migration and data-cleanup validation — UK and US

Problem signal: medium	Vendor coverage: weak	Automatable: largely

Problem	Switching or being moved between systems is where data is lost: "Data was transferred incorrectly" on a Reapit-to-Alto migration described as "one of their most common, straightforward migrations", a new Reapit customer "was provided with what was essentially an empty CRM", portal leads stopped arriving after a move, Jupix users are being moved onto Alto, LionDesk users were pushed onto Lone Wolf Relationships with a few weeks' notice, AppFolio cancellation may need a physical letter and Buildium cancellation forced "hundreds of owner PAD agreements" to be reset; "Importing a messy database is where teams lose weeks" and training "slows an office for 2 to 4 weeks". No vendor publishes a migration failure rate and no independent UK migration checker exists.
Who has it	UK agencies switching between Reapit, Alto, Jupix, Street and Dezrez, especially the Jupix-to-Alto cohort of 2026-27; US teams moving between Follow Up Boss, BoldTrail, Lofty and Lone Wolf, and small managers leaving AppFolio or Buildium. All lines of business.
Evidence	Alto migration reviews and the vendor's admission (Trustpilot Alto [336] user, Apr-Sep 2026); Reapit "empty CRM" and contract exits (Trustpilot Reapit [333] user, 2026); Zoopla's Jupix-to-Alto tool (three weeks end to end, 27 hours saved, 13-customer pilot) (Property Industry Eye, 30 Aug 2022 [406]); "High switching costs" (TradePick [335] secondary); "2 to 4 weeks" (ESRE Media [140] secondary); dirty imports (Tomba [355] secondary); LionDesk shutdown (HousingWire [423]); AppFolio and Buildium exit complaints (Trustpilot AppFolio [319]; Trustpilot Buildium [322] user, 2026); Reapit's API called "the worst API we have ever implemented" (AllAgents [331] snippet).
Their words	"Data was transferred incorrectly", "leads not coming through from portals", "essentially an empty CRM", "didn't run as smoothly as it should have", "corrupted data records", "Importing a messy database is where teams lose weeks", "duplicate records, dead email addresses, and missing phone numbers", "High switching costs (data migration is complex)", "reset hundreds of owner PAD agreements"; search: "alto software reviews", "reapit lettings login", "property management software uk reddit", "best estate agent software uk", "lofty crm reviews", "follow up boss customer service".
How they handle it today	The vendor's migration team; Zoopla's tool for Jupix-to-Alto; Fiverr and VA clean-up passes; spreadsheets; going back to the previous vendor; paying for both systems during the overlap.
Vendors already covering it	Zoopla's migration tool (Jupix to Alto only; rent due dates, charges and management-fee percentages migrate automatically) vendor; Alto "onboarding and data migration included" sponsored; Reapit training consultants and AU/NZ classroom sessions vendor; Fixflo data-migration services from £300 vendor; Buildium mandatory onboarding, DoorLoop and Propertyware onboarding fees vendor; SME Professional onboarding with a Propertymark discount. No independent validator of a completed migration exists in the UK notes; in the US it is the CRM gig and VA market.
Automatable?	Largely for validation: record counts by type, field-mapping checks, duplicate and missing-contact detection, portal-feed and lead-routing tests, rent-due-date and fee-percentage checks (the fields the Jupix tool migrates), and a before-and-after report. Choosing the vendor, negotiating notice periods and signing off the cut-over are human.
What the reader would need to learn	Reapit Foundations and AppMarket, Alto and Jupix export formats, the Rightmove real-time datafeed specification, Follow Up Boss and Lofty import and export limits, data-quality testing methods, UK GDPR on transfers between processors, and the contract terms (12-36 months, auto-renewal, notice clauses) that decide when a switch is even possible.

Crowded areas that are not gaps, and the three strongest private-data fits

- The three strongest gaps for a self-hosted or private-data angle are gaps 1, 3 and 2: they touch tenant files and certificates, bank statements and ID, and owner ledgers, all of which regulators say the firm must control and all of which are being pasted into free tools or shipped to offshore coordinators today; gaps 6, 7 and 9 (title documents, application documents, executed contracts) sit just behind them.
- The crowded areas are the ones a buyer finds first when typing 'real estate' into a marketplace: listing copy, promo video, CRM set-up gigs, screening reports, cold callers, and, on the title side, wire-fraud tools; their reviews complain about quality, contracts and price, not absence.
- Nine crowded problems in the ranking table: listing descriptions and social posts (ChatGPT, generators, $15-$40 gigs); AI receptionist and phone answering (many vendors; Charisma's 'Jane'; vendor-adjacent caveats about hang-ups); CRM set-up gigs (about 1,160 Fiverr gigs, Upwork $20-$399, 50+ bidders); commodity tenant screening reports (TransUnion, Experian via SmartMove, RentSpree, Buildium, Zillow at $17-$49 same day); wire-fraud and seller-identity tools for title companies (CertifID, Qualia Shield, FNF

ionFraud; the brokerage's role is the call-back); promo video, photo editing and floorplans (694-1,045 feedback gigs); skip-trace data vending (PropStream, BatchLeads, REISkip, Skip Genie); AppFolio bookkeeping as a human service (OJO, PM Bookkeeper, WPM at $34-$45 an hour; the automated exception layer is gap 2); cold-calling VAs and ISAs (292 OnlineJobs posts, MyOutDesk, $3-$7 an hour).

SECTION 10

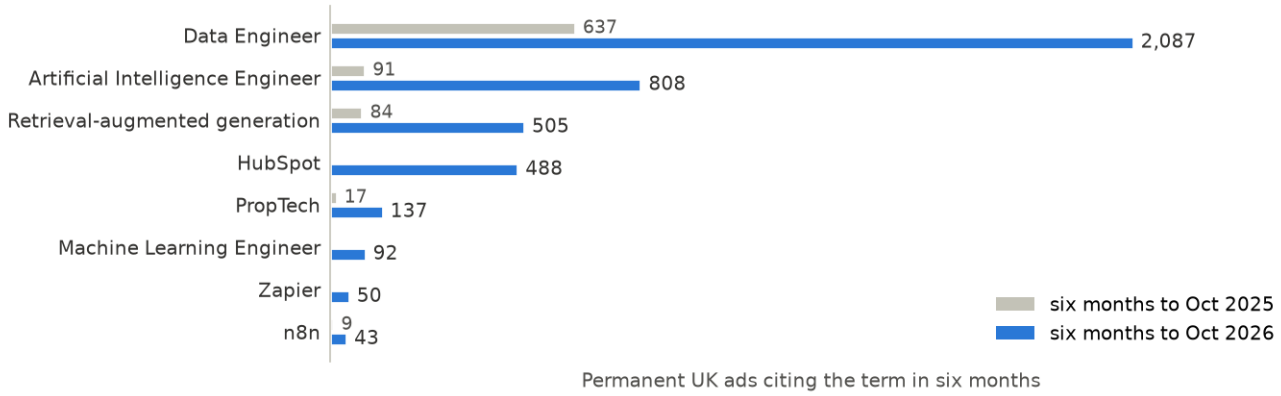
Employed path versus freelance path: a dozen cutting employers against a $10 gig floor

The employed path runs through a small number of PropTech employers whose engineering pay is high and whose headcount is shrinking; the freelance path runs through marketplaces where the small firm's buying habit has pushed the public price of 'set up my CRM' to $10-$35 and the price of a person to $5-$10 an hour. Neither path requires a real-estate licence on the evidence gathered; both reward the same stack of Python, LLM and RAG work, CRM configuration, workflow tools and property-data handling.

Counting the employed roles

- LinkedIn's public pages show '11,000+' US results for 'proptech', 'real estate ai' and 'real estate data engineer' and '8,000+' for UK proptech, but the matching is loose: the 'Follow Up Boss' page is mostly collections and billing jobs containing the words 'follow-up', and the 'AppFolio' page is AppFolio's own hiring, so these are ceilings, not role counts (LinkedIn proptech jobs [424]; LinkedIn follow-up-boss jobs [425]).
- The only clean series is IT Jobs Watch for UK permanent ads in the six months to 11 October 2026: **137 ads citing PropTech (17 a year earlier), top titles Sales Manager (36) and Account Executive (34); 808 citing 'Artificial Intelligence Engineer' (91); 505 citing retrieval-augmented generation (84); 2,087 citing Data Engineer (637); 92 Machine Learning Engineer; 488 HubSpot; 50 Zapier; 43 n8n (9)**; no tracked page at all for 'Reapit', 'estate agency' or 'property' (IT Jobs Watch PropTech [426]; AI Engineer [427]; RAG [428]; Data Engineer [429]; n8n [430]).
- US employers that actually post AI and data titles in the LinkedIn samples: AppFolio ('Staff Machine Learning Engineer - Leasing'), Zillow, CoStar and its Homes.com and Apartments.com brands, Realtor.com, Crexi, EliseAI, JLL, First American and Compass; Keller Williams, eXp, Lone Wolf and Inside Real Estate did not appear (LinkedIn real estate AI jobs [431]; LinkedIn real estate data engineer jobs [432]). UK engineering ads cluster in London and Manchester at Rightmove, Houseful, Reapit, Street Group, Yardi and CoStar UK plus small start-ups (LinkedIn UK proptech jobs [433]); Reapit's own careers page showed one live role with placeholder text and Indeed listed three Reapit UK jobs (Reapit careers [434]; Indeed UK Reapit [435] snippet).

UK permanent ads, six months to 11 Oct 2026: AI Engineer 808 (91 a year earlier), RAG 505 (84), Data Engineer 2,087 (637), PropTech 137 (17, mostly sales titles)



Source: IT Jobs Watch [426] [427] [428] [429] [451] [456] [430]. PropTech's top titles are Sales Manager (36) and Account Executive (34), not engineers; no tracked page exists for 'Reapit', 'estate agency' or 'property'.

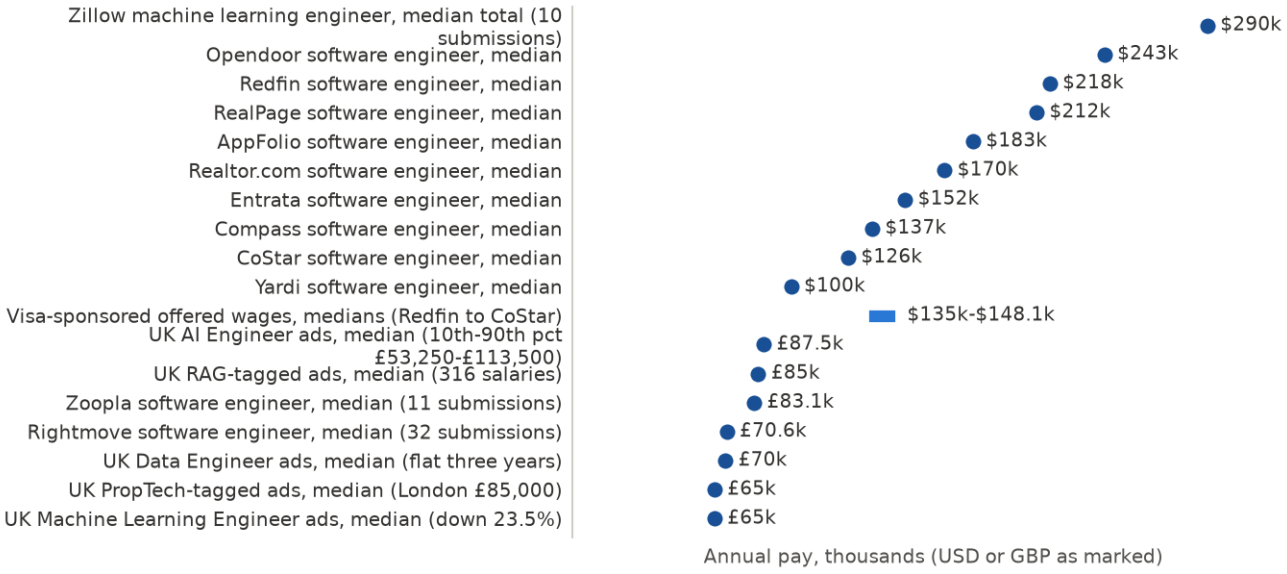
Pay: the employer matters more than the title

- Within US PropTech a senior engineer at the stock-paying portals (Zillow, Opendoor, Redfin) reports about double a senior at CoStar or Yardi; the property-management vendors (Yardi, Entrata, RealPage, AppFolio) pay base-heavy packages of $100,000 to $212,000. In the UK the PropTech tag carries no premium: £65,000 median against £87,500 for a generic AI Engineer, so the premium is for AI and RAG skills, not for the property vertical (IT Jobs Watch PropTech [426]).
- The skills the ads name are generic: UK AI Engineer ads co-occur with Python (54.6%), Azure (42.7%) and LLM (36.4%); RAG ads with LLM (82.8%), Python (65.9%), generative AI (51.5%) and Azure (49.7%); data-engineer ads with SQL (38.0%), Python (33.7%) and pipelines (32.2%); PropTech ads with SaaS (67.2%), TypeScript and Node.js rather than AI (IT Jobs Watch AI Engineer [427]; RAG [428]; Data Engineer [429]). The vertical skills (RESO

Web API, MLS and IDX feeds, Trestle, MLS Grid) show up in developer ads and freelancer directories, not in any salary index; no fetched ad mentioned ATTOM, CoreLogic, Snowflake, dbt, vector databases or the Rightmove real-time datafeed (Hirist IDX developer [457] snippet; Arc.dev RESO [458]).

- Remote and visa reality is thin: none of 60 LinkedIn US PropTech cards used the word 'Remote' (one hybrid, one on-site), two of 60 Real Estate AI cards did (both First American), 21 of 137 UK PropTech ads (15.3%) were tagged work-from-home, Reapit says 'Most roles are hybrid', Rightmove's data roles are London hybrid two days a week, Opendoor's chairman 'wants employees back in the office', and sponsorship is small and shrinking (Zillow's green-card filings fell from 44 to 2; F1Jobs reports 8 new-hire H-1B approvals against 92 renewals) (LinkedIn proptech jobs [424]; Reapit careers [434]; Built In London Rightmove [459] snippet; Fortune, 16 Sep 2025 [460]; Ellis Zillow [446]; F1Jobs [461] snippet). No fetched ad contained explicit sponsorship or degree wording.

Employed pay: US PropTech software-engineer medians run from $100,000 at Yardi to $290,000 for a Zillow ML engineer; UK AI Engineer ads pay a median £87,500 while PropTech-tagged roles pay £65,000



Sources: Levels.fyi, 11 Oct 2026 [436] [437] [438] [439] [440] [441] [442] [443] [444] [445] (self-reported); IT Jobs Watch, six months to 11 Oct 2026 [427] [428] [429] [451] [426]; Rightmove and Zoopla on Levels.fyi [453] [454]; DOL LCA data via Ellis [446].

Table 10.1 Employed pay by employer or title

Employed pay by employer or title	Figure	Basis	Source
Zillow machine learning engineer	Median total $290,000 (10 submissions); P3 $254K, P4 $292K	Levels.fyi, 11 Oct 2026 self-reported	Levels.fyi [436]
Opendoor, Redfin, RealPage, AppFolio software engineer	Medians $243K, $218K, $212K, $183K	Levels.fyi self-reported	Opendoor [437]; Redfin [438]; RealPage [439]; AppFolio [440]
Realtor.com, Entrata, Compass, CoStar, Yardi software engineer	Medians $170K, $152K, $137K, $126K, $100K	Levels.fyi self-reported	Realtor.com [441]; Entrata [442]; Compass [443]; CoStar [444]; Yardi [445]
Visa-sponsored offered wages	Zillow median $143,400 (145 LCAs in 2025; PERM 2 vs 44 in 2024); CoStar $148,050 (43 LCAs); AppFolio $140,000 (24); Redfin $135,000 (32, PERM 0)	DOL LCA data via Ellis, Aug 2026	Ellis Zillow [446]; Ellis CoStar [447]; Ellis AppFolio [448]; Ellis Redfin [449]
Built Technologies Staff/Sr AI Solutions Engineer	$150,000-$205,000, remote USA, onboarding customers to an "Agentic AI product"	Built In snippet	Built In [450]
UK AI Engineer	Median £87,500 (+12.9%); 10th percentile £53,250, 90th £113,500; outside London £80,000	IT Jobs Watch, 6 months to 11 Oct 2026	IT Jobs Watch [427]
UK RAG-tagged roles	Median £85,000 (+13.3%), 316 salaries; outside London £72,500	IT Jobs Watch	IT Jobs Watch [428]
UK Data Engineer / ML Engineer / AI skill	£70,000 (flat three years) / £65,000 (down 23.5%) / £72,500	IT Jobs Watch	Data Engineer [429]; ML Engineer [451]; AI [452]
UK PropTech-tagged roles	Median £65,000 (+36.8%); London £85,000; outside London £57,500; work-from-home £75,000; North of England £45,000	IT Jobs Watch	IT Jobs Watch PropTech [426]

Employed pay by employer or title	Figure	Basis	Source
Rightmove and Zoopla software engineer	£70.6K median (32 submissions, highest £100,669); £83.1K (11 submissions)	Levels.fyi self-reported	Rightmove [453]; Zoopla [454]
UK HubSpot, Zapier, n8n tagged	£45,000 / £90,000 (architect-heavy sample of 50) / £52,500	IT Jobs Watch	HubSpot [455]; Zapier [456]; n8n [430]

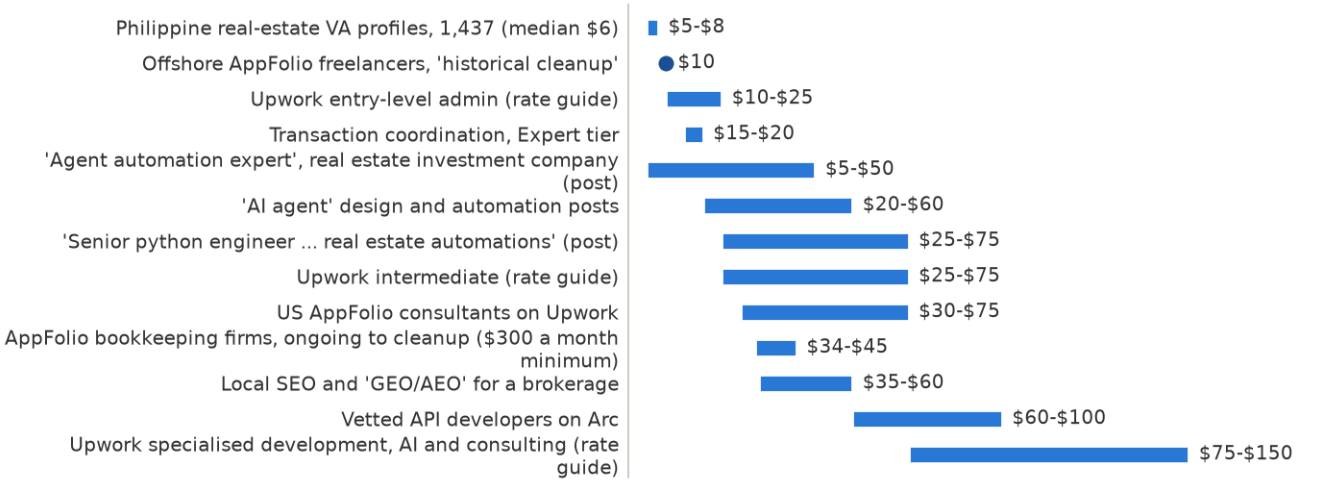
The 2025-26 market moves

- PropTech funding recovered to **$16.7bn in 2025 (+67.9%)** but was concentrated in large debt and structured deals, then flattened at **$4.53bn in H1 2026 (-0.6%)** with 11 deals of $100m-plus taking 49.6% and the 75 sub-$5m rounds of Q1 2026 taking 2.8% of capital, so early-stage PropTech is not a large source of engineering jobs (Multifamily Dive, 13 Jan 2026 [462]; Bisnow [463]; Inman, 9 Apr 2026 [464] snippet).
- The big residential players consolidated and cut while shipping AI: Rocket closed its Redfin purchase on 1 July 2025 and cut about 2% including product and engineering (HousingWire [465]); Compass closed Anywhere on 9 January 2026 with 110 New Jersey cuts in a WARN notice (Compass 10-K [466] snippet; NJBIZ [467] snippet); Zillow cut about 200 roles in January 2026 and 'just over 500' on 4 August 2026 while rolling Zillow Pro (Follow Up Boss plus consumer activity insights and AI alerts) nationwide (Real Estate News, 4 Aug 2026 [468]; Real Estate News, 15 Oct 2025 [379]); Opendoor's chairman said 'There's 1,400 employees at Opendoor... We don't need more than 200 of them' (Fortune [460]); CoStar launched Homes AI on Azure OpenAI in February 2026 (Business Wire [469] snippet); Lone Wolf shut LionDesk in September 2025 (HousingWire [423]); Alto shipped 'Alto Intelligence' in the UK (Alto [470] vendor); CertifID bought ClosingLock on 1 October 2026 (Inman [471] listing, not fetched).
- The AI feature work is being done by the portals and CRMs themselves, which both creates the AI and ML roles seen on LinkedIn and removes some of the simple 'add AI to the CRM' work from the freelance market.

The freelance path is priced in public

- Upwork's own rate guide puts entry-level admin at roughly $10-$25 an hour, intermediate at $25-$75 and specialised development, AI and consulting at $75-$150-plus (Upwork rate guide [472] snippet); live real-estate posts sit at the low end: an 'agent automation expert for real estate investment company' at $5-$50 an hour and a 'Senior python engineer who can build real estate automations' at $25-$75 an hour, each drawing 50-plus proposals (Upwork post [473] snippet; Upwork post [474] snippet).
- The 81 live posts read in October 2026 cluster at $100-$2,300 fixed for CRM, landing-page and integration builds, $500 for a voice agent, $20-$60 an hour for 'AI agent' design, $35-$60 an hour for SEO and 'GEO/AEO', $15-$20 an hour for Expert-tier transaction coordination, and $3-$12 an hour for everything done by a person (Upwork jobs: follow up boss [81]; Upwork jobs: real estate ai chatbot [115]; Upwork jobs: transaction coordinator [97]).
- US-based AppFolio consultants list at $30-$75 an hour against offshore freelancers at about $10 (Upwork AppFolio California [362]; Upwork AppFolio [363] snippet); Fiverr sells CRM set-up from $10-$20 and Zapier, Make and n8n automation from $25-$35 (Fiverr [475] snippet); Upwork's catalogue prices Follow Up Boss set-up at $30-$399 (modal $50), kvCORE and Lofty at $20-$175, a transaction coordinator at $20-$450 with 15 of 24 gigs unrated, a listing description at $15-$40 and a real-estate AI chatbot at $20-$400 with 5-10 feedback on the real-estate-named gigs (Upwork services: follow up boss [121]; Upwork services: transaction coordinator [123]; Upwork services: real estate chatbot [125]).
- Philippine directories list 1,437 real-estate VA profiles at $5-$8 an hour (median $6) and 51 AppFolio profiles at $6-$8; OnlineJobs.ph posts pay $700-$850 a month for a real-estate VA with MLS, Dotloop and PropStream experience (HireTalent.ph real estate [476]; HireTalent.ph AppFolio [477]; OnlineJobs.ph [478]); vetted API developers on Arc are $60-$100-plus an hour (Arc.dev [458]). One Upwork AppFolio bookkeeping post states 'we are open to international talent only', and several US posts require weekend and holiday cover in US hours (Upwork [479] snippet; OnlineJobs.ph 1640648 [480]).
- The consulting tier above the gigs is visible only in AppFolio accounting ($34-$45 an hour, $300 a month minimum, per-unit retainers), in vendor onboarding fees (Lofty $299-$1,499, AppFolio $400-$1,000-plus, Buildium $1,000-$2,000, PayProp £600-£2,000) and in a sponsored claim that BoldTrail implementation runs $1,000-$5,000; no certified-partner rate card exists for Follow Up Boss, kvCORE, Lofty, AppFolio, Buildium, Reapit or Alto, and Clutch, LinkedIn Services and vendor partner directories were not reached (OJO [357]; CostBench AppFolio [318] secondary; Luxury Presence Lofty [369] snippet; AI Tools Bakery [307] secondary).

Freelance rates: Philippine VAs at $5 to $8 an hour and Fiverr set-ups from $10 set the floor; Python and automation posts pay $25 to $75, AppFolio bookkeeping firms $34 to $45, vetted API developers $60 to $100-plus



Sources: Upwork rate guide [472] (snippet); Upwork posts [473] [474] (snippets, 50-plus proposals each); Upwork searches [115] [120] [97]; Upwork AppFolio freelancers [362] [363] (snippets); OJO Bookkeeping [357]; HireTalent.ph [476] [477]; Arc.dev [458]; Fiverr [475] (snippet).

How these businesses buy technology help explains the price floor

- US agents mostly buy their own tools: 34% spend $50-$250 a month, 20% $251-$500 and 24% over $500; 67% say the brokerage already provides what they need; brokerages commonly spend $50 or less per agent per month (about 28%) with 18% at $201-plus; about 45% of brokerages that switched did so for functionality, 28% named third-party integration a top opportunity, 48% named AI the technology they are most interested in; no survey measures spending on outside consultants (NAR newsroom, 18 Sep 2025 [481]; TotalBrokerage 2024 [353]; TotalBrokerage 2025 [352] vendor surveys).
- UK agencies are later-stage buyers pulled by compliance: 52% plan to adopt AI within 12 months, 66% expect to rely on compliance and AML automation, nearly nine in ten larger agencies plan adoption while smaller independents lag and about a third are nervous (Property Industry Eye, 16 Jan 2026 [248] vendor survey); 59% prefer to wait until others have tested new technology and almost half use no AI (Estate Agent Today, Apr 2026 [482] snippet). Alto claims 6,000-plus agencies and a consultancy's guide puts Reapit at about 5,000 offices and 25,000 users, so the UK installed base is two vendors deep with no third-party consultant layer around either (Alto blog [483] vendor, snippet; The Negotiator [484] snippet).

Table 10.2 Employed path against freelance path, dimension by dimension

Dimension	Employed (PropTech and portal AI, data and engineering roles)	Freelance and consulting (small brokerages, agencies, managers, investors)
Income range	US software-engineer medians $100,000 (Yardi) to $243,000 (Opendoor), Zillow ML engineer $290,000 self-reported; sponsored base medians $135,000-$148,000; UK AI Engineer £87,500, RAG £85,000, Data Engineer £70,000, PropTech £65,000 (London £85,000)	Marketplace gigs $10-$35 (set-up) to $399 (top FUB gig); posts $100-$2,300 fixed for builds, $500 for a voice agent; hourly $25-$75 for Python and automation, $30-$60 for AI-agent design, $30-$75 for US AppFolio consultants, $34-$45 for bookkeeping firms; $5-$12 for offshore people work; no partner-certified rate card found
Time to first revenue	No time-to-hire data found; the named employers were cutting in 2025-26 (Zillow 700-plus, Rocket/Redfin about 2%, Compass 110, Opendoor targeting 200 of 1,400); H-1B new-hire approvals at Zillow were 8 against 92 renewals snippet	Live posts exist now with 50-plus proposals each; Fiverr sellers offer free consultations; the AppFolio bookkeepers use a free health check as the entry product; vendor onboarding fees anchor what a set-up quote is compared with
Competition	UK: 808 AI Engineer ads against 1,646 live vacancies; PropTech 137 ads with 87 live and mostly sales titles; US counts unreliable from LinkedIn ceilings	50-plus bidders per Upwork post; 1,437 Filipino real-estate VA profiles on one directory; 7,129 remote API developers on Arc; Fiverr Follow Up Boss tag runs to 19-plus pages; some buyers restrict to international talent only
Need for a licence or industry background	No employer ad read required a real-estate licence; no degree or sponsorship wording was captured, so both remain unverified; vertical skills (RESO, MLS, IDX) appear in developer ads	No buyer post required a licence; an OnlineJobs.ph VA post required one year of real-estate experience and MLS familiarity; "3 years of direct US Residential Real Estate experience (Non-negotiable)" for an $8-$10 an hour operations role; vendor ecosystems (Zillow Pro tying Follow Up Boss to Zillow data) reward domain fluency

Dimension	Employed (PropTech and portal AI, data and engineering roles)	Freelance and consulting (small brokerages, agencies, managers, investors)
Remote and visa reality	Mostly hybrid or on-site (0 of 60 and 2 of 60 "Remote" cards; 15.3% UK work-from-home; Reapit hybrid; Rightmove two days in London); sponsorship thin and shrinking	Buyers explicitly accept or prefer offshore talent; US-hours and weekend cover often required; UK buyers almost absent from the boards (three property-related PeoplePerHour posts; one UK-worded Upwork gig)
Where the work is	Portals and large CRMs (Zillow, CoStar, Realtor.com, AppFolio, Rightmove, Houseful, Reapit) building their own AI; property-management vendors pay base-heavy and were not reported cutting	The integration and data layer between tools that the vendors gate (AppFolio Plus/Max, Buildium Premium, DoorLoop Premium, Reapit Foundations), the validation nobody sells (section 6), and the compliance work UK agents now prioritise
Skills that appear on both sides	Python and LLM/RAG (UK AI and RAG ads; Upwork "Senior python engineer... real estate automations"); CRM configuration (HubSpot and Salesforce in UK ads; Follow Up Boss, kvCORE/BoldTrail, Lofty, AppFolio, GoHighLevel in freelance posts); Zapier, Make and n8n (UK ads with Anthropic Claude at 60% of Zapier ads; Fiverr gigs; "Claude-built tools" in a TC firm's post); SQL and pipelines (Data Engineer ads; Rightmove data platform); MLS, RESO and IDX data handling (IDX developer ad; Arc directory; agents rank the MLS third as a lead source)	

Sources for the comparison table: Levels.fyi [436]; Ellis [446]; IT Jobs Watch [427]; Upwork rate guide [472] (snippet); Upwork AppFolio [362] (snippet); OJO [357]; HireTalent.ph [476]; Arc.dev [458]; Real Estate News, 4 Aug 2026 [468]; HousingWire Rocket [465]; Fortune Opendoor [460]; F1Jobs [461] (snippet); OnlineJobs.ph [478]; OnlineJobs.ph TC search [107]; PeoplePerHour [116]; IT Jobs Watch Zapier [456]; Upwork jobs: transaction coordinator [97]; Hirist [457] (snippet); HousingWire NAR 2025 [485].

The practical reading: the employed path's income ceiling is set by the stock-paying portals, which are the same firms that cut 2-7% of staff in 2025-26 and where 'remote' means hybrid in Seattle, San Francisco, London or Manchester, while the base-heavy property-management vendors were not reported cutting and pay $100,000-$212,000. The freelance path's public price floor is set by Fiverr and Philippine VAs, so a US- or UK-priced consultant's revenue depends on work that buyers already price at $25-$150 an hour (custom automation, data, AI agents, 'I'm not looking for someone who only connects apps') and on the validation and compliance work in section 9 that nobody prices, sold through private channels (referrals, vendor partner directories, LinkedIn Services) for which no data was found. Neither path requires a licence on the evidence; both reward MLS and portal data fluency, CRM and PM-system knowledge, and the compliance vocabulary of section 2.

Sources

Every URL cited in the research report, numbered in order of first appearance. Body references [n] point here. Hosts that blocked the researcher are listed in section 11, which follows this appendix; facts from them carry the snippet, secondary or sponsored tag.

[1]	**Property Industry Eye, 31 Jul 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/estate-agents-face-longest-wait-on-record-to-get-paid/
[2]	**Property Industry Eye, 17 Apr 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/fall-through-rates-edge-down-across-most-regions-year-on-year/
[3]	**Property Industry Eye, 10 Apr 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/?p=162331
[4]	**NAR 2026 Member Profile** https://www.floridarealtors.org/sites/default/files/basic-page/attachments/2026-08/2026%20Florida%20Member%20Profile%20Oversample.pdf
[5]	**NAR RCI, Dec 2025** https://cms.nar.realtor/sites/default/files/2026-01/2025-12-realtors-confidence-index-01-21-2026.pdf
[6]	**Clever** https://listwithclever.com/real-estate-blog/how-much-are-zillow-leads/
[7]	**Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/renters-rights-act-piles-more-work-on-letting-agents/
[8]	**Property Industry Eye, 12 Jun 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/complaints-against-agents-surge-by-almost-50/
[9]	**BiggerPockets, Oct 2026** https://www.biggerpockets.com/forums/52/topics/1303197-how-do-you-keep-tenant-requests-from-getting-lost
[10]	**FBI IC3 2025** https://www.ic3.gov/AnnualReport/Reports/2025_IC3Report.pdf
[11]	**ALTA 2026** https://alta.org/file/Seller-Impersonation-Fraud-Study-Report.pdf
[12]	**Property Reporter, 7 Aug 2026** https://www.propertyreporter.co.uk/rental-fraud-up-40-as-ai-generated-fake-identities-target-letting-agents-and-landlords.html
[13]	**Comsure on HMRC list** https://www.comsuregroup.com/news/aml-fails-in-six-months-hmrc-fined-estate-agents-836-000-most-never-even-registered/
[14]	**Property Reporter, 15 Dec 2025** https://www.propertyreporter.co.uk/time-to-exchange-stretches-to-123-days-twentyea.html
[15]	**Property Industry Eye, 1 Oct 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/the-property-markets-biggest-challenge-getting-sales-to-completion/
[16]	**Property Industry Eye, 3 Sep 2026** https://propertyindustryeye.com/estate-agents-escape-blame-as-almost-three-quarters-of-home-movers-face-delays/
[17]	**Mortgage Solutions, 19 Jan 2026** https://www.mortgagesolutions.co.uk/mortgage-news/2026/01/19/exchanges-in-2025-nearly-hit-one-million/
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[473]	**Upwork post** https://www.upwork.com/freelance-jobs/apply/agent-automation-expert-for-real-estate-investment-company_~022105698179776894846/
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[475]	**Fiverr** https://www.fiverr.com/gigs/follow-up-boss
[476]	**HireTalent.ph real estate** https://hiretalent.ph/industry/real-estate
[477]	**HireTalent.ph AppFolio** https://hiretalent.ph/tool/appfolio
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[481]	**NAR newsroom, 18 Sep 2025** https://www.nar.realtor/newsroom/realtors-embrace-ai-digital-tools-to-enhance-client-service-nar-survey-finds
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SECTION 11

What could not be verified

The researchers were blocked by many primary hosts (reddit.com on every mirror; Property118; Property Tribes thread bodies; Inman; The Negotiator; Estate Agent Today; Landlord Today in part; ConsumerAffairs; G2, Capterra, Software Advice, GetApp and AllAgents; Fiverr entirely; Upwork client fields and proposal counts; Zillow; HUD PDFs; the FCC; the ICO enforcement search; several GOV.UK HMRC and client-money pages; TPO's annual reports; Goodlord's report pages; Totaljobs, ZipRecruiter, Craigslist, Glassdoor and the Indeed US job-description pages for coordinator roles), and the shared web-search budget ran out part-way through every notes file, after which research continued by direct fetch of known URLs. The items below rest on search snippets, secondary reports, vendor claims or sponsored comparisons, or were not found at all, and should be checked before being repeated to a client.

Table 11.1 Items that rest on snippets, secondary reports, vendor claims or sponsored comparisons

Item	Status
Reapit "No certificate renewal automation" and Street "Certificate alerts only, with no end-to-end renewal workflow"	Stated only in an Alto-sponsored comparison on Letting Agent Today (Aug 2026); no vendor page or independent review confirms or denies it
NTSELAT Material Information Parts A, B and C item lists	Every candidate page returned 404 or empty; the lists used in this report are reconstructed from iamproperty, RICS (snippet) and the researcher's unverified recollection
HMRC estate-agency AML guidance of 8 July 2026 (CDD timing at offer, reliance under Regulation 39, registration fees)	GOV.UK slugs returned 404; all wording is from a law firm's summary (Devonshires); HMRC's penalty lists for 2023, 2024 and H2 2025 could not be located, so the year series rests on trade-press summaries and snippets
Renters' Rights Act civil-penalty amounts (£7,000 and £40,000 and the indicative schedule)	From a law firm's blog and council pages; the Act text and MHCLG's penalty guidance were not read; one secondary site gives £5,000 and £30,000 for the advance-rent breach
Tenant Fees Act caps, Client Money Protection rules and penalties, HMRC premises fees, deposit prescribed-information list and the 1x-3x deposit penalty	GOV.UK pages withdrawn or 404; not sourced beyond the Propertymark glossary
Awaab's Law statutory timescales for the PRS and the Decent Homes Standard date (2035 vs 2028 for EPC C)	Sub-pages returned 404; sources conflict (Simply-Docs 2028 for EPC C versus GOV.UK 2030 aim)
TPO 2024 and 2025 complaint causes by category and 2025 totals	TPO annual review PDF exceeded the fetch size limit and report pages returned 404; only the 2017 ranking and the Propertymark summary of 2025 casework are available
Goodlord State of the Lettings Industry 2025 figures (340 properties, 14 staff, 27% renewal revenue, 47% AI) and fraud data	Vendor-run survey and vendor data; the report pages returned 404 at several URLs; not independently confirmed
Propoly "73% more admin, 61% re-enter data" and The Letting Partnership "62.5%"	Vendor survey with no stated sample; the second implies a base of roughly 22-24 agents
Rushbrook "31+ hours a month", Worth Recruiting "33-35% turnover" and "150-200+ properties per manager", Alto "52% plan to adopt AI"	Vendor and recruiter surveys; samples and methods not published
Credas survey "63% pass ID fees", "64% manual", "£16,000 a year on compliance"	Vendor survey of 250 agents via Property Reporter; the £16,000 figure is a snippet-level claim
Thirdfort "57.7% of cases had a red flag", "17 hours" average, recharge prices £5-£30	Vendor data and a support article seen only in a snippet (403 on fetch)
Alto AML prices (£4.50, £7 + VAT), Reapit "from £150 per user", Jupix £95-£120 per user, BoldTrail $499-$2,500, BoomTown $2,500 with pass-throughs, AppFolio $1.40-$3.20 per unit and minimums	All third-party estimates, snippets or conflicting aggregators; the vendors publish no price
Capterra, G2, Software Advice, GetApp and AllAgents quotes (BoldTrail 81% and 83% negative, Lofty "never delivered", dotloop "MLS data not populating", Reapit "worst API", FUB tagging)	Search snippets of blocked pages; could not be read in full or attributed by date in every case
Fiverr counts and reviews (about 1,160 Follow Up Boss gigs, "195 orders and 55 reviews", "3,100 orders", starting prices $10-$35)	Fiverr returned 403 on every host; all figures are search snippets; no review text was read

Item	Status
Upwork client country, spend, proposal counts and per-tier gig prices; the "$150-$600 migration help" FUB price guide	Not exposed to logged-out visitors or page not identified; proposal counts were null on all 81 posts; the two "50+ proposals" posts are snippets
Form Simplicity "8 to 15 hours per file", Stealth Agents "13-15 hours a week reclaimed" and "$542 national average TC fee", ListedKit "45 hours per transaction with 30 on paperwork" attributed to NAR	Vendor figures; the NAR attribution was not verified; no primary time-use survey found
"3-5 work orders per unit per year", "4.2 requests per unit" (NMHC), "maintenance coordination consumes 35-45% of staff time" (NARPM 2025)	Vendor blogs seen in snippets; attributions unverified; no NARPM or NMHC source reached
Units per property manager, days to turn a unit, owner churn, share of firms with no CRM, agent hours on admin versus selling	No primary source found; NARPM, AppFolio and Buildium benchmarks are gated
Prospeo "15-hour average lead response"; Roof AI secret-shopper study; Relitix attrition figures (49% of 2022 first-closers closed nothing in 2023)	Vendor snippet; certificate error; Inman 403 (snippet only). The only independent response audit is WAV Group 2013, whose PDF gives two different average response times (917 minutes and 5.3 hours)
ICE Mortgage Technology 43-day close; Eviction Lab and TransUnion SmartMove eviction cost pages; NAR Member Profile paid-report fields (assistants, CRM use, tech spend)	Secondary or gated
NMHC/NAA "93.3% experienced fraud", Burnt "1 in 8" fraudulent income documents, Womble Bond Dickinson "1,760% BEC increase", CertifID per-victim loss	Aggregator or law-firm snippets; conflict with Snappt's own 6.4%; not verified against the reports
HUD's 2024 AI screening and advertising guidance (current status after 2025), HUD's July 2023 adverse-action letter, the FCC AI-voice ruling date and the one-to-one consent rule's present status, Utah's AI Policy Act, Colorado's delayed start date	Primary PDFs returned 403 or were not fetched; NAR's own pages contradict each other on the one-to-one rule (vacated 24 Jan 2025 per the March 2025 one-sheet; "took effect" per the standing page)
MLS fines for undisclosed AI staging, Wisconsin's disclosure law, Zillow's photo standards, New York's alert	Secondary summaries and snippets; no MLS rulebook with a fine schedule was read
National Trading Standards' statement on AI-edited photos; the Eaglescliffe Rightmove removal; Daily Mail investigation	Seen only in The Negotiator snippets (403 on fetch); NTS's own page says nothing about AI
UK agency-software security incidents after 2019 (Alto credential incident, CTS 2023 outage details), ICO breach counts for "Land or property services", the Life at Parliament View notice	Snippets; ICO pages rate-limited or 404
State rules outside Oklahoma (CE hours, trust-account rules, wholesaler disclosure laws in South Carolina, Illinois, Pennsylvania, Ohio; security-deposit windows where charts conflict, such as Illinois and Washington)	Only Oklahoma's commission pages, Hemlane's Texas and Washington rows and secondary charts were reachable; charts disagree
Property-management licensing by state (dedicated licences in Montana, South Carolina, Alaska and others)	Two secondary guides conflict
Right to Rent penalty figures in secondary guides (£3,000 vs £10,000/£20,000)	GOV.UK figures used; secondary guides disagree
Wholesaling due-diligence norms (comps, ARV, earnest money) and how a listing agent verifies a pre-approval or proof-of-funds letter	No primary source reached
UK CRM market share among independents, Reapit AppMarket app count, Reapit and Alto partner programmes, "Alto training" or "Reapit consultant" providers	Not found; The Negotiator 403; AppMarket page 404
Clutch, LinkedIn Services and vendor partner-directory rates; any survey of how many brokerages or agencies hire outside consultants and what they pay	Not reached; no survey exists in the notes
LinkedIn job counts for "proptech", "real estate ai", "real estate data engineer" ("11,000+", "8,000+")	Keyword ceilings including unrelated roles; the "Follow Up Boss" page proves the matching is loose
Levels.fyi pay medians, Rightmove and Zoopla pay, Indeed salary pages	Self-reported submissions; Glassdoor and Indeed salary pages returned 403
Employer sponsorship or degree wording at Zillow, CoStar, AppFolio, Rightmove, Houseful, Reapit; Rightmove's presence on the UK sponsor register	No ad text fetched; the one sponsor-register page returned 410

Item	Status
CoStar Homes AI launch details, Zillow Pro nationwide rollout, Compass-Anywhere cuts, Opendoor headcount "down 25%", CertifID's ClosingLock purchase	Business Wire, Inman, NJBIZ and Stocktwits snippets or listings; SEC filings seen in snippet only
CRETI funding figures for Q1 2026 ($3.3bn) and July 2026 ($528m)	Inman and a personal blog in snippets; the 2025 and H1 2026 totals come from Multifamily Dive and Bisnow
Google autocomplete volumes and "People also ask" boxes	No volume tool was available; PAA markers come from the suggest endpoint's question subtype, a proxy
Reddit vocabulary (r/realtors, r/PropertyManagement, r/estateagents, r/uklandlords, r/EstateAgentsUK) and Facebook-group write-ups	Unreachable on every host; the forum quotes in this report come from BiggerPockets, Property Industry Eye comments, LandlordZONE, Trustpilot and BBB only
The phrases "we only use it as an address book", "leads go into a black hole", "nobody updates the pipeline"	Not found verbatim in any reachable source

Conclusion

What the research changes

The problem a small property business will pay to remove is not valuing, selling or letting. It is the loop of chasing, re-keying and date-watching that surrounds every deal and every tenancy, and in 2025-26 that loop was put under outside pressure at the same time in both countries: by regulators (HMRC's July 2026 AML guidance, the Renters' Rights Act from 1 May 2026, the DMCC Act, the FCC's revocation rules, HUD's fair-housing-and-AI guidance), by fraudsters (seller impersonation doubling, AI-built tenant identities), by the ombudsmen (lettings complaints up 47% and 65%) and by the portals (Rightmove removing images, Zillow folding Follow Up Boss into Zillow Pro). The strongest language is therefore risk and evidence language, not productivity language, and the strongest thing a reader can carry into a conversation is a regulator's finding or a dated review about the buyer's own software.

The software these firms already pay for has drawn a clear line around what it will not do: it will alert but not verify, log but not own, reconcile the bank but not the owner statement, score the applicant but not handle the exception, and migrate the data but not check it arrived. Every top-ranked gap sits on that line, and every one touches records the law says the firm must control and that staff today paste into free tools or email to a coordinator at £4.50 an hour: tenancy certificates and notices, bank statements and ID, owner ledgers, title documents, application documents and executed contracts.

Where not to go, and what the law reserves to a person

Listing copy, phone answering, CRM set-up, screening reports, cold calling and title-side wire tools are where the vendors, the gigs and the venture money already sit, and their users complain about quality, contracts and price rather than absence.

The things the law reserves to a person (the Right to Rent check with the holder present, the nominated officer's AML judgment, the conveyancer's ID1, the landlord's FCRA notice, the licensed agent's publication sign-off, the call-back on a wire instruction) are boundaries to design around, not gaps to fill.

Two vocabularies, two markets for the same skills

The vocabulary split is not cosmetic: a UK buyer searches 'renters rights act compliance checklist', 'material information part b', 'sales progression software' and 'estate agency aml risk assessment', hires a 'lettings administrator' around 'deposits', 'certificates' and 'referencing', and finds nothing when typing those words into a freelance marketplace; a US buyer searches 'follow up boss vs lofty', 'transaction coordinator checklist pdf' and 'fair housing words to avoid pdf', hires a 'TC' or an 'ISA' around 'contract to close' and 'no lead falls through the cracks', and finds operations help only by typing a product name. The same service will need two sets of words, and the notes give them verbatim.

The job-market notes add the last contrast: the employed path pays most at the portals that are cutting staff and hiring hybrid in a handful of cities, while the freelance path is priced down to $10 a gig and $5 an hour by marketplaces, and the only priced middle tier, AppFolio trust-accounting cleanup at $34-$45 an hour with a free health check as the door-opener, is the proof that small firms pay for validation when someone offers it in their own words.

This document reports problems, workflows, numbers, vocabulary and gaps only. It contains no solutions and no recommendations. The Sources appendix lists every URL the research cited; section 11 lists what could not be verified.